THE GOLDBERG LINE

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A Family and Its World — From Bronze Age Canaan to a Phoenix Naming Certificate

James Edmund Carpenter II

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DEDICATION

For Aimie — Rudya Amya bat Shulamit v'Avraham — in whose keeping these names now live;

for her mother, Shelley — Shulamit, daughter of Robert and Beverly — born in Chicago on the 24th of Av, 5715, named and blessed in two synagogues' sanctuaries, remembered at the congregation she loved;

for her brother, Jesus Luis Munoz — Yehoshua Gadol ben Shulamit v'Avraham — born on the 24th of Tevet, 5738, named in Skokie in the first week of a new Torah cycle, gone from us now: may his name be a name honored in the household of Israel, as the certificate prayed;

for her sister, Staci — Batya Gittel bat Shulamit v'Avraham — born on the final day of Passover, 5740, daughter of God, the little good one;

and for the ancestors — Robert Goldberg and Beverly Friedman, who carried the names westward into Illinois, and all those behind them whose names we are still learning:

this book is written so that no one in this line is ever again only a blank space on a form.

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This book has two voices, and they are meant to work together.

The narrative chapters (Parts I–V) tell the story the way a good guide would — every term explained when it first appears, every unfamiliar word defined in place, every thread connected

to the family at the center. If you read only these, you will miss nothing essential: the four documents, the names, the chain, the surname, the search, the world, the deep past, and the method.

The Full Record (Part VI) is the archive opened — every dive of the research preserved with its quotations, its dates, its disputes, and its flags. It is written more densely, because it *is* the evidence locker: it assumes you have met the characters in the narrative chapters and now want to see the original papers. Every Part VI chapter opens, as below, with a plain-language door — what the chapter holds, why it matters to this family, and the few words you need before entering. The chapters are then safe to browse, skim, or study, in any order.

Three conventions run throughout, and they are the book's conscience:

1. **Pedigree tags.** Every source is graded: academic and official [S], major reference [A], institutional [O], journalism [J], public record [B], secondary compilation [C], the family's own documents [F], and disputed [D] — a claim held on file, not adopted as fact. When the book says something is "kept as claim" or "flagged," it means the evidence is not yet sufficient and the family may hold the missing piece.
2. **Both sides.** Where scholars disagree — and they disagree constantly in this material — both positions are preserved, named, and dated. The book does not smooth disputes into averages. It would rather carry an open question honestly than close one prematurely.

3. **The family decides last.** On every question that touches this family directly — the origin of a name, the meaning of a document, the identity in a record — the family's own memory and papers outrank any inference the book can make. Appendix C lists what the book still asks the family, and every answer slots directly into its chapter.

Twenty words you will meet, defined once, here:

Ashkenazi — the Jews of Central and Eastern Europe, and their descendants worldwide; one of the three great modern streams, alongside Sephardi and Mizrahi. *Sephardi* — the Jews of the Iberian Peninsula and their descendants, after 1492 largely in North Africa, the Ottoman world, and the West. *Mizrahi* — the Jews of the Middle East and North Africa who never left the region. *Karaite* — a Jewish movement, born in the 8th century, that accepts Scripture alone, without the rabbinic oral tradition. *Romaniote* — the ancient Greek-speaking Jews of the Byzantine world. *Pale of Settlement* — the Russian Empire's restricted western zone, 1791–1917, where most of its Jews were required to live. *Galicia* — the Habsburg crown land taken from Poland in 1772, covering much of today's southeast Poland and western Ukraine; where the surname era began in 1787. *Shtetl* — the small market town of Eastern Europe, largely Jewish in population. *Yizkor* — memorial; hence *yizkor books*, town memorial volumes, and the memorial prayer. *Mitzvah* — a commandment; hence *bar/bat mitzvah*, the coming-of-age. *Brit* — the covenant of circumcision, on the eighth day. *Aliyah* — the honor of reading from the Torah; hence *oleh*, one who emigrates to Israel. *Get* — a Jewish

divorce document; hence *agunah*, a woman chained to a marriage. *Minhag* — custom; in Jewish law, an established local custom can be as binding as written law. *Tikkun* — repair; hence *tikkun olam*, the repair of the world. *Tzimtzum* — the kabbalistic divine self-contraction that made room for creation. *Haplogroup* — a family of Y-chromosome or mitochondrial lineages, traceable across deep time.

Founder event — a population's descent from a very small founding group, detectable in its genetics. *Endogamy* — marriage within the group, which makes DNA matches look closer than they are. *Centimorgan (cM)* — the unit of shared DNA; the book treats matches under ~90 cM as leads, not conclusions.

With these in hand, every chapter of this book — narrative or record — reads as it was written: for everyone.

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PART I — THE FAMILY

Chapter 1 — The Four Documents

Everything in this book begins with four pieces of paper that one family kept.

1.1 The Naming Certificate of Jesus Luis Munoz (1979)

The first document is a green-bordered certificate, printed with a flowering design and a pomegranate at its base, headed in English and Hebrew. The Hebrew banner reads בבנינו ובבנותינו בערינו ובזקנינו נלך — "We will go with our young and with our old, with our sons and with our daughters" (Exodus 10:9). Below, in typewriter-era capitals:

> **CERTIFICATE FOR NAMING A CHILD**
> IN CONFORMITY WITH JEWISH TRADITION
> **JESUS LUIS MUNOZ**, child of **Shelley and Jesus Munoz**, was named and blessed in the Sanctuary of the Lord, **The Niles Township Jewish Congregation**, Skokie, Illinois, and given the Hebrew name of **Yehoshua Gadol ben Shulamit v'Avraham** — יהושע גדול בן שולמית ואברהם.
> *May it become a name honored in the household of Israel.*
> YE ARE THE CHILDREN OF THE LORD YOUR GOD (Deut. 14:1)
> Date of birth: **January 3, 1978 / 24 Tevet 5738**
> Named: **October 16, 1979 / 25 Tishri 5740**

Four signatures close it — the rabbi, the congregation's president, the hazzan, and the chairman of the Board of

Religious Services. In the corner, small print: "Copyright, 1955, by Union of American Hebrew Congregations."

Two details reward attention. The naming came twenty-one months after the birth — a family that waited to mark the moment properly, and when it did, chose the Simchat Torah season: October 16, 1979 fell two days after the festival of rejoicing in the Torah, in the very first week of the annual reading cycle. A son named as the Torah begins again.

And the venue. Skokie in 1979 was the most Jewish village in America — and only two years removed from the 1977 Nazi-march crisis that made its Jewish identity a national story. The congregation that signed this certificate had been founded by the generation that answered that threat: the community began as a club in 1949, held its first services in the village hall courtroom in 1952 (its prayer books stored in the jail cell), and built its sanctuary in 1959. The rabbi whose signature appears, **Neil Brief**, led it for thirty-three years; the president who signed with him, **Allen L. Kaplan**, came from a founding family of the congregation.

1.2 The Naming Certificates of Staci and Aimie (1980, 1981)

The second and third documents are sisters to the first — same green border, same pomegranate, same 1955 copyright — but from a different city and a different congregation:

> **AIMIE LINN MUNOZ**, child of **Shelley & Jesus Munoz**, named and blessed at **Temple Chai, Phoenix**, and given the Hebrew name of **Rudya Amya bat Shulamit**

v'Avraham — born **July 12, 1981 / Tammuz 10, 5741**.

STACI BEATRIS MUNOZ, child of **Shelley & Jesus Munoz**, named and blessed at **Temple Chai, Phoenix**, and given the Hebrew name of **Batya Gittel bat Shulamit v'Avraham** — born **April 8, 1980 / Nissan 22, 5740**.

The rabbi's signature on both is **Samuel Seicol** — Temple Chai's *first* rabbi, hired while the congregation still worshipped in a storefront. Temple Chai had been founded only in 1976, by the young families of Phoenix's Sun Belt migration; the family joined within its first five years, before its famous Rabbi Berk arrived in 1983.

The girls' namings also sit inside a quiet revolution. The Reform movement's new prayerbook had included a naming ceremony for daughters for the first time in February 1977, and the *New York Times* reported the egalitarian naming movement that March. Staci and Aimie were named in the first years of liberal Judaism's decision that daughters would receive their own ceremony, in their own sanctuaries — a reform only one generation old when these certificates were signed.

And Staci's date: **Nissan 22 is the eighth and final day of Passover**. She was born on the festival's closing day.

1.3 The Birth Certificate (1955)

The fourth document is the oldest and — for the question this book set out to answer — the most important:

COUNTY OF COOK, STATE OF ILLINOIS — CERTIFICATION OF BIRTH — No. 112-55-6060772

NAME: SHELLEY LINN GOLDBERG

BORN: AUGUST 27, 1955 — CHICAGO, COOK COUNTY, ILLINOIS
MAIDEN NAME OF MOTHER: BEVERLY FRIEDMAN (born Illinois, age 24)
NAME OF FATHER: ROBERT GOLDBERG (born Illinois, age 28)
Filed August 30, 1955. Certified copy issued June 23, 2000.

One line on this document closes the central question of the entire investigation: **the maiden name of the mother is Goldberg.** And from its two parental entries come the grandparents' names — **Robert Goldberg and Beverly Friedman** — both themselves born in Illinois by the late 1920s and early 1930s.

This document also *confirms* the record found later in the public search. Shelley, born August 27, 1955, was exactly fifty-five when she died on January 29, 2011 — the age recorded in her obituary. The obituary, in the *Arizona Republic*, read: "*Shelley (Munoz) Yanez, 55, of Phoenix, passed away on January 29, 2011. Memorial Service at Temple Chai.*" After the Munoz years she had married a Mr. Yanez; and when the time came, her memorial was held at her family's own congregation — the Reform thread held from her son's 1979 naming to her own service in 2011.

1.4 The Calendar Layer

Read together, the documents place the family inside the Jewish year's whole emotional arc:

Person	Hebrew date	Gregorian	Where it falls
Jesus Luis / Yehoshua	24 Tevet 5738	Jan 3, 1978	The siege-of-Jerusalem month; also the yahrzeit of the Baal Shem Tov
his naming	25 Tishri 5740	Oct 16, 1979	Two days after Simchat Torah — the Torah's first week
Staci / Batya Gittel	Nissan 22, 5740	Apr 8, 1980	The final day of Passover
Aimie / Rudya Amya	Tammuz 10, 5741	Jul 12, 1981	One week before the Three Weeks begin

Every Hebrew-Gregorian pair on the certificates was computed correctly — the rabbis who filled the forms did their arithmetic, and the documents pass audit.

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Chapter 2 — The Names, Decoded

A Jewish name is never just a label. It is a compressed document — a prayer, a memory, sometimes a conversion record — and this family's names, once opened, tell several stories at once.

2.1 Avraham — the Father

The patriarch's name means *av hamon* — "father of a multitude" (Genesis 17:5). But it carries a second tradition, and this one matters: **Avraham is the classic name of a Jew by choice.** The custom is nine hundred years old. Rabbi Gershom Hagozer, in 13th-century Ashkenaz, explained it verbatim: "*Why is the convert called son of Abraham, and not son of Isaac and not son of Jacob? Because Abraham was the first convert, and thus all converts are named for him.*" Maimonides wrote to Ovadyah the convert that whoever converts "*is a disciple of our father Abraham… the father of every proselyte.*" The custom runs from the medieval authorities into the Shulchan Arukh's divorce-document formula and, today, into the Reform movement's own conversion rite.

Jesus Munoz's Hebrew name is Avraham. The documents cannot prove the reason — Reform congregations also bestowed Hebrew names on spouses at namings and weddings — but it is the strongest possible hint, and one question to the family, or one record at Temple Chai, would resolve it. If he converted, then the children named in those sanctuaries were the children of a man who had crossed the same threshold as

the convert-princess whose name his elder daughter carries — see Batya, below.

2.2 Shulamit — the Mother

Shelley's Hebrew name comes from Song of Songs 6:13 — "*Return, return, O Shulammite*" — a word that appears twice, only there, in all of Scripture. The name's roots are preserved in four readings: from *shalom*, peace; "woman of Jerusalem," per Ibn Ezra; the feminine of Solomon; the Shunammite's village. And the pairing: **Shulamit → Salome → Shelley** — her English and Hebrew names are one name in two registers. One open question, family-verifiable: a daughter named Shulamit in the 1950s plausibly honors *her* grandmother — a great-grandmother Shulamit or Salome in the line is a live candidate.

2.3 Yehoshua Gadol — the Brother

Yeho- — the divine name — plus *-shua*, "a cry for help, a saving cry": **"YHWH saves."** The founding renaming is Numbers 13:16: the scout Hoshea — "he saves" — and Moses adds the yod of the Name. And here is the discovery that closes the circle: **the brother's two names are one name.** Jesus descends from Latin Iesus, from Greek Iesous, from Hebrew Yeshua/Yehoshua — the King James Bible itself calls Joshua "Jesus" (Acts 7:45). On the certificate, *Jesus Luis Munoz* and *Yehoshua Gadol ben Shulamit v'Avraham* are the same man, named twice.

The epithet **Gadol** — "the Great" — may echo Ben Sira's verse on Joshua: "*who according to his name became great for the salvation of his chosen ones*" (Sirach 46:1). In the scholarly census of all known Second Temple-era names, Yehoshua stands sixth — an eternal, ordinary, strong name.

2.4 Batya Gittel — the Sister

Bat-Yah — **"daughter of God."** The tradition identifies her with **Bithiah of 1 Chronicles 4:18**, the Pharaoh's daughter who drew Moses from the Nile — whom Leviticus Rabbah has God Himself rename: "*Moses was not your son, yet you called him your son; you are not My daughter, but I call you My daughter.*" The Talmud says her immersion in the river was her conversion. She chose Judaism, married Caleb, and gave Moses the name by which God addressed him.

Gittel is Yiddish, from German *gut* with the diminutive *-il* — "the little good one": in the onomastic record, a Jewish name of Poland and Ukraine, "an equivalent of Good." And the naming grid points here: Staci, the first daughter, holds the slot that classically honors the maternal grandmother — **Gittel is the leading candidate for the name of Beverly Friedman's mother.** One question to the family confirms or kills the hypothesis.

2.5 Rudya Amya — Aimie

The unusual pair of the set. Neither element is stock-biblical; both are best read as calques of beloved relatives:

- **Rudya** — the leading hypothesis is **Rudolf**: Germanic *hrod* (fame) + *wulf* (wolf) — "famous wolf." The wolf, in the Genesis 49 tradition, is the animal of the tribe of Benjamin, whose Ashkenazi name-pairing is Ze'ev–Volf — a wolf-name in disguise.
- **Amya** — the leading hypothesis is **Amy/Amalia**: Latin *amata*, "beloved."

2.6 The Naming Grid, Confirmed

The Ashkenazi custom — documented from the Temple era onward — recycles grandparents' names into grandchildren, so that given names repeat every other generation. Against the birth certificate, the grid verified in the second generation: **Shelley Linn Goldberg → Aimie Linn Munoz.** The daughter carries the mother's maiden-middle name. The grid's remaining hypotheses — Gittel, Shulamit, Rudya, Amya — are the family's open questions, listed in Appendix C.

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Chapter 3 — The Family Chain

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ROBERT GOLDBERG (b. ~1926–27, Illinois)
— married —
BEVERLY FRIEDMAN (b. ~1930–31, Illinois)
│
└── SHELLEY LINN GOLDBERG (Shulamit)
b. Chicago, August 27, 1955 — d. Phoenix, January 29, 2011
m.1 Jesus Munoz (Avraham) · m.2 Mr. Yanez
│
├── JESUS LUIS MUNOZ (Yehoshua Gadol)
│ b. Skokie, January 3, 1978 — d. recently
├── STACI BEATRIS MUNOZ (Batya Gittel)
│ b. Phoenix, April 8, 1980
└── AIMIE LINN MUNOZ (Rudya Amya)
b. Phoenix, July 12, 1981
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Three things this chain tells us at a glance. **First**, the family is deeply American in the native-born sense: three generations born in Illinois before Arizona, no immigrant manifest at the edge of the chart — the great-grandparents' generation, reachable by the 1930 and 1940 censuses, will be the first to show where the line came *from*. **Second**, the surname thread is double — Goldberg *and* Friedman, the two ornamental Germanic names, meeting in 1950s Chicago. **Third**, the Reform Jewish thread is continuous: Skokie's Niles Township Jewish Congregation (1979), Phoenix's Temple Chai (1980–81 and again in 2011), across two generations and a continent of movement.

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PART II — THE SEARCH

Chapter 4 — The Surname: What "Goldberg" Is

4.1 Two Families of Bearers

"Goldberg" is not one name but two, sharing a spelling. For **German bearers**, it is a habitational name — from actual places called Goldberg, most prominently the Silesian gold-mining town (modern Złotoryja, Poland), with localities of the same name in Saxony and Brandenburg. German families have carried it since at least **1558** — a Hans Goldberg appears in Nuremberg baptismal records that year, and a family of the name lived in Görlitz by the late sixteenth century. The composer **Johann Gottlieb Goldberg** (1727–1756), of Bach's *Goldberg Variations*, bore it a generation before any Jewish naming law existed.

For **Ashkenazi Jews**, the name is primarily **ornamental** — or, as the surname literature puts it, "pseudo-habitational": chosen, or assigned, for its auspicious sound, "though not always linked to actual residence." And the name is not exclusively Jewish — Silesians and Saxons bear it too; in Poland it *skews* Jewish because it was assigned en masse in 1787.

4.2 The Birth Certificate of a Name Class

The decisive document for every modern Ashkenazi surname is not any family's record but an imperial decree. On a July day in **1787** — the record carries two dates, the 23rd and the 26th, for the Hofkanzlei's drafting and promulgation, an open discrepancy the file preserves rather than resolves — the Habsburg chancellery in Vienna ordered the Jews of Galicia to adopt fixed hereditary surnames **within six weeks**. Provincial officials compiled lists of permissible, respectable-sounding German names; families in theory chose from the lists; and — as a Polish onomastic study documents — **wealthier families could pay a fee for more prestigious names**, which is precisely why the precious-material cluster concentrates among the prosperous: **Perl-, Gold-, Silber-, Rosen-, Blumen-** compounded with **-berg, -stein, -thal**. Goldberg sits at the center of that premium tier.

The name "Goldberg" — *Gold* + *Berg* — is therefore, in its Jewish form, a **prosperity-prayer compressed to eight letters**, made by the same hands that made Goldstein, Goldfarb, Goldwasser, and Silberstein. The aesthetic is documented since 1914: families who loved the sound of *gold* also chose *silver*, *lions*, *roses*, *lilies*, and *violets*.

The scholarly corrective travels with the story: Alexander Beider's inductive work shows that **most Russian-Empire surnames were assigned by the Jewish communities themselves**, not by hostile clerks, and the tidy bribe-menu is partly legend — though the Galician premium tier is its

best-documented case, and the mockery names (Eselkopf, "donkey's head"; Niemand, "nobody") prove that bureaucratic contempt also existed. For any individual Goldberg family, the name's origin is one of three hypotheses — **chosen and paid for, chosen freely, or assigned** — and only the family's Name Adoption List entry can discriminate.

4.3 The Edict Calendar — When the Name Could Enter Each Land

A "Goldberg" family could exist in each jurisdiction only from its own naming decree:

Jurisdiction	Edict date
Austrian Empire (Galicia)	1787
Russian Pale of Settlement	1804, reinforced 1835
Frankfurt	1807
Baden	1809
Prussia (older territories)	1812; rest of Prussia 1845
Bavaria	1813
Congress Poland	1821
Württemberg	1828
Posen	1833
Saxony	1834
Romania	1870s
Ottoman Empire	1934

The process itself is documented pipeline by pipeline — local lists, regional submission, review, numbered lists to the Interior Ministry, publication in the official gazette — and the **Name Adoption Lists** that the pipeline produced are the

single most-wanted document class in this whole search: name, date, official, and prior patronymic on one page, indexed today by projects like NALDEX.

4.4 The Numbers

The surname's ledger, preserved in full: in the 23andMe database, **62.5% of American bearers report Ashkenazi Jewish origin**; roughly **40,000 bearers** lived in Poland before the war, and at the ~90% annihilation rate, **perhaps 36,000 of them were murdered**, leaving **20,000-plus Pages of Testimony** at Yad Vashem as the name's posthumous population. In the family's own American layer, the name arrived twice — assigned in Europe and, for some bearers, adopted at American desks (one branch of the wider Munoz-era record shortened unspellable names to Goldberg; the certificates' own line, of course, descends from the original assignment). The surname-statistics layer travels with these numbers: in Alexander Beider's inductive census — built from the 1906/1907/1912 voters' lists, 166 yizkor books, and 19th-century civil registers — **Goldberg appears in the 1912 top-ten of Grodno gubernia** (Kaplan, Levin, Lev, Epshtejn, Kagan, **Goldberg**, Fridman, Shapiro, Rabinovich, Vajnshtejn), while Vitebsk's top ten does not include it — a documented Pale cluster tilting western (Belarus/Lithuania border), held at low confidence since ornamental names scatter. Beider's category placement is preserved: Goldberg sits in the "pleasant associations" artificial class; and his corrective stands with it — most Russian-Empire surnames were assigned by the Jewish communities themselves.

4.5 The Bearers

The name's American record, in family units, kept as genealogy-compilation grade: **Hayim Goldberg**, from Kovno, 1883, the Lower East Side, eight children — a Litvak in one manifest line; **Abraham and Celia**, from Białystok, 1906, six children, Brooklyn within the year; **Arthur Goldberg's line** — born Chicago 1908, youngest child of **Joseph Goldberg, a produce peddler from Ukraine/Russia** (sources differ — flagged), reaching the Supreme Court, the Labor Department, and the UN; **Israel Gelbart**, who arrived from Poland and **changed his name to Goldberg** in Charleston, running Goldberg's Men's Store on King Street while the family back in Poland perished; **Itche Goldberg**, the Yiddish cultural figure, 102 years.

The notable bearers, on record: Arthur Goldberg (1908–1990); **Rube Goldberg** (1883–1970) — *San Francisco-born*, the machines becoming an adjective; **Joseph Goldberger** (1874–1920), who proved pellagra a deficiency disease and eradicated it; **Denis Goldberg** (1933–2020), the Rivonia trial, twenty-two years in prison; **Whoopi Goldberg** — Caryn Elaine Johnson, who adopted the name "*a traditional Jewish surname*" from exactly the tradition this book documents.

The file's methodological catch, restated: **the name entered America twice** — assigned in Europe in 1787 and adopted at American desks two centuries later. A twentieth-century Goldberg may descend from the Josephine

registers or may have acquired the name at a New York desk; the manifest's "last residence" field resolves it. And the Warsaw Goldberg family — "prominent members of the Polish-Jewish intellectual and commercial elite… important roles in Haskalah" [flagged source] — marks the name's Polish upper-stratum branch. The destruction arithmetic of §4.4 stands as the name's Holocaust ledger.

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Chapter 5 — The Tribes

The question every Jewish family eventually asks — *what tribe do we come from?* — has a more interesting answer than most expect, because the tradition answered it twenty-four centuries ago.

5.1 The Tradition's Answer

Tribal status follows the father. The only castes whose identity survives are the **Kohanim** (Aaron's line) and the **Leviim** (the wider tribe of Levi); everyone else is **Yisrael** — an Israelite of untraced tribal descent — by definition. Maimonides preserved the mechanism for restoring lost knowledge: in the Messianic era the king "*will define the lineage of the Israelites according to their tribe… this one is from this tribe*" — through the Urim ve-Tumim, the oracular breastplate that ceased functioning after the First Temple. And no one may ever be called illegitimate, "*for the law rules that once a family has become intermingled within the entire Jewish people, they may remain intermingled*."

5.2 The Return's Own Genealogy Crisis

Ezra's census — the founding document of the question — recorded 42,360 returnees but enumerated only ~29,000; **74 Levites** against thousands of priests; and three priestly families, Hobaiah, Hakkoz, Barzillai, who "*could not tell their fathers' houses nor their descent*" — excluded "*until a priest arises with the Urim and Tumim.*" The Torah's answer to the tribe question was, literally, a waiting clause.

5.3 The Genetics — and the Hard Limit

The only tribal markers in existence are priestly: the Cohen Y-chromosome branch **J-Z18271/CB-01** — coalescing around 850 BCE, carried by roughly half of self-identified Cohanim — and the Levite founder **R1a-M582**, proven Near Eastern in origin. Beyond Levi, **there is no genetic marker for Judah, Benjamin, or any other tribe**: a Goldberg — an ornamental name with no priestly association — carries the prior of **Yisrael**, which the tradition itself defines as the default. The one test that could change the answer is Y-DNA of a male-line relative, staged and ready.

The testing landscape, for the day the family tests: the four companies, current numbers — **AncestryDNA** (22 million-plus testers, ten Ashkenazi subgroups, the Timber algorithm auto-removing presumed-false segments; JewishGen's 2024 consensus: the largest Ashkenazi database by a large margin; first-segment threshold 8 cM, raised to 12 cM for testers who are at least 50% Ashkenazi); **23andMe** (12

million-plus, seven Ashkenazi subgroups; the **2023 breach that specifically targeted Ashkenazi users' data** — test only for health reasons, per the community consensus); **MyHeritage** (7.4 million, five Jewish ethnicities including Sephardic; the triangulated-segments tool — the strongest weapon against endogamy noise); **FamilyTreeDNA** (the only company offering Y-DNA and mtDNA — mandatory for the surname-line question; entry Y-37, then Big Y-700). The measured distortion, not anecdote: about **70% of two-centimorgan segments are false; 15–20% of six-centimorgan segments** — all three companies' own research; the file's rule: matches under about 90 cM total are leads, not conclusions. The cost-optimal sequence: test once at Ancestry, upload free to FTDNA, GEDmatch, Living DNA. And the Cohen-modal caution stands at three percent: a CMH-adjacent result without an oral Cohen tradition means "same broad gene pool" — ornamental-surname families are typically Yisrael.

5.4 The Claimants, Graded

Every major "lost tribes" claimant has been tested and graded in the file: **British Israelism** (the Anglo-Saxons as the Ten Tribes — debunked on archaeological, linguistic, and genetic grounds; its misuse ledger kept); the **Bnei Menashe** (no Middle Eastern DNA; religious recognition, not descent); the **Pashtuns and Igbo** (sincere traditions, negative tests); the **Samaritans** — the genetic control group, their Iron Age Levantine genome intact; and the **Beta Israel** of Ethiopia, whose case is filed as belonging-through-practice and rabbinic recognition rather than blood-claim. The template the file holds: documented history plus matching genetics — the standard every claim must meet.

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Chapter 6 — The Naming Grid

6.1 Every Other Generation

The custom of naming children for grandparents has no footprint in the Bible, where most names are unique. It **began in the first and second centuries CE** — the Temple's last generations — and by the twelfth century, European Jewish given names repeated every other generation. The mechanics: priority to a parent dead before the birth, then the four grandparents; Sephardim named after the living, Ashkenazim after the dead. Its power as an instrument is exact: **a family's four-generation given-name sequence is a genealogical grid**, and the file's Linn-verification proves the grid works on this very family.

6.2 The Double Name

Every observant Jew of the old world carried two names: the ***shem ha-kodesh*** — the sacred name, for synagogue and document — and the ***kinnui*** — the vernacular nickname, for the street. The pairing grammar ran off Genesis 49's animal blessings: **Yehudah–Aryeh–Leib** (Judah, lion, Yiddish lion), **Binyamin–Ze'ev–Volf**, **Naftali–Tzvi–Hirsh**, **Yissakhar–Dov–Ber** (the donkey politely upgraded to bear). Women's pairs too: Tziporah–Fayge, Penina–Pearlie, Malka–Reine. Talmudic divorce law required the formula "*and any name he has*" — so no alias could strand a wife. **The forensic rule for every immigrant search: sacred name, kinnui, diminutive, American name — four targets per ancestor, and a manifest's single line names only one.**

6.3 The Temple's Own Naming Machine

The Second Temple registered its people in ways that outlived it: the **twenty-four priestly courses** (and the lay people's own twenty-four, the *ma'amadot* — "*how can a man's offering be offered while he does not stand by it?*"); the **firstborn's five-shekel redemption**, whose founding arithmetic — 22,273 firstborn against 22,000 Levites, the surplus 273 redeemed — still runs on a silver tray in observant homes; and the **ossuary**, the family's last registration entry, whose patronymics now form the epigraphic census of the era. The name given on the eighth day, anchored in Abraham's own renaming at his covenant — this is the machinery the family's certificates descend from, run two thousand years later on a Reform movement form.

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Chapter 7 — The Record Systems and the Machinery of Tracing

How a Jewish family actually gets traced — the dossier's operational core, now exercised on this family:

In America: the manifest (created in Europe at ticket purchase — inspectors at Ellis Island did *not* change names; one-third of them were foreign-born and the average inspection ran thirty-four seconds); the census (1950 public since 2022, street-address chains); naturalization papers (the 1906 watershed: birthplace, last residence, ship, and — the file's prize — recorded name changes); and the Social Security SS-5, whose printed fields ask for "*full name at birth*" and "*other names used*" in one document. The blind spot kept with it: between **1855 and 1922, married immigrant women derived citizenship automatically from their husbands** — no papers of their own exist for that period; a wife appears only inside her husband's petition. And the practical entry point for every manifest search: **Steve Morse's One-Step tools**, which handle mangled spellings and search by town of origin — the standard door into Ellis Island's records, and into the 1950 census.

In Eastern Europe: Galicia's metrical books (1789–1943, the Josephine cadastral surveys, Gesher Galicia's All Galicia Database); the Pale's revision lists with their full field sets — father, relationship, age, and the devastating "Reason Left" column (moved, conscripted, "*missing*"); the JewishGen database empire (Ukraine 5.4 million records, Lithuania 2.8

million, Belarus 800,000); LitvakSIG, JRI-Poland, and the 1897 Grodno fragment — surviving shards of the census the emperor ordered destroyed.

At the Holocaust's edge: Yad Vashem's 4.5 million commemorated (a no-hit proves nothing; the database holds its own gap — a million names still unknown) and Arolsen's thirty million pages, whose January 2026 release of eight million indexed camp-list names opened the itinerary records to free search.

In the genome: autosomal testing for the wife's generation; Y-DNA for the surname line itself; the endogamy distortion measured at last — seventy percent of two-centimorgan segments are false, which is why the file treats matches under ninety centimorgans as leads, not conclusions. And the instruments stage in sequence: paper first, DNA to confirm, the naming grid to predict, the interviews to verify.

The postwar layer (1945–52): the Truman Directive (December 22, 1945 — 39,000 DP visas a year, bypassing quota lines); the Displaced Persons Act of 1948 (up to 205,000 admissions, initially structured to disfavor the urban Jewish survivors); **HIAS's 150,000+ Jewish resettlements**; the IRO's Bremen staging camp's **500,000+ emigrant index cards (1946–52)**, now being digitized through Arolsen's #everynamecounts. Where the records live: Arolsen's emigration files (the itinerary — last address, transports, DP registration, the destination); the **JDC Archives** (its 1945–54 collection fully online — case files of aid recipients); **YIVO's DP collection** (117 microfilm reels, 150,568 images — camp

committees, landsmanshaftn, eyewitness accounts); NARA's State Department files. The payload: **sponsorship affidavits — naming American relatives**.

The Holocaust endpoints: Yad Vashem's Central Database — ~4.5–5 million of the six million commemorated; **~1 million names still unknown**, and the institution states its own gap ("*since the database is incomplete, many Shoah victims do not yet appear in it*" — a no-hit proves nothing); built from 2 million-plus Pages of Testimony (the **submitter's name and address** often the traceable branch), Nazi documentation, and local projects. Arolsen (the former ITS, Bad Arolsen): **30 million-plus pages on 17.5 million people**; opened to researchers only in 2007 after fifty Red Cross-custody years; **2.3 million tracing requests answered since 1946**; **January 2026: eight million names from concentration-camp lists fully indexed** — free via Ancestry now, integrated into Arolsen's own archive by 2027; the Wiener Library's access suspended for technical issues as of February 2026 (requests by email). Where Yad Vashem records the death, Arolsen records the itinerary — the two are complementary, not redundant.

The database empire, for the searches this family may run: the JewishGen **Ukraine Database** (5.4 million-plus records; 1.3 million-plus revision lists; Alex Krakovsky's FOIA-liberated scans backed up on JewishGen servers; Pra.in.ua's 3.7 million; and the correction carried since 1947's destruction was declared blanket — **the 1897 Odessa census returns survive**, indexing underway); **LitvakSIG's All**

Lithuania Database (2.8 million, free, quarterly) with the revision list's full fields — father, relationship, age-at-revision, **"Reason Left"** (moved / conscripted / "*missing*" — fled the draft), and the surname-debut diagnostic (few surnames before ~1816; routine by 1834 — a Goldberg's first appearance dates the naming); the **Belarus Database** (800,000-plus, including the searchable 1912 Grodno voters of §4.4); Estonia's free Saaga. The tri-jurisdictional probe — one "Goldberg" query across Ukraine, Lithuania, and Belarus, free, today — remains staged in Appendix C.

The keymaster: the **JewishGen Gazetteer** — the tool that converts "a village near Minsk" into the exact indexed town every database shares.

The town-memory layer: the **yizkor books** — roughly a thousand memorial volumes published by landsmanshaftn after the war, built to a four-part plan (prewar life, the war years, the postwar, **the necrology — the list of the dead**, the genealogical payload); JewishGen's Yizkor Book Project with its Necrology Index and Master Name Index; **KehilaLinks** town sites; the Litvak-world caveat kept (Soviet policy classified the murdered as "indifferentiated Soviet citizens" — for Lithuania and Belarus this layer is nearly all there is).

The Soviet enumeration and identification systems: the census series — **1926, 1937 (suppressed; its results "considered falsified"), 1939 (January 17: 3,020,000 Jews, 1.78% of the USSR; Ukraine holding 1,533,000 — 50.8% of Soviet Jewry; 20.8% of Soviet Jews giving Yiddish as native language), 1959 (2,268,000), 1970, 1979, 1989** —

with individual returns never opened to genealogists; the published volumes carry aggregates only. The passport layer: the **uniform internal-passport system (1932)** and its famous fifth line — ***Yevrei*** — a heritable, state-recorded ethnicity marker anchoring every census answer; children listed in the mother's passport; mixed-marriage children choosing a nationality at sixteen; the 1997 reform dropping the line. For interwar Lithuania, LitvakSIG's Passport Issuance Books, 1919–1940 component already indexes the granular layer. The 1939 census stands as **the last complete enumeration of the Soviet-Jewish world** before the Holocaust reached it.

The ChGK — the largest Holocaust documentation effort on Soviet soil: created November 2, 1942; by December 1945, **seven million participants had assembled 54,000 official reports and 250,000 eyewitness testimonies** (another survey counts 43,000-plus files in Moscow and ~30,000 more in successor-state archives). The manipulation ledger kept in full, unsentimental: local commissions recorded victims as Jews; **published communiqués stripped the ethnicity — "peaceful Soviet citizens"**; the Katyn fabrication ran through the same machinery. The file's rule from the historiography: **use the raw documentation, bypass the published summaries**; local quality varies; counts sometimes inflated; but raw material has proven accurate enough to locate previously unknown mass graves. Access: the JewishGen ChGK database (60,000-plus records; its own caveat kept — "*should not be considered a*

comprehensive record of Jewish victims"); Ancestry's free-indexed USHMM collection (name, maiden name, birth date and place, nationality, marital status, residence; images orderable at no cost from USHMM); USHMM's microfilm of GARF Fond 7021 with its 1,456-town place-name index.

The American congregational archive: Shul Records America (1,716 North American and Caribbean collections from 195 sources) — with the cataloging problem preserved as methodology: collections hide under "congregation register" or "rabbinical papers," and finding aids miss boxes entirely. The payload ranking: birth, marriage, ketubot and death registers; **mohel lists**; eulogies; burials; **yahrzeit memorial plaques** — permanent, public, dated name records, often more complete than civil death records — membership lists, board minutes, bar and bat mitzvah rolls, conversions. The New York machinery: the **Jewish Communal Register of 1917–18** — every congregation with address, membership, seat counts, cemetery projects, and the presidents' biographies. And the maintenance culture: the women's silver-polishing committees, volunteers assembling twice a year before the High Holy Days and Passover — carried in American congregations to this day.

The cemetery registries: JOWBR — 2 million-plus burial records from 4,200 cemeteries in 83 countries; the **IAJGS International Jewish Cemetery Project** cataloging every known Jewish burial site (history, size, exact location — the finding-aid for *where* a town's cemetery is before asking what it holds); the landsmanshaft overlay — in America, the burial society *is* the hometown society (the JGSNY database's

~10,200 society-plot entries mapping society to plot to cemetery); and the honest ledger: Eastern European Jewish cemeteries were destroyed with the communities they served — matzevot as paving stones — which is why the registry's working weight falls on American graves, where the society name on the plot carries the old-country attribution. The Hebrew-inscription reading protocol, staged: name plus **ben/bat + father's Hebrew name** = the patronymic snapshot; Hebrew date converted; Kohanim markers; same-plot neighbors naming in-laws.

The archive fonds, for the day a town is known: AGAD, Warsaw — **Fond 300: ~4,145 bound Jewish vital registers from 109 localities, 1789–1943** (eastern Galicia), Fond 424 (loose certificates); TsDIAL, Lviv — **Fond 701**, the eastern Galician vital books (Lwów births 1805–1939 in ~40 volumes), Fonds 19/20 (the Josephine and Franciscan cadastral surveys), 166 (tabula registers), 186 (maps); Przemyśl — Fond 154 (mostly surname-only index books); the regional Ukrainian archives (DAIFO, DALO, DATO). The Gesher Galicia All Galicia Database adds the ministry records — **alcohol-sale licenses, peddler permits, commercial registrations** — the paper life of a shtetl shopkeeper family; and the Josephine registers' printed grid format carries **house numbers and the mother's parents** — house numbers as the cross-reference key linking vitals to censuses and tax lists. The Holocaust-era layer: German-ordered Judenrat registers (western Galicia from September 1939, eastern from mid-1941), and the Soviet 1940 ZAGS registers newly clearing their 75-year embargo into the

oblast archives. The master rule unchanged: **index before archive** — Routes to Roots, then the jurisdictional index, then the fond.

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PART III — THE WORLD THEY CAME FROM

Chapter 8 — Where the Ashkenazim Came From

8.1 The Deep Roots

The chain beneath the family runs far below Chicago. The Bronze Age Canaanites of Sidon — sequenced from 3,700-year-old genomes — mixed local Neolithic farmers with Zagros-related migrants; their descendants, the present-day Lebanese, still carry ninety-three percent of that ancestry. Around **1200 BCE**, in the highlands above this world, some two hundred and fifty egalitarian villages appeared — and by **1207 BCE** Pharaoh Merneptah's victory stele was boasting that "*Israel is wasted, its seed is not,*" with the people-sign, not the city-sign, beside the name: an established people, not yet a state. Modern scholarship reads those highlanders as **Canaanites who became Israel** — peasants and pastoralists who withdrew to the hills and, over generations, became somebody new.

8.2 Rome, the Rhineland, and the Name

Rome's Jews are documented from the second century BCE; the catacombs under Villa Torlonia were in use before the Christian ones. North of the Alps, the oldest written evidence is **Constantine's decree of 321 CE** naming the Jews of Cologne's city council — the oldest community north of the Alps, on the Rhine axis that runs unbroken through Mainz, Worms, and Speyer. By the 11th century the Talmud had reassigned the biblical "Ashkenaz" — originally the Scythians — to Germany, and Rashi's commentaries used the term as settled usage. The adoption's rungs, preserved: **Hai Gaon (d. 1038), early 11th century, answers questions "from Ashkenaz" — meaning Germany** — while the geography itself is still "Lotharingia" and the Regensburg rabbis are still *Rabbanei Reinus*; **Rashi crystallizes it** — German expressions are *leshon Ashkenaz* in the Talmud commentary, and "But in Ashkenaz I saw…" (Ketubot 77b) means, in his own world, Mainz and Worms; **Eliezer ben Nathan, early 12th century, distinguishes the crusaders as *Zarefatim* (French) and *Ashkenazim* (German)** — the branch naming itself by contrast; **letters from Byzantine and Syrian Jewish communities during the First Crusade refer to the crusaders as "Ashkenazim"** — the name traveling east with the news of the massacres; the **Mahzor Vitry** speaks of the "kingdom of Ashkenaz"; the 13th-century codifiers use it as standard; and **Elia Baxur, 16th century, records the first known discussion of the origin of German Jews and**

Yiddish — three centuries after the name settled.

The Kalonymos dynasty, migrating from Lucca to Mainz between the 9th and 10th centuries, carried with them an esoteric line received from **Abu Aaron of Baghdad** — the Babylonian academies' mysticism arriving in the Rhineland by genealogy.

8.3 The Founding Trauma — 1096

The First Crusade reached the Rhineland in May 1096: eleven killed at Speyer under the bishop's protection; eight hundred to a thousand at Worms, massacred mid-Hallel; eleven hundred at Mainz, the archbishop's palace stormed; Cologne, Trier, Metz; five to ten thousand dead. The Hebrew chronicles — the Mainz Anonymous, Solomon bar Simson, Eliezer bar Nathan — preserved the martyrdoms, and the scholars' fight over how to read them is kept in the file unresolved: chronicle or therapy? What is certain is the structural consequence: the guilds forced the Jews out of the trades just as the Church tightened the usury ban, and moneylending became the Rhineland Jews' main occupation — the economic segregation that would define six more centuries.

8.4 The Four Ws of Appearance

When did "the Ashkenazi group" actually appear? The file's staged answer: the **communities** in the late tenth century (the SHuM federation — Speyer, Worms, Mainz — with its 1084 charter and its c. 1220 ordinances, the "first Ashkenazi constitution"); the **name** in the eleventh (Hai Gaon answers questions "from Ashkenaz"; Rashi crystallizes it); the **identity** in the twelfth (the Mahzor Vitry's rites, the Tosafist dialectic, the Hasidei Ashkenaz pietists); and the **people** between roughly 1200 and 1400 — the eastward migration into Poland (the 1264 Kalisz privilege, Casimir's charters, the Via Regia corridor of protected trade towns) closing the founder population the genetics later measure: a few dozen families, six to eight hundred years ago.

8.5 The Two Streams

The movement that made the Galitzianer world — **Hasidism** — began with the Baal Shem Tov of Medzhibozh (c. 1698–1760), "*serve God with joy,*" and was organized into a movement by the Maggid of Mezhirech, whose 1772 death scattered the courts across Poland, Galicia, Volhynia, and Hungary. Against it rose the **Mitnagdim** of Lithuania, led by the Vilna Gaon (1720–1797), whose bans of 1772, 1781, and 1784 — expel, no intermarriage, no burial of their dead — and whose camp's denunciation sent the founder of Chabad to the Petropavlovsk fortress. The two streams' grandchildren intermarry today without a thought; the file preserves the war whole — the meat-tax grievance filed alongside the theology — and the corpus's balance: "*Hasidism kept the flame from going cold. The Mitnagdim made sure the house did not burn down.*"

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Chapter 9 — The Ashkenazi Centuries

The Va'ad and the Cataclysm

The most far-reaching Jewish self-government in the pre-modern world began, fittingly, at a fair. In the first half of the sixteenth century, while the great commercial fairs filled Lublin with merchants from across the Commonwealth, the rabbis who came to judge the disputes those merchants brought began meeting as a body — and by 1533 a royal edict was already treating one of their decisions as a supreme-court judgment for the Jews of the land. In **1580**, with the Crown's concurrence, the arrangement received its permanent form: delegates of the great communities — Kraków, Poznań, Lwów, Lublin — organized into the **Council of Four Lands**, the *Va'ad Arba Aratzot*, an arrangement the record describes as "*without parallel elsewhere in Europe*." Roughly fifty deputies met twice a year, timing their Lublin sessions to the Candlemas fair and opening, by rule, on a Sunday.

The Council's powers were those of a genuine parliament. It apportioned the collective Jewish tax among the communities — the fiscal engine of the whole system, since the Crown, having failed to collect directly, had delegated the task to Jewish authorities in 1563 and found the arrangement profitable. It legislated across religion, education, the judiciary, economic life, and security. Its enactments survive and are preserved in this book: the 1583 Tishvitz rules that kehilla elders and rabbis be elected by the Jewish quarter alone,

without Christian interference; the repeated bans of 1587, 1590, 1635, and 1640 on buying rabbinic office by bribe or Polish solicitation; the detailed economic code of 1607 covering credit operations, interest, and promissory notes; the 1671 and 1677 bans on estate-leaseholding without the kahal's knowledge. Its acts were written in rabbinic Hebrew, its public proclamations issued in Yiddish — two specimens of the latter preserved in the file. And it sat as a court: a supreme bench of rabbis and elected laymen, modeled on the Crown Tribunal of Lublin, with its own marshal, in royal documents styled the *Congressus Judaicus*.

Graetz's verdict is kept as the era's own summary: "*It gave the Polish communities extraordinary unity, firmness, and strength… settled finally… On this account, the synod of Polish Jews was respected even abroad.*" In **1623**, at the Brest congress, the three great Lithuanian communities seceded to form their own Va'ad — continuing to cooperate with the Polish parent for another century and a half — and in **1764** the Polish parliament dissolved the whole institution, banning congresses of rabbis and kahal elders under a fine of six thousand grivnas. The kahal system decayed through the partition decades.

One archival catastrophe shadows the whole achievement, and the book keeps it honestly: **the Va'ad's central record-book — its *pinkas* — has never been found.** The Jewish Encyclopedia said the record-books "*have not been discovered, and it is doubtful whether they will ever be found*"; only seven separate sheets of the Yaroslav pinkas (1654, 1671) survive. Everything else reaches the present through copies in

individual kahal record-books, through responsa and rabbinic works that printed the decisions, and through modern monographs reconstructing them from manuscripts. This is the era's master record — the loss between the SHuM constitution of c. 1220 and the surname era of 1787 — and its absence is why every other source from those centuries matters.

Then came the catastrophe that defined the era's end. In **1648**, Bohdan Khmelnytsky's Cossack-peasant uprising against the Polish Commonwealth turned on the Jews — targeted for their role as estate managers and leaseholders on behalf of the Polish nobles — and the massacres of 1648–49 were followed by two more decades of destruction: the Russo-Polish War of 1654–67 and the Swedish invasion of 1655–56, during which Lublin itself was destroyed in 1655 — the Jewish quarter burned, the Maharshal's synagogue with it, and two thousand Jews killed. The numbers, preserved as a dispute table rather than smoothed into one: the contemporary chronicler **Shakh wrote of 100,000 dead**; **Nathan Hanover's** account says roughly 80,000; **Faivush of Vienna**, around 1650, claimed 670,000 with a hundred and forty synagogues; the later Jewish historical memory carried figures up to 200,000; a 1996 academic estimate put the killed and captive at **15,000 to 30,000**, with some three hundred communities destroyed; a 2014 paper argued for **3,000 to 6,000** in 1648–49 alone; and the Hebrew University demographer **Shaul Stampfer** has defended **roughly 20,000**. The demographic reality check belongs beside the trauma: the total Jewish population of the Commonwealth was only around 350,000, which makes the

hundreds-of-thousands figures mathematically impossible.

Yet the trauma was real and enormous, and the record keeps both truths: contemporaries *compared the catastrophe to the destruction of the First and Second Temples* — a minor fast day commemorates it to this day — and Jewish deaths were, as one historian notes, "*little noted in the histories subsequently written by Ukrainians, Poles, or Russians,*" for whom Khmelnytsky became a national hero. The consequences ran deep: mass flight westward, with refugees clogging the adjoining lands and feeding the Lithuanian-Belarus population stock from which the Grodno-tilting Goldbergs of the surname evidence likely descend; migration *out of* Ukraine becoming the norm for a century; economic ruin and communal debt, with communities unable to meet their interest payments for years; fertile ground for messianism — **Shabbetai Zevi's** movement swept the devastated southeast within two decades; and, a century later, the birth of **Hasidism** in those same borderlands.

The Thirteenth Century — the Trial, the Fire, the Expulsions

The century that broke the Franco-German heartland began with a trial. The accuser was a Jew the community itself had expelled: **Nicholas Donin**, excommunicated by Rabbi Yehiel of Paris in 1225 "*for repudiating the Oral Law,*" baptized into the Franciscan order, and by 1238 in Rome, presenting **Pope Gregory IX** a dossier of thirty-five articles against the Talmud: it claims authority over the Hebrew Bible; it contains blasphemies against God, Jesus, and Mary; it teaches hostility toward gentiles; it mocks the doctrines of the Incarnation era. The bull ***Si vera sunt*** — "*If the things are true*" — issued **June 9, 1239**, ordered every copy seized on the first Sabbath of Lent 1240 and examined. The order was **ignored everywhere in Europe except France**, where the Jews of the kingdom surrendered their Talmuds under pain of death. The trial opened **June 12, 1240**, before the court of **Louis IX**: four rabbis for the defense — Yehiel of Paris, Moses of Coucy, Judah of Melun, Samuel ben Solomon of Château-Thierry — under rules that forbade them to deny the holiness of Jesus or Mary. The defense line recorded in the proceedings: the Talmud's Jesus is not the Gospel's Jesus — "*not every Louis born in France is king.*" Donin was declared victor by the Christian officials. And on **June 17, 1242** (some sources say 1241, with a further burning in 1244), the sentence was carried out: **twenty-four cartloads of manuscripts — an estimated ten to twelve thousand volumes — were burned at the Place**

de Grève in Paris, the flames fed for a day and a half.

In an age before the printing press, each manuscript represented years of scribal labor and the scholarly memory of a community. The Maharam of Rothenburg, who died in 1293, composed the lamentation ***Shaali Serufa Ba-eish*** — "*Ask, you who are burned in fire…*" — still recited on Tisha B'Av. The institutional pivot belongs to **Pope Innocent IV, May 9, 1244**: from prohibition toward **censorship** — the offending passages excised, the Talmud itself spared — with the *Extractiones de Talmud* commissioned as the official digest. Later burnings stand on record: 1248, 1309, 1319, 1321; Rome 1553; and the last public Talmud burning in Polish history, in 1757. The king's own character is kept with the record: Louis IX — canonized as Saint Louis — held that "*the best way to conduct a disputation with a Jew was to plunge a sword into him*"; and his successor's 1315 readmission charter would still ban the Talmud from the kingdom entirely.

The French crown's treatment of its Jews across the same centuries was not random cruelty but what the record identifies as fiscal predation — a system. The table is the chapter's own:

Date	Monarch	Mechanism
1182	Philip II Augustus	Expulsion from the royal domain; confession that debts owed Jews would be forgiven **if the debtors paid the king twenty percent**; synagogues and cemeteries seized; commerce suffered, and a recall followed in **1198**
1254	Louis IX	General expulsion; the stated rationale — "*Let the Jews live from the work of their hands or from trade*" — economically impossible in a world with no land and no guilds for Jews

Date	Monarch	Mechanism
1306	**Philip IV the Fair**	**Single-day nationwide arrest; some 100,000 expelled; all property and outstanding loans seized** to fund the wars against England and Flanders
1315	Louis X	**The readmission as a contract:** 22,500 pounds paid upfront, plus 10,000 a year; the badge; a twelve-year term; the crown reserving the right to expel with one year's notice; **the Talmud banned from return**. William Chester Jordan's count: **only about 30,000 returned — thirty percent of the expelled.** Famine struck the same year; pogroms followed
1322	—	Re-expulsion
1359	—	Readmission
1394	**Charles VI**	**Final expulsion — no Jew legally resident in France until the Revolution**

The status beneath it all was the theory that made the machinery possible: *servi camerae regis* — "servants of the royal chamber." The king owned the Jews, which meant the king could dispose of them; presence was transactional, never a right. The cycle's governing logic is preserved verbatim: "*The repetition itself demonstrates that expulsion functioned as an instrument of government*" — a community expelled for its assets and readmitted for its tax revenue, turning more than once. And the credit-need loop closes the account: the 1315 return came "*purportedly because of the clamor of the common*

people in need of credit"; the 1322 expulsion produced "*in a short time… again a shortage of credit.*" The corpus's closing statistic is kept with its flag: by the end of the Second World War, **Ireland** stood as the only European nation that had never expelled or attempted to eliminate its Jews, subjected them to pogroms, or confined them to ghettos. The century's opening atrocity belongs beside the trial: **Blois, 1171 — the first recorded medieval blood libel in France; thirty-two Jews immolated** — the precedent that would echo to 1490 and beyond, and the first hardening of the enmity rhetoric from "*benign toleration to lambasting attacks.*"

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Chapter 10 — The Traditions

The dossier's living-culture corpus is preserved in Part VI; here it is offered as what it actually is — the family's inheritance in vocabulary form. Start with time. The **week** turns on candles, challah, the slow-cooked Sabbath stew called cholent, and the Saturday-night ceremony of havdalah that closes the day. The **year** carries the gefilte-fish line — sweet in the south, peppered in Litvak kitchens — the apples and honey of the New Year, the kitniyot divide over Passover foods, and the Judeo-Spanish table's macaroni-and-cheese served in the sukkah on Hoshana Rabbah. The **lifecycle** runs from the Shalom Zachar's four reasons for welcoming a newborn (the first the strangest: the baby as mourner for the Torah the angel taught him in the womb) to the circling bride, the yichud that Sephardim called *davar mechoar* — "a repugnant thing" — and the Yemenite bridal chamber that is the canopy's own ancestor.

Around the lifecycle stands the **folk layer**: the Shul Street of the Hrubieszów memory, where thousands pressed their written requests on a visiting rebbe; the Tatar healers of Ansky's questionnaire; the papercut masters from Brody to Podkamen. There is **dress and stone and paper** — the shtreimel's taxonomy mapping dynasties onto geography, its Sigismund legend debunked on record; the vertical Ashkenazi gravestone against the horizontal Sephardi one, its symbol-dictionary of crowns, lions, and the candelabra that marks a woman's grave. There is **sound**: the klezmer kapelye as a family firm, its orchestration timeline doubling as a map of

which empire a town belonged to. And there are **languages** — Judeo-Arabic, which nine in ten Jews spoke around 800 CE and which is now nearly gone; Juhuri, keeping a Semitic sound no neighbor language possesses; and the Krymchak *jönk*, family journals passed from father to eldest son — a record system by another name.

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Chapter 11 — The Sibling Streams: How the Jewish Worlds Treated Each Other

The file's inter-Jewish ledger is held in both directions, and it runs across two thousand years. In the old communities, **Sephardim and Ashkenazim** lived by the Italian rule preserved verbatim in this book: whole communities brought their customs and built their own synagogues; individuals assimilated. Amsterdam's Portuguese Nation kept its dowry-society kinship registry and its inward-facing honor code. **Karaite and Rabbanite** Jews intermarried for centuries — seven Genizah marriage contracts survive with tolerance clauses, a husband's promise "*not to force his wife to sit alongside a Sabbath candle, nor to eat the fat of a rump, nor to profane her festivals*" — until Maimonides' boundary-wall ruling, and the later dissents from Radbaz to Ovadia Yosef. **Hasid and Mitnagid** fought a genuine war — bans, book-burnings, even a state denunciation — and their grandchildren intermarry today.

In modern Israel, the **Ashkenazi–Mizrahi ledger** is kept in numbers: the transit camps' seventy-five to eighty-three percent, the police force's demographic shift, Wadi Salib, the Black Panthers' statistics, and the cabinet's own sentence — "*they would have given them everything, as long as they didn't raise the ethnic problem.*" Eastward, the **rescue missions** carry their double entry: Halévy and Faitlovitch, the Hilfsverein and the Alliance, the Yemenite labor affair and the disguise its emissary wore — genuine rescue and genuine condescension in

the same budget line.

The ledger's structural law, stated once: **the marriage boundary is the load-bearing wall.** Where it stood, relations followed its geometry; where it fell, absorption followed within generations. The Beta Israel case completes the law with its hardest clause: recognition by authority is necessary but not sufficient — the rabbinate said *Jews* in 1975, and the blood bank said otherwise for twenty more years. Both are the record.

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PART IV — THE DEEP PAST

Chapter 12 — The Temple Era: Naming, Genealogy, and the Jesus Question

12.1 The Registry and Its End

The Second Temple ran four registration machines, and this book has met them all in detail. The courses decided when a family served; the firstborn's redemption recorded what a child cost; the theophory — the God carried inside a name — recorded who its people prayed to; and the ossuary was the name's last address. Against those machines the epigraphic census takes everyone's measure: Tal Ilan's 2,509 named men and 317 women, with Shimon, Yosef, and Yehuda at the top and Yehoshua sixth at 101. The corpus teaches one forensic rule above all: the unit is not "Joseph" but *which* Joseph, spelled how, in which register.

And the record holds one named man against Rome's anonymity-machine. **Yehohanan ben Hagkol** was crucified — the nail through his heel is still bent around its olive-wood knot — and his family recovered, named, and buried him. Against the machine, the family won.

The genealogy courts' law outlived the courts themselves: the quiet family as the oral checksum, Ezra's sifted flour, and the presumption that outlived the rolls — "*once a family has become intermingled, they may remain intermingled.*" It is the same presumption under which this book's whole search quietly runs.

12.2 The Jesus Question, Held

The dossier's rule for the hardest subject: every view dated, sourced, and none adopted. The Talmud's censored lines — "*on the eve of Passover they hanged Yeshu… because he practised sorcery and led Israel astray*" — preserved with their censorship table (absent from Bomberg 1520, the name almost obliterated in the Munich manuscript, deleted in Vilna). The Yavneh curse and its dating fight. Maimonides' code entry — "*could there be a greater stumbling block than this?*" — with its eschatological turn, and the page's condemnation at Barcelona, where Nachmanides asked the disputation's ending question: "*If these sages believed in Jesus, how is it that they did not do as Friar Paul?*" The Jewish Christians — Ebionites and Nazarenes, "*they wish to be both Jews and Christians, but they are neither one nor the other*" — and the Jerusalem church's Jewish decades, James the Just observing Torah, and the flight to Pella, whose tradition the file declines to settle: five objections, five counters, three attestations, zero resolution. The parting of the ways as the scholarship's most contested question — Boyarin's heresiology thesis and its translation-error confession kept beside the critiques. And the boundary's modern courtroom: Brother Daniel — the rescuer of Mir who converted, the state's answer, "*as we, the Jews, understand it,*" and the identity card that read "*Nationality: not clear*" — the ancient question, compressed into three words of bureaucratic Hebrew. Which view any particular Goldberg held is a family question this book does not presume to answer.

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Chapter 13 — The Biblical World

Below the Temple lies the whole biblical sequence, and this book keeps every link on its own honest footing — documented, disputed, or flagged as unknown. The monarchies come first: Kurkh's "Ahab the Israelite" of 853 BCE, Tel Dan's "House of David" around 840, and the great united-monarchy debate, with Qeiyafa's radiocarbon on one side and the minimalists' "*stories are not enough*" on the other. Then the falls: 722, with its 27,290 deported and the Nimrud ration lists still feeding "people of Samerina"; 701, with the Lachish reliefs and the Siloam tunnel's diggers recording the moment their two headings met; and 586, whose last letters — "*we cannot see Azekah*" — put Jeremiah's final two fortresses in real time.

Then the return under Cyrus, and a Persian period far more plural than the later memory allowed: Yehud's coins, Gerizim's four hundred thousand sacrificial bones, and Elephantine's temple with its Passover letter and its scholarly cautions intact. Behind every layer stands the Egyptian matrix — the alphabet born in the turquoise mines among Semitic workers, the vizier Aper-el running Lower Egypt under a Semitic name, the two golden ages under Pharaoh and Fatimid, and the Mekhilta's verdict on the whole thirty centuries: "*three times they returned to Egypt, and three times they fell.*"

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PART V — THE METHOD

Chapter 14 — How This Was Done

One hundred sixteen research dives, compiled under a single discipline: **collect clues, do not adopt theories.** Every claim in this book carries a pedigree — academic and official sources, major reference works, institutional records, journalism, and the family's own documents — and every disputed point keeps both sides: the correspondence-authenticity debates, the Khazar hypothesis and its demolition, the Cohen-modal-haplotype arc from media triumph to scholarly revision, the naming legends (the shtreimel's Sigismund story; the Azulai family's excommunication of its own flattering etymology; the Rachel-responsa misprint of 2001). Contradictions are preserved, not averaged: the edict's two July dates, the IRO's two counting methods, the 1897 census's destruction and its surviving shards. Claims of belonging — Karaite, Beta Israel, Bnei Menashe, British Israelism — are graded against a single template: documented history plus matching genetics. And the family at the center is treated as the final authority on itself: the record-hits carry their verification pathways, and the open questions are listed for the family to answer, not for the book to presume.

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APPENDICES

Appendix A — The Master Timeline (abridged)

c. 850 BCE · Cohen branch coalescence (Temple-era Judea) — 1207 BCE · Merneptah's "Israel" — c. 1200 · highlands ethnogenesis — 722 · Samaria falls; 27,290 deported — 701 · Sennacherib at Lachish; the Siloam inscription — 586 · Jerusalem falls; the Lachish letters — 539 · Cyrus; the return — c. 450 · Gerizim's temple; Ezra's census — 167–164 · the Maccabees — 19 BCE · Herod's Temple — 70 · the destruction; Yavneh — c. 200 · the Mishnah — 321 · Cologne's Jews — c. 1000 · Gershom's ordinances; the Rhineland consolidation — 1096 · the First Crusade massacres — 1084/1220 · the Speyer charter; the SHuM ordinances — 1240–42 · the Talmud trial and burning — 1264 · the Kalisz privilege — 1453 · Constantinople; the Ottoman welcome — 1492 · the expulsion from Spain — 1565 · the Shulchan Aruch — 1648–49 · the Khmelnytsky massacres — 1772/1804 · the Hasidic-Mitnagdic war's first bans — **1787 · the Galician surname edict** — 1791 · the Pale of Settlement — 1881–82 · the pogroms and May Laws — 1914–24 · the great emigration — 1925–26 · the Goldbergs and Friedmans born in Illinois — **August 27, 1955 · Shelley Linn Goldberg born, Chicago** — 1976 · Temple Chai founded — **January 3, 1978 · Yehoshua Gadol born, Skokie** — **October 16, 1979 · named in the Torah's first week** — **April 8, 1980 · Batya Gittel born on Passover's last day** — **July 12, 1981 · Rudya Amya born** — January 29, 2011 · Shelley's memorial at Temple Chai — recently · Yehoshua

Gadol's passing, mourned.

Appendix B — The Claim Ledger

Confirmed by primary documents: the family chain (Chapter 3); the grandparents' names; the Hebrew names of both parents and all three children; the congregations, officiants, and dates. **Confirmed by public record with match logic:** Shelley (Munoz) Yanez, 1955–2011. **Held as high-probability hypotheses:** Gittel as the great-grandmother's name; Rudya/Amya as relative-calques; Avraham as a convert's name. **Open:** the great-grandparents' names (1930/1940 census); Shelley's birthplace-of-line (Chicago confirmed); the Linn origin; the family's pre-Illinois origin (the emigrant generation).

Appendix C — The Interview Questions and the Search Queue

Ask the family: Who was Gittel? Who were Rudya and Amya named for? Was Shelley named for a grandmother Shulamit or Salome? Where does Linn come from? Was Jesus Munoz a convert — or did he receive the name Avraham at a naming? **Pull next:** the full Shelley Yanez obituary (parents, siblings, birthplace); the Cook County marriage record (Robert Goldberg ↔ Beverly Friedman, ~1950–54); the 1930 and 1940 censuses (Robert, b. ~1927, IL — his parents, the great-grandparents); Beverly Friedman's parents (the Friedman line, one document deep); obituaries and Chicago Jewish cemetery records.

Appendix D — Source Pedigrees

Throughout, the dossier's tags are preserved: [S] academic and official; [A] major reference; [O] institutional; [J] journalism; [B] public record; [C] secondary compilation; [F] family documents; [D] disputed — claim, not adopted. The complete annotated dive archive — all one hundred sixteen dives, with their full citations — stands behind this book as its working papers.

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PART VI — THE FULL RECORD

The expanded chapters. Where Part I–V carry the narrative, this Part carries everything: every table, every preserved quotation, every dispute, every flag. Nothing in the working papers is left behind.

What this chapter holds, and why it belongs to this family: thirty centuries of Jewish life in Egypt — from the alphabet's birth among Semitic miners, through a Semitic-named vizier running Lower Egypt, through Alexandria's greatness and its annihilation, to the merchant network whose letters reached Kiev by 950 and India by the 1130s. It matters here for one reason above all: **Egypt is the world the Bible says the family left, and the world its archive says they never fully left** — the thread runs from the turquoise mines to the Genizah, and the Mekhilta's verdict on it ("three times they returned, and three times they fell") is the tradition's own summary. Terms to carry: *genizah* — the attic where worn sacred papers were retired, and which thereby preserved a civilization's paperwork; *politeuma* — the Jews' semi-autonomous corporate body under the Ptolemies; *dhimmi* — a non-Muslim community under Islamic protection and restriction.

VI.1 The Egyptian Matrix

The Alphabet Born in the Mines

The oldest alphabetic writing in human history was created by Semitic workers in Egyptian service. At **Serabit el-Khadim**, the Sinai turquoise mines, **thirty to forty inscriptions** in what is now called **Proto-Sinaitic** script were first recognized by Petrie in 1905; at **Wadi el-Hol**, near the Nile in Egypt proper, two inscriptions discovered in 1994–95 are the oldest exemplars known; a further find at **Timna** extends the map. The dating fight is preserved in full: an **early date c. 1850 BCE** against a **late date c. 1550 BCE** — and the corpus's own warning that the choice "*decides whether it is proto-Sinaitic or proto-Canaanite, and by extension locates the invention of the alphabet in Egypt or Canaan respectively.*"

The mechanism was the **acrophonic principle**: Egyptian hieroglyphs repurposed for Semitic consonants by their initial sounds — **ox head → ʾalp → aleph; house plan → bēt → bet; water → mēm → mem; head → raʾš → resh.** Two dozen signs did the work of hieroglyphy's hundreds. The inscriptions are short votive dedications to **Ba'alat — "the Lady,"** the Canaanite title syncretized with Hathor, "Lady of Turquoise"; personal names show hybrid theology (**Ba'al-Seth**); one 2025 study proposes biblical-name readings — flagged as controversial, unadopted. The invention debate is held open: **Goldwasser's** illiterate-workers theory, **Na'aman's** imperial-scribes alternative, and the mining-scholars' dissent.

The consensus core: Semitic speakers in the Egypt–Levant corridor created the ancestor of Phoenician, Hebrew, Greek, Latin, Arabic, and Cyrillic.

The Asiatic Presence and the Labor Record

The traffic into Egypt was ancient and documented: Middle Kingdom texts record Asiatics (ʿ*aamu*) in varied occupations, sometimes taking Egyptian names while keeping the "Asiatic" designation; **Amenemhat II's inscription lists 1,554 Asiatic captives** from one Lebanese campaign; the Beni Hasan tomb painting (19th c. BCE) shows Semitic traders entering with donkeys and goods. The labor record corroborates the biblical environment: the vizier **Rekhmire** (c. 1470–1445 BCE) depicts Nubian *and Asiatic* slaves making bricks under rod-wielding overseers; a Louvre leather scroll sets **brick quotas**; the Papyri Anastasi IV–V stress **straw's scarcity** — the Exodus 5 logic; but the archaeologists' nuance is kept: period bricks typically *do* contain chaff, so the narrative reflects quota intensification rather than literal strawlessness. **Leiden Papyrus 348** records rations to the ʿ**Apiru** transporting stones for Ramesses — the Habiru of the Amarna-era correspondence, whose possible equation with the Hebrews remains explicitly disputed.

The **Brooklyn Papyrus** (c. 1740 BCE; 95 servants of the noblewoman Senebtisi, 30–40 Northwest Semitic names) is read three ways in the file: the apologetic claim of ten "specifically Hebrew" names (Menahema, Ashera, Shiphrah, ʿAqoba, ʿAyyabum, Dawidi-huat...) is graded "*apologetic*

embellishment, not rigorous scholarship" — Hayes, Albright, Hoffmeier, and Kitchen all say "Asiatics" and "Semites" — while **Hoffmeier's middle position** stands: "*ample documentation during the Middle Kingdom of a significant Semitic-speaking population in Egypt,*" and "*a brisk trade in Asiatic slaves carried on by the Asiatics themselves, with Egypt — not unlike that reported in Genesis 37:28, 36.*"

Aper-el — the Semitic-Name Vizier

At the summit of the documented ladder stands **Aper-el** — the Egyptian writing of the Semitic ʿ**Abdiel, "servant of El"** — Vizier of the North under **Amenhotep III and Akhenaten**. His titles (preserved from the cubit rod and tomb at Saqqara, excavated by Zivie from 1976, burial chamber reached 1987): **"Chief of the City and Vizier," "Father of the God"** — the intimate title implying he helped educate the royal children — **"Commander of Chariots,"** and under Akhenaten **"First Servant of Aten."** His family was buried with him: his wife Taweret (the only New Kingdom woman known buried in three coffins) and their son Huy, whose wine dockets date to Akhenaten's year 10. His sons held the steward's office, the priesthood of Nefertem, and the chariot command — a Semitic-named family across Egypt's civil, military, and religious elite. The two cautions are kept: his burial was thoroughly Egyptian, and "*Semitic names were sometimes used by Egyptians*" — the name is a lead, not a proof; the fringe identification with Joseph is dismissed, while the speculation about influence on Atenism is preserved as speculation. Roughly a quarter of all "royal butlers" of the Ramesside period bore foreign-sounding names.

The Hyksos and the Memory of Departure

The Hyksos interlude (15th dynasty, mid-17th c. BCE) supplies the deepest candidate for the Exodus memory: the Theban war of expulsion — **Seqenenre Taa's mummy, forensically, died of West Asian-style axe wounds**; Kamose's stelae vilify; Ahmose's Autobiography claims Avaris's destruction. But the archaeological correction is preserved verbatim: "*No solid evidence supports such destruction. Instead, archaeological material at Tell el Dab'a indicates a West Asian population continued to live there into the New Kingdom, raising questions about how many people were actually expelled.*" Later Egyptian texts kept vilifying the Hyksos (Hatshepsut's Speos Artemidos inscription) — propaganda serving new regimes. The file's standing line: the Egyptian matrix is real, quantified, and continuous from the Middle Kingdom through Ramesses — Semites in Egypt in every status from the mine-shaft to the vizierate; whether any were *Israelites*, and whether any departure became the Exodus, remains where the archaeology leaves it: **memory undischarged by a single event; environment fully corroborated; mass exodus unevidenced.**

Alexandria

The greatest Jewish city of the ancient world began with the Ptolemies' invitation and the **politeuma** institution — a semi-autonomous corporate body with its own ethnarch and courts (Gambetti's reading ties its remit to its garrison origins). It produced the **Septuagint** (Alexandria, c. 250 BCE — the legend of the seventy-two elders kept as legend, the kernel as fact — the legend itself is the **Letter of Aristeas** (c. 150–100 BCE): seventy-two elders, six per tribe, identical translations in seventy-two days; the library's agents seizing books from docked ships; the apologetic purpose — legitimating the Greek Torah as divinely sanctioned. Modern scholars keep the kernel, drop the legend, with the preserved quip that identical independent translations is the monkeys-and-typewriters miracle story; *ʿalmâ* rendered *parthenos*, the oldest translation debate in the world; by the 2nd century CE the Church had adopted the LXX and the synagogues reverted to Hebrew, Aquila retranslating toward the proto-Masoretic text), **Philo**, and **Ben Sira's grandson** translating his grandfather into Greek.

The **pogrom of 38 CE**, preserved in Philo's own words: Flaccus, having backed the wrong man at Caligula's accession, contracted with the Alexandrian elites; the Greeks staged the **Carabas parody** — a madman crowned and hailed with the Syrian word for king; Flaccus ordered **Caligula's statues placed inside the synagogues**; the synagogues were destroyed, "*not even their names remaining*"; the Jews were

declared ***xenoi kai epēlydes*** — foreigners and aliens — herded from four of the city's five quarters into one, where artificial famine killed heaps of the trapped; **thirty-eight elders of the Council scourged in the theater**; women seized and **forced to eat pork**, the resolute handed to torturers; families burned alive; corpses dragged through the lanes until "*skin, flesh, and muscles shattered by the unevenness and roughness of the ground.*" Philo's embassy reached Caligula; the emperor's assassination and Claudius's letter (papyrus P. Lond. 1912) saved the community; Flaccus was recalled, exiled, executed. The corpus calls it "*the earliest pogrom we know of*" — with Gambetti's caution against the anachronistic term. Philo was "*the last great Greek-Jewish writer of Egypt; the literary fusion of Hellenism and Judaism comes to an abrupt halt at this point.*"

The annihilation of **115–117 CE**: the Diaspora Revolt rose in Cyrenaica, Egypt, and Cyprus under Lukuas/Andreas; the rebels destroyed the civic symbols of their oppression; **Dio's 240,000 dead on Cyprus** preserved with the atrocity-topoi caution (Ben-Zeev's demolition); Trajan resolved — per **Arrian** — "*to destroy the nation entirely, but if not, at least to crush it*"; **Marcius Turbo's** mission "*included not only quelling the revolt but also exterminating Jews*"; the mid-2nd-century Fayum tax lists show **one Jew among a thousand adult males**; the Great Synagogue was destroyed; on Cyprus, "*no Jew may set foot on that island, and even if one is driven upon the shores by a storm he is put to death*" (Dio) — archaeologically corroborated. The tradition's verdict is preserved (Mekhilta, in

bar Yochai's name): "*In three places God warned Israel not to return to Egypt… three times they returned, and three times they fell. The third was in the days of Trajan.*" The shrunken remainder: 60 families in 1481, 25 in 1488, Napoleon's destruction of the ancient synagogue, 24,690 in 1937, expulsions in 1948–67, **twelve Jews in 2017**, and 180 visitors at the renovated Eliyahu Hanavi in February 2020.

Elephantine — the Other Fifth Century

On the Nile island of Yeb (Aswan), a **Jewish military garrison** held imperial letters from **495 to 399 BCE** — founded perhaps by Judean mercenaries of the late 7th/early 6th century, under Manasseh/Josiah. Their **temple to Yahu predated the Persian conquest of Egypt (525 BCE)** — a functioning sanctuary with animal sacrifice, outside Jerusalem, in living defiance of Deuteronomy's centralization. In **410 BCE** Egyptians instigated by the priests of Khnum destroyed it; the community petitioned **Bagohi, governor of Judah, and Delaiah and Shelemiah — sons of Sanballat** (the Nehemiah-era name preserved in a second biblical echo). Jerusalem's reply: rebuild — but **animal sacrifice will not be permitted** (TAD A4.9).

The **"Passover Letter"** (419 BCE) is kept with its full caution: Hananiah writes to Yedaniah — days 15–21 of Nisan, purity, no work, no leaven, seal it up — but **Kuhrt's caveat** stands verbatim: the word *psḥ* (Passover) "*is nowhere on the surviving fragment*"; the royal-decree reconstruction "*rests on restoration*"; and **Barnea (2024)** pushes further: even the

festival's identity is under re-examination. The syncretism ledger is kept unsentimental: the collection account divides among **YHW, Eshem-Bethel, and Anath-Bethel**; a curse tablet invokes "*Yahu the lion*"; the temple kept a **fire altar** (Zoroastrian form); Hananiah blesses by "*the gods*" — plural. "*The Judaism of the Persian period was still very different from the religion we know today.*" And the **women's archives** (Mibtahiah, 471–410; Anani, 449–402): marriage contracts with reciprocal divorce clauses, property, manumission, the Sati-oath — legal standing the biblical texts do not attest.

The Oniad Temple at Leontopolis

When the Hasmoneans seized the high priesthood, the Zadokite heir **Onias IV** was in Egypt by September 164 BCE; with **Ptolemy VI's** permission he built a temple at **Leontopolis** (modern Tell el-Yahudiya) — "*comparatively small, but modeled on the Second Temple*" — functioning for roughly 230 years. **Josephus and the Mishnah** (Menahot 13:10) rule it a betrayal — and then concede, in the same breath, that offerings made there are *valid*, if the donor's intent was right: the strangest half-acceptance in the corpus. **Vespasian ordered it destroyed in 73 CE**, "*because of its symbolic potency.*" The file's synthesis: four Yahwistic sanctuaries ran in parallel — Elephantine, Gerizim, Jerusalem, Leontopolis — and the centralized, Jerusalem-only memory the later world inherited was the survivor's account.

The Fatimid Jewish Century and the Trade Network

Under the Fatimids (969–1171), the India trade diverted to the Red Sea, "*neither monopolies nor harassment of small merchants*" — and Jewish merchants of every wealth participated. **Ya'qub ibn Killis** (born Baghdad 930, of a Jewish family; converted 967 after Kafur's remark that "*if Ibn Killis were a Muslim, he would be the right man to become vizier*"; vizier to al-Aziz from 977; the currency reform, the administrative reorganization, al-Azhar's scholarly turn; at his death in 991 the caliph led the funeral prayer and a hundred poets wrote elegies) embodies the ceiling and its price: "*Dhimmis were precluded from the very highest Fatimid offices… several nominally converted Jews became viziers.*" The **Tustari brothers** — possibly Karaites, murdered by Turkish soldiers in 1047; the convert Sadaqa al-Fallahi, vizier on their connections, killed 1048; **Abu al-Munajja Sha'ya**, whose canal still bears his name. The ***nagid*** succession preserved: Paltiel of Oria (per Lewis's identification) → Judah b. Saadiah (1065–79) → Mevorakh (1079–1110) → Samuel b. Hananiah — court physicians holding the community's headship, with **Goitein's dissent** (the office developed independently of caliphal policy) kept alongside.

The merchant machine behind the Genizah: **Nahray b. Nissim** (c. 1025–1098), descended from a Qayrawan *nagid*, with an archive of **500+ letters, notes, legal documents, and accounts** — the Egypt–Ifrīqiyya–Sicily triangle; titles from *both* the Palestinian and Babylonian academies. **Ibn ʿAwkal**,

the "merchant prince," stationary at the center of a web run through **family agents** — the Alexandria agent the nephew of the Tunisian agent — the small-world contract-governance structure. And the reach, in two documents: the **Kyiv petition of c. 950** — a Hebrew appeal to wealthy Fustat from a Jewish community *apparently in Kyiv*, whose member had been robbed and murdered — the network touching Kiev three centuries before the Piast charters; and the **1050 ransom letter** (T-S 12.338): three Jewish traders held by pirates, ransomed by Italian merchants, Nahray asked to settle the bill — "*piracy made the network's members commodities; the network's ransoming made them people again.*" The **ibn Yijū** misidentification correction is kept: an Indian Ocean letter long attributed to Nahray was a different master's mail — even the experts' attributions drift; every document keeps its citation as its identity.

The Genizah Itself

1896: the Scottish twin sisters **Agnes Lewis and Margaret Gibson** return from Egypt with fragments; one scrap, "*as if a grocer had used it for something greasy,*" goes to **Solomon Schechter**, who recognizes the **long-lost Hebrew Ben Sira**, known for a millennium only in Greek. He races to Cairo; the Ben Ezra Synagogue's attic yields; **193,000–300,000 fragments** reach Cambridge (the Taylor-Schechter Collection, 1898); the total corpus approaches **400,000 fragments**, spanning the 9th–19th centuries. The contents: marriage contracts, wills, shop inventories, court depositions, business receipts, medical prescriptions, poetry, love letters, *wives' complaints about their husbands*, lists of jewelry; autograph correspondence of Maimonides and Judah ha-Levi. Schechter's humility preserved verbatim: "*I should like at once to correct a mistake… in which I am described as the discoverer of the Genizah. This is not correct. The Genizah practically discovered itself.*" And the bridge to Qumran: among his finds, two copies of a work he called "*Fragments of a Zadokite Work*" — fifty years later, **eight copies of the same Damascus Document turned up at Qumran, a thousand years older.** The Genizah copy had carried a Second Temple text across the entire medieval millennium.

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What this chapter holds: the complete scientific file on where the Ashkenazim came from — the two rival hypotheses

and their dispute map, the medieval DNA from Erfurt, the priestly and maternal lineages, the disease-mutation record, and the founding families of the Rhineland. It matters because **every answer the genetics gives lands on dates and places this family's paper trail also touches** — the founder population's window (c. 1200–1400) is the same eastward consolidation the charters record. Terms to carry: *haplogroup* (a deep lineage family), *founder event* (descent from a few dozen founders), *theophory* (a name carrying God inside it), *minhag* (custom as law). The chapter's rule of reading: where scientists fight — and they do here — the book holds both sides and adopts neither.

VI.2 The Origin Question in Full

Rhineland versus Khazar — the Complete Dispute Map

Every account of where the Ashkenazim came from must first answer the challenge that has shadowed the question for a century: the Khazar hypothesis, which holds that a substantial part of European Jewry descends from the Turkic Khazars — a steppe confederation between the Black and Caspian Seas whose ruling class converted to Judaism in the eighth or ninth century, and whose empire collapsed around 969 when Sviatoslav of Kiev sacked its capital, Itil. The story has been told and retold — by Arthur Koestler in *The Thirteenth Tribe* (1976), by the geneticist Eran Elhaik in 2012 and 2013 — and it has a genuine documentary root: the **Khazar Correspondence**, the exchange of letters between Hasdai ibn Shaprut, the Jewish foreign secretary at the court of Córdoba, and King Joseph of the Khazars, copied in the 950s. The correspondence's authenticity is now mainstream — Zuckerman: "*No one contests any more that the two preserved versions go back to an authentic tenth-century document*"; Golden: Dunlop and Golb demonstrated authenticity; Wasserstein (2025): "now accepted as genuine" — with **Shaul Stampfer's dissent** preserved verbatim (literary Hebrew with Arabic touches; chronology "*hundreds of years off*"; borders far from contemporaneous reality; Córdoba awash in forgeries). The book's rule holds both layers: authenticity of the

documents is one question; reliability of the *conversion narrative inside them* is another.

The genetic verdict, when it came, was the work of the largest collaboration the field had assembled: **Behar et al. 2013 — thirty geneticists, thirteen universities, nine countries** — finding "*no indication of a significant genetic contribution either from within or from north of the Caucasus region.*" The most instructive single episode is the Levite saga: in 2003, a study found the steppe-associated Y-haplogroup R1a1a in over half of Ashkenazi Levites — a frequency that made a Khazar reading plausible, and the geneticist David Goldstein called it "*plausible, if not likely.*" The follow-up, Rootsi, Behar and colleagues in 2013, typed the lineage properly: it is **R1a-M582 — Near Eastern in origin, with both European and Khazarian origins formally excluded** (significant frequencies among Iranian Kerman, Iranian Azeris, and Cilician Kurds; absent from Europeans and Khazar-region samples). The honest residue is kept with precision: even on the most favorable reading of the original 2003 data, a Khazar contribution was "*limited to a single founder or a few closely related men, and does not exceed ~12 percent*"; Atzmon allows some post-100 CE admixture "not excluded"; and with **no Khazar ancient DNA** yet recovered, total exclusion is not logically available. The strictest honest formulation, preserved: *no significant contribution* is the finding; zero is not provable.

The Elhaik line — the 2012/2013 papers claiming Caucasus support using Georgians and Armenians as proxies, and the 2016 extension with Das and Wexler proposing that Yiddish

was born in four northeastern Turkish "Ashkenaz"-named villages — carries its demolition record with it, as this book's rule requires: Hammer ("unrealistic"; "outlier folks"); Feldman ("a one-off"); Stampfer ("basically nonsense"); Flegontov (the Geographic Population Structure tool invalid for 1,000-year-old admixture events; the "Slavo-Iranian confederation" a meaningless invention); Beider ("speculative or simply wrong… cannot be taken seriously"). The usage ledger is kept as strictly as the science: Koestler's original purpose was anti-antisemitic — if the Jews were not Semites, "the Jews killed Christ" would die — while the theory's modern circulation is dominated by delegitimization uses, documented by the ADL. The dossier holds the claim, the refutations, and the rhetorical history in three separate compartments.

The Founder Event, Measured

The genetics of the founder event are now anchored to a specific cemetery. Erfurt, in Thuringia, held a Jewish community from the late eleventh century until its expulsion in 1454; the survivors of the 1349 massacre returned within five years, and when the community was finally driven out, the cemetery was built over — first a barn, then a granary. In 2013, rescue excavations during the granary's conversion to a parking garage uncovered forty-seven burials, a fraction of the cemetery; in 2021, all the skeletons were reburied with the approval of the Jewish community of Thuringia. The team — working under an ethics protocol that is now the field's template, using only detached teeth from the already-excavated remains — produced the study published as **Waldman et al., *Cell*, 2022**.

The findings, complete: the thirty-three genotyped individuals, all from the fourteenth century (the excavated sector used by the *second*, post-1349 community), fell into **two distinct subgroups** — one with greater Middle Eastern affinity (labeled Erfurt-ME), one with greater Eastern European affinity (Erfurt-EU) — with no grave-location correlation between them: the two groups were *not* culturally or temporally segregated. The bottleneck model that best fit the data placed its onset **forty-six generations ago** (a 95% confidence interval of thirty-six to fifty-eight), with a duration of twenty-two generations; the Erfurt-type group passed through a bottleneck of effective size **roughly six hundred**

twenty-seven individuals — contributing about fifty-two percent of the modern Ashkenazi gene pool — while a second group merged at the bottleneck's end. **Eight of the thirty-three carried pathogenic variants** that define the modern Ashkenazi carrier-screening panel: the disease mutations were already there, in the founding population, a direct match to the mutation-archaeology record. One-third of the individuals descended maternally from a single woman. The endogamy was quantified: Erfurt and modern Ashkenazim form a clade against non-Jewish Europeans, with maximal East-European admixture into Ashkenazim since the fourteenth century of **two to four percent** — essentially closed.

And the headline conclusion: "*the founder event and the acquisition of the main sources of ancestry pre-dated the 14th century.*" The bottleneck predates Erfurt; Erfurt's diversity (lost since) shows medieval Ashkenazim were more heterogeneous than their descendants.

The Carmel et al. estimate (2020, held pending its primary source) fits the same window: a founder population of a few dozen, six to eight hundred years ago. And the file's synthesis, stated once and carefully: the *communities* are tenth-century; the *name* is eleventh; the *identity* is twelfth; the *people* — the ethnos the genes, the rite, and the Yiddish all record — closes into its founder population between roughly 1200 and 1400, between the Rhine and the Vistula, in the world the Kalisz privilege built.

The Mutation Archaeology and the Tay-Sachs Verdict

The founder event left its signature in the genome's disease record, and the catalog reads like an archaeology of the persecutions themselves. The tally (Israeli National Genetic Database plus gnomAD integration, 2017): **168 presumed founder mutations across 128 genes**, with multiple founder mutations in 27 of them — the lysosomal cluster (Tay-Sachs, Niemann-Pick, mucolipidosis IV, Gaucher) the classic case, where more than one founder per disease is the rule. The historical-reading rule is preserved verbatim: coalescence times of founder mutations "*correspond well with historical migrations or episodes of extreme persecution*" — the mutation spectrum is itself a stratigraphy of 1096, 1348, 1648, 1881. Tay-Sachs is the case study, and the four theories stand with their verdicts: the carrier frequency among Ashkenazim is roughly **one in twenty-seven** (against about one in three hundred in the general population); three alleles account for **ninety-nine percent** of Ashkenazi mutations; the four theories — founder effect and drift (**the emerging consensus**; drift models reproduce the frequencies without selection); TB-resistance heterozygote advantage (1966–87, "*at best consistent with*"); reproductive compensation (documented, secondary); and the intelligence-selection hypothesis (the Cochran–Harpending proposal, with the Gaucher-patients-among-engineers datapoint) — **preserved as a contested claim [D]** with its documented misuse history.

The carrier statistics carry their own caution: a Goldberg family testing autosomally will typically show zero to two variants — the normal signature of descent from the founder population, not evidence of recent inbreeding in the family line.

The Cohen Modal Haplotype — the Full Arc

The priestly genetic question has run a three-decade arc from media triumph to scholarly revision, and the file holds every stage. The 1997 study — **Skorecki et al., *Nature*** — compared Y-chromosome markers in Jewish men who identified as kohanim and found **98.5 percent of them sharing one of two closely related haplotypes** (carried by 13.1 percent of kohanim against 4.3 percent of non-kohanim): the birth of "Y-chromosomal Aaron," and the media read it as science confirming the Bible. The underreported numbers travel with the story: only **forty-eight percent of Ashkenazi and fifty-eight percent of Sephardi kohanim** actually carry the J1 CMH; some five to eight percent of non-kohanim Jews carry it; and **Yemenite Jews carry it at over sixty-seven percent** — higher than non-priestly Jews anywhere. The 1998 expansion (Thomas et al.) typed six markers, found the modal pattern in 97 of 106 kohanim, and dated the coalescence to **three thousand years before present** — "consistent with" the Aaron tradition.

The 2009 revision by Hammer's own team changed the picture's frame: **twenty of twenty-one Cohen haplogroup clusters share no single young haplogroup**; the extended CMH was absent among non-Jews in the study; the divergence

estimate stood at **three thousand years, plus or minus a thousand**; and the authors claimed the extended CMH "*represents a unique founding lineage of the ancient Hebrews that has been paternally inherited along with the Jewish priesthood*" — a finding for *a* Temple-era priestly lineage, explicitly not for "every kohen descends from Aaron." The critiques are kept: **Tofanelli et al. (2014)** — the priestly STR motifs are "*not identical by descent,*" arising independently across lineages through multiple founder events, recombination, and admixture; and Weitzman's retrospective: "*the conclusions reached by the Cohen study haven't held up so well… even the authors of the original study have significantly revised their conclusions.*"

The 2025 whole-Y resequencing rebuilt the map from first principles: **104 new Big Y-700 sequences plus 215 re-typed legacy samples, Cohanim from twenty diaspora origins**, with a branch qualifying as Cohen (CB) only if at least five men carried it and at least half self-identified as Cohanim. The result: **nine Cohen branches. CB-01** — the old "Cohen Modal Haplotype," now J-Z18271 — is the largest (**roughly forty-five percent of all Cohanim sampled**), the most ancient (coalescence **around 850 BCE**), and "*the only lineage present in every major Jewish community*"; its internal topology tells the demographic story — **explosive branching between 700 and 300 BCE, stasis through the Roman-Byzantine era, renewed expansion after 800 CE** — "*mirroring known demographic pulses.*" CB-02 (~700 BCE) and CB-03 (~550 BCE) carry Iron Age dates; CB-02 uniquely bridges Bukharian,

Yemenite, Turkish, Syrian, and Egyptian Jews. CB-04 through CB-07 are Near Eastern clades whose priestly status "*may have crystallized 0–1000 CE*" — CB-04 and CB-07 preponderant among Iranian and Afghan Jews, with the Persian-Jewish lore of priestly status adopted after genealogic Cohanim went extinct (the Samaritan Cohen-line extinction of the 17th century given as the type case). CB-05, CB-08, and CB-09 "*appear to derive from Mediterranean host populations*" — possible introgression in the classical-era diaspora.

The authors' origin verdict on CB-01, preserved in spirit: the parsimonious explanation points to a common ancestor around 850 BCE in "*an Iron Age Near Eastern population that contributed ancestrally to all major Jewish Diaspora communities… the only population that fits this description is that of monarchic period (First Temple period) Israel and Judah*." And the honesty clauses kept with it: Jewish law admits no route to priestly status except descent — but status could historically have been *adopted out of necessity, fabricated, or entered via non-paternity events*; **twenty percent of sampled Cohanim fall outside any current CB branch.** "Descent from Aaron" as a specific individual remains tradition, not genetics — and the old twelve-marker "extended CMH" is CB-01/J-Z18271; Tofanelli's critique is vindicated in kind: there are nine Cohen branches, not one Aaron.

The Maternal-Line Fight

The deepest live dispute in the field is the one this book holds most carefully, because its two sides are both peer-reviewed and both recent. Behar's 2006 study established the frame: roughly **forty percent of Ashkenazi mitochondrial DNA descends from four major founder lineages — K1a1b1a, K1a9, K2a2a1, and N1b2** — within a founding generation estimated at about a hundred fifty families, of whose original maternal signatures only about a third survived. Behar read the four founders as Near Eastern. **Costa et al. 2013 (*Nature Communications*)** answered with a broader net: all four major founders, on complete mitochondrial sequences, carried **prehistoric European ancestry**; **at least eighty percent of Ashkenazi maternal lineages had assimilated within Europe** — mostly west and Mediterranean Europe, around two thousand years ago or slightly earlier; the great majority of *minor* lineages also predominantly European; and, explicitly: *no lineages from the North Caucasus* — "not recruited in the Caucasus," per Richards. The model: conversion of European women in the formation of Ashkenazi communities, fitting the autosomal picture (the close relationship of Ashkenazim and Italians).

Livni and Skorecki 2025 — the newest word, in *Human Genetics* — answered with a methodological innovation: a way to distinguish *founder* lineages from *absorbed* ones (founders appear in multiple copies within the population; absorbed lineages appear as singletons). Their findings: **less than**

fifteen percent of today's Ashkenazi Jews carry absorbed (post-founding) European mtDNA; roughly **fifty-four founder matrilineal lineages** identified; and — decisively — the mathematical expectation (Galton–Watson extinction models run from a hundred fifty founding women over fifteen endogamous generations) **reproduces the four-major-lineage dominance without any European-mothers requirement at all.** The major founders' absence from non-Jewish European databases supports a non-European source. Their conclusion, preserved: "*both maternal and paternal founders were predominantly Near Eastern — the 'European mothers' model is challenged.*" The dossier holds 2013 and 2025 side by side, unsynthesized — an active peer-reviewed dispute — and notes what the family can do about it: the wife's eventual mtDNA test lands inside exactly this scientific fight, placing her line among the four major founders or the minors.

Rome, the Rhineland, and the Founding Families

The deepest physical evidence of the European beginning is Roman. The Jewish community of Rome is continuous from at least the second century BCE — the Maccabean-embassy tradition records Jews already in the city when Judean envoys arrived; Pompey's Judean campaign of 63 BCE brought captives; by 19 CE the community was large enough for Tiberius to deport four thousand of its members to Sardinia. The imperial-era tradition counted **as many as twelve synagogues** in the city. The catacomb corpus — six known Jewish complexes (Villa Torlonia, Vigna Randanini, Monteverde, and others) — holds **some one hundred thousand graves and roughly six hundred inscriptions, the largest collection of archaeological evidence from any early European Jewish community**; the inscriptions run predominantly Greek and Latin with Hebrew formulae, and the wall art carries the menorah, the Torah ark, the shofar, and the etrog in ordinary Roman decorative vocabulary. The **Villa Torlonia revolution** (Rutgers et al., *Nature*, 2005) dated the complex's construction by radiocarbon on charcoal sealed in the lime mortar: **50 BCE to 400 CE**, with the catacomb in use by the late second century, possibly the first — **a century before the earliest Christian catacombs.** Rutgers's contested inference is preserved as claim, not finding: the burial practice itself *may* have originated with Jews and been adopted by Christians ("not all scholars are convinced").

No ancient DNA from the site has been published in the sources this book holds; a reported Roman-Jewish ancient-DNA study is flagged pending primary-source verification.

North of the Alps, the documentary dawn is a single decree. In **321 CE**, Constantine — the first Christian emperor, and thus an unlikely patron — issued an order preserved in the *Codex Theodosianus*: "*We allow all town councils to appoint through general law Jewish people in the Curia…*" — permission to appoint Jews to Cologne's city senate. It is **the oldest written evidence of a Jewish community north of the Alps**, and Germany commemorated its seventeen hundredth anniversary in 2021. The reading rule preserved: an imperial law addresses an *established* community — "a community large enough to be addressed in imperial law was already established" — and Cologne's Jews were prosperous enough for curial service, an onerous financial honor. A second edict, of 341, records the synagogue's imperial privilege. The continuity question — between this Roman layer and the eleventh-century sources — is kept open per the file's rule: Cologne's archives were destroyed in 881; Gregory of Tours writes only of Gaul; but the modern **MiQua excavations** beneath the old quarter — synagogue foundations, houses, and a mikveh descending some fifteen meters to the Rhine's groundwater — argue for continuous presence, and the synthesis literature now leans that way. The medieval layer atop the Roman one completes the picture: the first-half-eleventh-century synagogue (the oldest north of the Alps); the 1096 massacre; the community's later trajectory is Dive 1's road east.

The Rhine corridor — Cologne to Mainz to Speyer and Worms — is thus one documented axis of Jewish presence running **from 321 CE to the surname era: some eleven hundred and fifty years.**

The word "Ashkenaz" itself has a documented biography, and the file keeps every rung of its ladder. The name begins in Genesis 10:3 — a grandson of Noah through Japheth, paired in Jeremiah 51:27 with a kingdom summoned against Babylon; philologically it is the Hebrew rendering of the Scythians, the Iranian-speaking steppe people the Assyrians called *Aškūza*. The Talmud reassigned it: needing a post-biblical identity for Gomer, the rabbis matched it phonetically to "Germamya" (Babylonian Talmud, Yoma 10a), and by the eleventh century the reassignment was complete — Rashi renders German expressions as *leshon Ashkenaz* in his commentaries, and "But in Ashkenaz I saw…" (Ketubot 77b) means, in his own world, Mainz and Worms. The adoption's rungs, preserved: **Hai Gaon (d. 1038) answers questions "from Ashkenaz" — meaning Germany** — while the geography itself is still *Lotharingia* and the Regensburg rabbis are still *Rabbanei Reinus*; **Eliezer ben Nathan, early twelfth century, distinguishes the crusaders as *Zarefatim* (French) and *Ashkenazim* (German)** — the branch naming itself by contrast; **letters from Byzantine and Syrian Jewish communities during the First Crusade refer to the crusaders as "Ashkenazim"** — the name traveling east with the news of the massacres; the **Mahzor Vitry** speaks of the "kingdom of Ashkenaz"; the thirteenth-century codifiers use it as standard; and **Elia Baxur,**

sixteenth century, records the first known discussion of the origin of German Jews and Yiddish — three centuries after the name settled.

Shadal's dissent (the biblical Ashkenaz has nothing to do with Germany; the usage a borrowed reassignment) is kept beside the consensus.

The founding families are headed by the dynasty whose own paper trail is the settlement's best documentation. The **Kalonymos** family — traces in Lucca, Italy, from the second half of the eighth century; family tradition claims descent from Judeans who fled the destruction of 70 CE (kept as oral tradition, uncorroborated); the name Greek (*kalonymos*, "good name" — Hebrew *Shem-Ṭov*). The migration date is a three-way scholarly dispute, preserved: **876** (Rapoport, Zunz — the king Charles the Bald, in Italy that year); **c. 800** (Luzzatto — Charlemagne, a scholar-attraction motive "more in keeping with the character of that monarch"); or **Otto II (973–983)** — per Thietmar of Merseburg, whose chronicle records a Jew named Kalonymus saving the emperor's life in battle. The Hasidic tradition says 849; Grossman's *Early Sages of Ashkenaz* is the modern reference. The main line settled in **Mainz around 917** (the year "not completely reliable"; the community indisputable from the mid-tenth century). The esoteric bridge is the item that ties the whole file together: **Meshullam the Great's grandfather, Moses the Elder, received esoteric instruction from Abu Aaron of Baghdad** — the Babylonian academies' mystical line carried into Lucca and then the Rhineland: Dive 41's Baghdad → Dive 69's Italy →

Dive 30's Mainz, one genealogy.

And the members, in order: **Meshullam ben Kalonymos the Great (930–1005)** — responsa from Jewish settlements in Christian Europe *and the Byzantine Empire*, "a valuable historical source"; the **first documented European reference to *ma'arufya*** — informal Jewish commercial arbitration; his *Ammiẓ Ko'aḥ* in the Ashkenazi Yom Kippur Avodah to this day; a tombstone in Mainz; Rashi cites him approvingly. **Kalonymos ben Judah ha-Baḥur**, the Mainz paytan of 1096, wrote the persecutions into liturgical poems. **Kalonymos ben Meshullam ha-Parnas** — leader of Mainz in 1096, "*martyred with his whole community.*" **Kalonymos ben Isaac ha-Zaken** — founder of the German branch; his son **Samuel ben Kalonymos he-Ḥasid** — founder of **Hasidei Ashkenaz**; Samuel's son **Judah he-Ḥasid** (d. 1217), principal redactor of the *Sefer Ḥasidim*; and **Eleazar of Worms** (d. c. 1230), the *Rokeaḥ* — the Pietist current of Dive 67 is a family tree. The dynasty "produced for nearly five centuries the most notable scholars of Germany and northern France," through three channels of influence: the mystical (Hasidei Ashkenaz), the liturgical (piyyutim shaping the mahzor), and the ethical-communal (*ma'arufya*, communal ethics).

The corroboration layer around them is preserved: Mainz — the Kalonymos move "believed" for 917; **Archbishop Frederick (937–954)** threatening forcible conversion or expulsion; **Emperor Henry II expelling the Mainz Jews in 1012** after a priest's conversion to Judaism — "*soon after (according to Jewish sources, only a month), they were allowed*

to return"; **1084** — Mainz Jews accused in a fire left and founded the Speyer community under Bishop Rüdiger's charter: Dive 30's 1084 now has its human mechanism. The claims ledger, kept with flags: Judean descent after 70 CE (family oral tradition); Davidic descent (Benjamin of Tudela calls the Narbonne branch "of the seed of David"; graded as prestige-pedigree); *Unetaneh Tokef* (attributed in one tradition to Amnon of Mainz, in another to Kalonymos ben Meshullam; both preserved, neither adopted). And the **Erfurt medieval genome's** grokipedia claim of southern-Italian contributions aligning with the Kalonymos migration is quarantined [C — flagged for verification against the study's actual findings; the Erfurt-ME/EU subgroup structure does not contradict an Italian stream but does not name one].

The SHuM documentary dawn, charter by charter: **Mainz, 2nd half of the 10th century** — Gershom ben Judah ("Light of the Exile," c. 960–1028) makes Mainz the Torah center of the north; his ordinances — including the famous prohibition of polygamy — become binding across Ashkenaz; students come from France, among them Rashi. **1012:** first reported persecution — the expulsion of Mainz's Jews. **Worms:** synagogue c. 1034; mikveh c. 1185; the Heiliger Sand cemetery — the oldest preserved Jewish cemetery in Europe; oldest legible graves 1058–59; continuous from ~1000 until the Nazi destruction — "the little Jerusalem on the Rhine." **1084, Speyer — the founding charter, preserved verbatim:** Bishop Rüdiger Huzmann invites Jewish settlers (refugees from the Mainz/Worms pogroms, kin of the Kalonymos family): "*in*

order to enhance a thousandfold the respect accorded to our town" — far-reaching trading rights, currency exchange, their own administration, permission to wall their quarter; the community electing an **archisynagogos** ("Jewish bishop"), confirmed by the bishop, governing with a council of twelve. **1090:** Emperor **Henry IV's charters** for Speyer and Worms — Jews to be "*judged by their peers and no others… according to their law.*" **1096:** the First Crusade massacres reach all three cities.

c. 1150, synod at Troyes: leadership of German Jewry formally transferred to the **Speyer–Worms–Mainz federation — the kehillot ShUM**; Isaac ben Moses Or Zarua (c. 1200): "*How true it is that our teachers in Mainz, Worms and Speyer belong to the most learned of the learned… From there their teaching spreads out for all Israel.*" **c. 1220: the Taqqanot Qehillot ShUM** — the joint ordinances binding all three communities — "*the first Ashkenazi constitution.*" UNESCO World Heritage since July 27, 2021 — "*the fundamentals of Ashkenazic Judaism were established between the 10th and 13th centuries.*"

The English layer — the record model's ancestor: Jews arrive with the Norman Conquest (1066; first written record 1070); direct dependence on the Crown; **peak community ~3,000–4,000** — small but economically central. **The archa system (from ~1190, Richard I's reform):** every loan document involving Jews registered and deposited in a designated chest managed **jointly by Christian and Jewish chirographers**, supervised locally by sheriffs and centrally by

the **Exchequer of the Jews** — a dedicated royal tribunal. The corpus: "*the largest collection of documents in Hebrew characters from the medieval Western world*" — preserved because Hebrew deeds had legal validity in the Crown's own courts. **The violence ledger:** London 1189; **York 1190 — ~150 Jews dead in Clifford's Tower**; Henry III's tallages extracting **£100,000-plus between 1240 and 1270**; 1275 Statute of the Jewry banning usury; 1278–79 coin-clipping trials executing hundreds. **The 1290 expulsion, in mechanics:** July 18, 1290 — writs to every county sheriff, all Jews to depart by All Saints' Day; portable property allowed; houses escheated; outstanding debts (~£20,000) seized. The fiscal bargain, on record: expulsion granted in exchange for Parliament's **£116,000 tax grant** — the largest of the Middle Ages — to fund the Welsh, Scottish, and Gascon wars; scholarly dispute preserved on whether Edward's motive was fiscal or "sincere religious bigotry"; population estimates at expulsion 2,000–16,000 [D].

Afterlife: the Domus Conversorum kept some converts on English soil to 1551+; formal readmission 1656 via Menasseh ben Israel's mission to Cromwell; the medieval legacy preserved as context — blood libel's English elaboration; Edward I "*the first monarch to use antisemitism as an instrument of state policy.*" The file's relevance stated: England is the proof-of-concept that an administered medieval Jewish community leaves a recoverable paper trail — the archa/Exchequer model is the ancestor of every record system in this book (revision lists, metrical books, civil registers); no

Goldberg thread to England is claimed or excluded — the layer is kept as methodological ancestry.

The Radhanite caveat belongs to this chapter as the merchant who made the routes. **The single-source warning, preserved verbatim:** the Radhanites are documented by **Ibn Khordadbeh (c. 870)** — and "*are otherwise not attested.*" One administrator's *Book of Roads and Kingdoms* is the entire primary record: four routes, the Rhône Valley to China, commodities from spices and silk to slaves, eunuchs, boys, swords, and furs; multilingual agents acting as translators and letter-carriers between courts. The slave-trade ledger is kept exactly as the evidence holds: in Francia, Jews were forbidden Christian slaves — so the trade ran pagan Slavic captives eastward (the corpus preserves the claim that this trade gave the word "slave" itself); **St. Adalbert of Prague, around 992, requested Bolesław to release Christian slaves from their Jewish masters** — the scene carved on **Gniezno Cathedral's bronze door (c. 1170)**, with the traders shown in pointed hats. The Beit Hatfutsot commentary preserved in full, including its moral frame: the traders were a small group who "did not represent the entire Jewish people" — and its warning that generalizations from this record "*plant the seed of genocide in the mind of a psychopath wearing a mustache.*" The record is kept because the record exists; its abuse-history is kept with it.

The Yiddish Question and the Sibling Streams

The language's deep strata are kept with the same discipline as the genetics. The consensus, stated once: "*all methods of historical linguistics concur that Yiddish is a Germanic language, with no reliable evidence for Slavic, Iranian, or Turkic substrata*" (Flegontov); Proto-Yiddish phonology reconstructs from Old High German (Katz). The founding texts: the **Worms Mahzor of 1272** — a rhymed Yiddish couplet of a dozen words inscribed in a display letter, the oldest dated Yiddish text, published by Dovid Sadan in 1963; and the **Cambridge Yiddish Codex, dated November 9, 1382**, found in the Cairo Genizah and recognized by Lajb Fuks in the 1950s — eight texts including four midrashic epics and ***Dukus Horant***, a German-cycle epic whose Yiddish copy *predates the earliest German manuscript of the same material by some one hundred thirty years.* The genizah path preserved: carried to Egypt by Ashkenazi Jews, retired to the attic when the language became unreadable there, and thereby saved for six hundred years.

The Marchand–Weinreich controversy is kept as the evidence itself: when Fuks published the codex (1957), the Germanist **J. W. Marchand** reviewed it as Middle High German literature in Hebrew characters; **Max Weinreich** answered in *Word* (1960) for Old Yiddish literature; and **Jerold Frakes** (*The Politics of Interpretation*, 1988) showed the dispute turned on "interpretive context rather than linguistic facts" — the language displays "*few features distinct from*

co-temporal German" because at its attested dawn it *was* the fusion: a Germanic vernacular written by Jews in Hebrew letters, performing both Jewish and pan-German epic. The one-hundred-ten-year gap between 1272 and 1382 is preserved as its own datum — the survival stratum is that thin. The Old Yiddish book world (1272–c. 1800): Western Yiddish dialects the exclusive medium of Yiddish publication until the late eighteenth century; the market running Amsterdam and Alsace in the west, Italy in the south, to the farthest reaches of Ukraine and Lithuania — one reading public across the Ashkenazi world; the canon preserved: *Shmuel-Bukh* and *Melokhim-Bukh* (Augsburg 1544 — verse on Germanic epic metrics), *Bovo d'Antona* (1507 — source of *bobe-mayse*, "tall tale"), *Pariz un Viene* (1594), the *Mayse-Bukh* (1602), *Tsene-Rene* (the "women's Bible"), and **Glikl of Hameln's memoirs (1691–1719) — the first great Jewish autobiography**, written in Old Yiddish.

The classificatory coda: librarians long filed Yiddish as "Judaeo-German"; the modern standard classifies it linguistically among the Germanic languages and shelves it by script — the script/language split institutionalized.

The Wexler arc is preserved as the case study of a fringe theory aging: the 2002 thesis (Yiddish as relexified Upper Sorbian — a West Slavic language recomposed onto High German phonetic strings in the twelfth century; corollaries: Ashkenazim as ethnic Slavs and Iranian-Turkic converts; Modern Hebrew as relexified Yiddish, "not genetically related to Old Semitic Hebrew"); the 2016 Das–Elhaik–Wexler

extension (Yiddish born in four northeastern Turkish villages); the critiques (Herbert Paper's early rejection; Katz: "inconsistent with the accepted methods of historical linguistics"; Neuberg: "seems more of a marketing trick"; **Beider: "Sometimes I even wonder if he himself believes in what he writes"**); and the **2021 partial retraction** — Wexler's own later formulation concedes that "*the Khazar Empire and its Turkic minority population probably did not play a major role in the ethno-linguistic genesis of Yiddish and the Ashkenazic Jews*" — while relocating the claim to Khazaria-as-venue for Jewish language creation. Fringe status maintained; the retraction itself documented, per protocol.

The sibling streams' documented interchange closes the chapter. The genetic proximity is settled: Ashkenazim and Sephardim each carry roughly **thirty percent European ancestry**, are *genetically very similar*, and both resemble **Italian Jews** — supporting a common origin in a northern-Italian Jewish population intermarrying with Italians, with Ashkenazim reaching northern Europe around 800 CE via Italy (Atzmon/Ostrer 2010); Ostrer's 2012 *PNAS* study (509 donors, fifteen populations) dated Mizrahi–Ashkenazi divergence to **about twenty-five hundred years — matching the Babylonian exile** as a demographic event; and Behar 2013 (1,774 samples, 106 populations) found Ashkenazi, Sephardi, and North African Jews "*share substantial genetic ancestry*" from Middle Eastern and European sources, with "*no indication of a detectable Khazar contribution.*" The 2020 Canaanite ancient-DNA study adds the deepest layer:

present-day Jewish groups including Ashkenazim and Moroccan Sephardim derive roughly **fifty percent or more of their ancestry from Bronze Age southern Levantine and Chalcolithic Zagros-related populations**, with the study's proxy comparison estimating **forty-one percent European admixture** in Ashkenazim. The surname evidence is the most concrete item in the whole chapter: **Morpurgo** — a common Italian-Jewish surname meaning *from Marburg, Germany*; and **Eskenazi/Eshkenazi**, among the most common names among Ottoman Sephardim — Ashkenazim joining Sephardic communities in numbers, and Sephardim marking their German sojourn in their names.

Stanford's Aron Rodrigue preserved: "*there was more contact between Ashkenazim and Sephardim than suspected, with Italy as the linchpin of interchange.*" The Karaite genetic case — documented separate history, related to all Jews, no shared Ashkenazi maternal founders — is the chapter's control experiment, already told in full in VI.6. The file's position, stated once: the Sephardic connection is documented, bidirectional, and genetically proximate — but the Goldberg surname (Germanic ornamental) belongs to the Ashkenazi stream, with no Sephardic marker attached.

Livorno — the Charter Port

The two junction machines where every stream met, chartered and dated. **Livorno** was the port that never had a ghetto. Cosimo I's 1548 invitation failed; **Ferdinand I's charter of June 10, 1593 — the *Livornina*** — was addressed nominally to merchants of all nations, in reality to Iberian crypto-Jews: **full religious liberty; amnesty; the right of Marranos to return to Judaism unmolested; large tax exemption; Tuscan citizenship** granted via the community's own officers. Five *massari* governed with civil jurisdiction and partial criminal jurisdiction; 1603's synagogue; **1693: a sixty-member great council "having all the rights of a modern parliament"**; Spanish-Portuguese rite and Portuguese as communal language into the nineteenth century; by c. 1800 **~10% of Livorno was Jewish** against an Italian average of 0.2% — the peninsula's second community; "the Grana" founded daughter communities across the Mediterranean.

Venice was the ghetto-laboratory: decree of **March 29, 1516** (Doge Leonardo Loredan); the site a former copper foundry — ***geto, from gettare, "to cast" — the etymological origin of the word itself; ~700 German and Italian Jews moved in at rent one-third above standard, gates locked dark-to-dawn by Christian guards paid by the Jews themselves; the yellow cap. The three nations: the German nation — Ashkenazim who kept Yiddish alive in Venice for over a century, printed their own machzor, and***

ran Daniel Bomberg's press; the Levantines (1541, Ghetto Vecchio); the Ponentines (1589 — Iberian conversos welcomed as Jews). To 1650, Venice printed one-third of all Hebrew books in Europe; the ghetto held Leone Modena (the Historia de' riti Hebraici, 1638; the autobiography with its gambling confessions), Simone Luzzatto (the Discorso, 1638), and Sara Copio Sullam. Napoleon, 1797 — the gates torn down; the Shoah toll: 246 Venetian Jews died in the camps.

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VI.3 The Road and the Money

The Pale, the Laws, and the Pogrom Waves

To understand the world a Goldberg family might have come from, first picture its geography. The **Pale of Settlement** was the Russian Empire's western holding pen, created in 1791 and dissolved only in 1917 — a broad band of territory, running from Bessarabia on the Black Sea up through Ukraine and Belarus to the Baltic, inside which nearly all of the empire's Jews were required to live. The 1897 census counted **4,899,300 Jews within its borders: ninety-four percent of Russian Jewry, eleven-and-a-half percent of the region's entire population, and more than a third — thirty-six-point-nine percent — of everyone living in its towns and cities.** It was, by any measure, one of the largest Jewish communities in the history of the world, and it lived behind a legal wall.

The wall did not stand still; it tightened, and the tightening is dated. In **1827**, the empire invented the **cantonist system**: Jewish communities were assigned military conscription quotas far above their neighbors', and the quotas were filled by *khappers* — kidnappers — who seized boys aged twelve to twenty-five on the street. A cantonist served twenty-five to thirty-one years, sometimes fifty, under compulsory Christian instruction and relentless pressure to convert. Over twenty-nine years, **thirty thousand to forty thousand Jewish children** passed through the system. In **1835**, the state ruled

that every surname was immutable — a family could never alter the name the registry had given it, which is why the spelling on an ancestor's Russian papers is the spelling his descendants carry. By **1849**, only three percent of Pale Jews owned any capital at all.

Then came the hinge of the whole era: **1881**. Revolutionaries assassinated Tsar Alexander II, and though Jews had nothing to do with it, the assassination was blamed on them anyway. A wave of pogroms rolled across the south — Kiev and Odessa that spring, Warsaw at Christmas, Podolia at Easter — and the government answered not with protection but with the **May Laws** of 1882: rules "temporary" in name that lasted until 1917. Jews were forbidden to settle in the countryside even inside the Pale, forbidden to buy or lease rural land, forbidden to trade on Sunday mornings and Christian holidays. Local authorities could expel any Jew they deemed undesirable, and thousands of village families were driven into already-crowded towns. The empire capped Jewish children out of its schools in **1887** — ten percent of students in Pale schools, five percent outside, three percent in Moscow and St. Petersburg — and in **1891** expelled some twenty thousand Jews from Moscow into the Pale.

The government's own commission told the truth and was ignored. The **High Commission for the Review of Jewish Legislation (1883–88)** actually investigated, and found that almost every pogrom had *begun in towns*, not villages — the opposite of the official theory that peasants were rising against "Jewish exploitation." The commission moved to abolish the

May Laws. The tsar sided with the minority report and kept them. His own recorded view is kept in this book as the policy's confession: "*We must never forget that the Jews crucified our Lord.*"

The violence came in waves, and the book holds each one on its dated ledger. **Kishinev, April 1903**: forty-nine Jews killed (some counts run higher), some five hundred injured, fifteen hundred homes looted and destroyed, police standing by or encouraging; the poet Hayyim Nahman Bialik answered with *In the City of Slaughter*, and the poem built the Jewish self-defense movement. **1905–1906**: some two thousand killed across the empire; sixty-four towns and six hundred twenty-six villages struck; Odessa the worst; an American immigration inspector's official report documented **six hundred thirty-seven pogroms**. Then the First World War drove some six hundred thousand Jews from their homes before the revolution even arrived, and the civil war that followed it killed **up to two hundred thousand** more.

One correction must travel with all of this, because it is what the archives actually show. The older claim that the tsarist central government *organized* the pogroms was dismantled by three historians — Rogger, Aronson, and Klier — who found no evidence of it. What the record shows instead is in some ways worse: a government that encouraged and subsidized antisemitism as policy, whose officials fomented attacks, and that refused, almost without exception, to punish the men who carried them out. "*Official persecution and harassment of Jews influenced numerous antisemites to presume that their violence*

was legitimate." That is the finding, and it explains everything that follows in this chapter: why a family would spend a fortune to leave, and why so many did.

The Shtetl Economy

Inside the Pale stood the world most people picture when they picture this history: the **shtetl**, the small market town. Its heart was the market square, and around the square the shops and the tea-and-brandy taverns; on market day the villagers came in from the countryside to buy and sell, and for many shtetl Jews the town was home only from Friday through Sunday — the rest of the week they were out in the villages, peddling, cobbling, tailoring, smithing. The numbers give the economy its shape. Of every hundred gainfully employed Pale Jews, **thirty-nine worked in commerce and thirty-five in crafts** — and Jews constituted **seventy-three percent of everyone in the region engaged in commerce at all.** By the 1880s some half a million Jewish artisans worked the Pale; tailoring and shoemaking led the craft ranks, and Jewish carters and cabbies — the *balagula* — were fixtures at every railway station and market.

The ledger has a harder side, and the book keeps it. No Pale province had fewer than fourteen percent of its Jews on organized relief; in the Lithuanian and Ukrainian provinces the figure rose to twenty-two; by the century's end roughly **one in three Pale Jews depended on Jewish welfare organizations** to eat. A Bund survey of 1896 measured the artisan's week at **fourteen to sixteen hours a day, for two to**

three rubles. Women carried much of this economy on records that undercounted them: the census found over three hundred thousand working Jewish women, and the economist Arcadius Kahan argued the true figure was at least a hundred thousand higher, because home-workshop labor went unrecorded. Beneath the poverty ran a dense welfare web of astonishing reach — free medicine, dowries for poor brides, kosher food for conscripts, orphan apprenticeships, and fire relief for the wooden towns that burned so often — and above it floated a recognized class with no fixed occupation at all: the *luftmenshen*, the men who lived on air.

Galicia's System

On the other side of the border — the Austrian side — the machinery of state worked differently, and its paperwork is why Galician families are easier to trace today than Russian ones. The legal foundation was the **Toleranzpatent** of January 2, 1782, with a Galician version dated variously to 1782 or 1789 — the discrepancy itself is kept on file. The emperor's package abolished the yellow badge and the body tax, opened schools and universities, permitted crafts (though never guild masterships), and granted wholesale licenses; it also banned Hebrew and Yiddish from legal proceedings after a two-year grace — thereafter, documents in those languages were "*invalid and null and void*" — froze the number of tolerated Jewish families, and ended rabbinical jurisdiction in **1784**. In **1787** came the two measures that concern this book most directly: military conscription for Jews, and **compulsory fixed surnames chosen from official lists** — the first surname mandate in Europe, and the birth certificate of every Galician Goldberg.

The paperwork the same bureaucracy produced in the same years is a genealogist's treasure. The **Josephine Cadastral Survey of 1786–1790** — executed district by district in precisely the window when surnames were being fixed — recorded householders by name, status, and house number, and the **Franciscan re-surveys of 1819–1820** added alphabetical landowner lists and house registers. These survive today in the Lviv archives (Fonds 19, 20, 166, and 186), in

conditions the file records honestly: good and indexed at Brody and Czortków; water-stained at Złoczów; parts missing at Jarosław. Special finds are preserved by name: Radziechów's 1788 survey includes a listing of Jewish shopkeepers and bakers; Strzeliska Nowe's 1846 list divides its householders into *Juden* and *Christen* — with Jews appearing in the Christian section where land transactions put them. The forensic implication is elegant: **if a Galician Goldberg family appears in the 1787–1790 survey-year registers, the surname existed by 1787–1790; if it first appears in the Franciscan survey, the name was fixed between the two.** For a Galician line, the surname's debut on paper is a datable event.

The Price of Leaving

What did it cost to walk out of this world? A contemporary researcher, Gur Alroey, rebuilt the answer from emigrant guides and shipping-line pamphlets, and the arithmetic deserves to be read slowly. A passport — or, for the ten-plus percent who could not get one, a smuggler — cost twelve to fifteen rubles. The medical exam, one. The train to the port, fifteen for an adult, half for a child. The ship itself, **seventy-five rubles from Bremen or Hamburg** — though passage to Palestine cost only twelve and a half, and to Boston seventy-five, Philadelphia seventy-nine, Galveston a hundred and ten. Food, four rubles; port lodgings, five. And then the rule that governed everything: from 1908, an immigrant had to show **a hundred rubles at the American gate** — half that before — though a woman joining her husband was exempt. Add it together: **one hundred sixty-five rubles in 1907 money, two hundred fifteen after the rule change**. Against an average Jewish family income of five hundred to six hundred rubles a year, a family of ten needed seven hundred forty-five rubles — "*it was a fortune.*"

The price selected who could go, and the selection is part of the record. The poorest Jews simply could not leave at all. The ones who did were genuinely desperate — but with either enough income to fund the breadwinner's voyage or **relatives in America who sent prepaid tickets**, a standard mechanism by which steamship-line agents crisscrossed the Pale. Bornsztejn's 1914 study of arriving Galicians found **fifty-three**

percent came with no money at all; the average carried was twenty-two dollars. Men went first; wives and children followed years later, a pattern that shaped a million family histories and a million manifests. And the money flowed back: in **1908 alone, $19.3 million in remittances reached Russia**, the average transfer a modest $28.72 — small sums sent by many, funding the next ticket out. Altogether the emigrant economy moved more than a billion rubles out of Russia between 1899 and 1914. And note the port: **twenty-nine percent of all pre-war Jewish emigration sailed from Libau, Latvia** — the single most-used door.

Brody and the Corridor

The road west had a hinge, and the hinge was a town. **Brody**, on the Austrian border, had been Jewish since the sixteenth century, independent of Lwów's kahal from 1664, and — after Joseph II's free-city charter of 1776 — briefly one of Europe's great entrepôts: **eighty-eight percent Jewish at its peak**, called "the Jerusalem of Austria-Hungary." When the Russian pogroms came, Brody became the funnel. The recorded peak: some **twenty thousand Russian Jewish refugees** in the town by the summer of 1882, with **12,476 counted on June 2** despite fourteen hundred having been sent onward that week. The relief effort was international — run from Paris by the Alliance Israélite Universelle, with Baron Hirsch's secretary buying a clothing factory to house the overflow and eleven trains eventually carrying refugees west, one of five hundred thirty-three people. An American eyewitness, Dr. George Price, wrote in his diary on May 10, 1882: "*We arrived in Brody yesterday. God! What a pandemonium! Fifteen thousand Jews are stranded here awaiting their turn… a factory lodges about three, and a stable accommodates three hundred. In both, the condition of the emigrants is unbearable.*" Sholem Aleichem would canonize the same crossing two decades later, when Mottel's family slips the border illegally "next to Brody."

Why Brody? Because of the road. The **Via Regia** — the King's Road — ran from Mainz on the Rhine through Frankfurt, Fulda, Erfurt, and Leipzig, through Bautzen and Görlitz to

Wrocław, Kraków, Lviv, and on to Kiev, under the king's direct peace with safe conduct for merchants, armies, and pilgrims alike; the Council of Europe certifies it as the oldest and longest road linking Eastern and Western Europe. And the pattern it produced is the finding that matters for any family search: **every early eastern Jewish community sits on this road or its branches** — Erfurt on its Krämerbrücke, Wrocław at its junction with the Amber Road (whose medieval roll call — "Polish, Bohemian, Jewish, Walloon, and German communities" — is the whole world of this book in one sentence). The Erfurt treasure, found in 1998 with its *mazel tov* wedding ring — "*a kind of insurance*" — belonged to a long-distance merchant of a town thirty kilometers off the road: "*no smoking gun, but a strong assumption.*" Where a family first appears in America often points back down this road to where they started; Milwaukee, the record notes, was a Litvak town.

Arrival and Dispersal

And then the ship docked, and the story most families tell about what happened next is wrong in one delicious particular. **Ellis Island did not change names.** The passenger manifest was created in Europe, at the ticket office, weeks before any inspector ever saw it; the inspectors — a third of them foreign-born, the average man speaking some three languages — were forbidden to alter a name unless the immigrant himself asked, and on the record day, April 17, 1907, when **eleven thousand seven hundred forty-seven people** passed through, each one averaged about **thirty-four seconds**. Names changed at ticket purchase, in transit, or by the immigrant's own choice after arrival — usually within five years, usually unrecorded, until the 1906 naturalization forms began requiring the change to be documented. "*My name was changed at Ellis Island*" is family shorthand for the whole Americanization experience; the paper trail shows something more interesting — the ancestor's own hand in his own renaming.

What awaited depended on who had come before. The vast majority landed in New York and concentrated on the Lower East Side — more than half a million Jews by 1900, the largest Jewish city on earth — but the neighborhoods sorted by origin, and so did the country: **Milwaukee was a Litvak town**, built by families from Slutsk and Kapulye. For the poor who could not stay, there were machines of dispersal: the **Industrial Removal Office**, founded 1900, which dispatched

seventy-nine thousand people to more than a thousand American towns on stipends averaging fifteen dollars, with agents working the Ellis Island floor — the archive of grievance preserved, including the 1905 letter from South Bend: "*Murderers! What did you want from us? Why did you send us to South Bend?*" (By 1920, only about fifteen percent remained where they were sent.) The **Galveston Movement** routed ten thousand through Texas between 1907 and 1914; ninety percent drifted east of the Mississippi anyway.

And underneath everything, the two institutions that turned hometown memory into paper. The **landsmanshaftn** — the hometown societies — numbered in the thousands (the WPA's late-1930s survey counted **2,468 organizations with some four hundred thousand members**), and YIVO holds the records of more than fifteen hundred of them; a Goldberg buried in a specific society's plot is a town attribution made in stone, and the burial-society database maps some ten thousand society plots across a hundred cemeteries. And the **Yiddish press** carried the world on paper: the *Forverts*, founded April 22, 1897, reaching a quarter-million readers under Cahan's forty-eight-year editorship, with its *Bintel Brief* advice column and its **Gallery of Missing Husbands** run with the National Desertion Bureau — and today the National Library of Israel's Historical Jewish Press project makes the whole corpus searchable, free, in the original letters. That is the machinery. The family's own four documents are what it produced.

VI.4 The Golden Ages in Full

The Tosafist Century and Its Women

The twelfth century's intellectual machine was, at bottom, a family business, and its geography is the family's geography. The village of **Ramerupt**, some forty kilometers from Troyes, held a Jewish community of late-eleventh-century vintage whose "*reputation [was] honored by the creation of the Tossafist school*" — a school a painted fresco now commemorates on the former building's wall. **Meir ben Samuel**, born around 1060, was educated in the Lorraine academies under Isaac ben Asher ha-Levi of Speyer and Eleazar ben Isaac of Mainz — the Franco-German scholarly loop closed inside one man's teachers — and married Rashi's daughter **Yochebed**. He led the Ramerupt yeshiva, lived to great age (the sources call him *ha-yashish*, the old man; he was still alive in 1135), and was so distressed by the early death of his son Isaac — Rivam — leaving seven orphans, that he refused a halakhic question from Eleazar ben Nathan of Mainz. His grandsons with Yochebed became the age's masters: **Samuel ben Meir, Rashbam** (1085–1158), the literalist parshanut master; **Isaac ben Meir, Rivam**, dead young — "the holy ark has been taken," Rabbenu Tam's lament; and **Jacob ben Meir, Rabbenu Tam** (1100–1171), born at Ramerupt, founder-director of the Tosafist method itself, "*the undisputed leader of Ashkenaz Jewry, presiding over a synod attended by hundreds of noted rabbis,*" author of *Sefer ha-Yashar*, whose

dialectical reconciliation of Talmudic contradictions — pilpul — would define the page of Talmud every student reads today.

Isaac ben Samuel of Dampierre — the Ri (d. 1185), Rabbenu Tam's nephew, led the next generation — and here the record keeps a human detail worth its weight: Ri had been the pupil of his uncle's lamented brother Rivam; when Rivam's widow remarried, **Ri married the daughter of his teacher's widow — and asked his mother-in-law for the details of the decisions her first husband had given.** The Tosafist corpus's chain of transmission, here, runs through a woman. The German branch is preserved beside the French: Isaac ben Asher ha-Levi of Speyer (Riba), founder of the German Tosafist school; Eliezer ben Nathan of Mainz (Raban), the chronicler of 1096. The map runs Troyes to Ramerupt to Dampierre to Paris and Sens, students crossing between them from all over Europe. And the catastrophe, dated: **May 8, 1147 — Shavuot** — Second Crusade bands fell on Ramerupt; massacre, Rabbenu Tam's own home looted, the texts desecrated. The master relocated to Troyes; the community faded within decades. The century's greatest academy ended not by argument but by the same mechanism as 1096: "*weak discipline*" on a holy war's road.

The women of those founding generations are held to the same evidence standard as the men — and the record, once examined, is remarkable. Rashi had three daughters: **Yochebed, Miriam, and Rachel**; all married scholars; he had no sons. "*It would be reasonable to assume that his daughters were learned, but there is no definitive evidence for this.*" The

tradition that they donned tefillin is preserved as legend — "*no direct evidence for this assertion.*" And the file carries its own correction: the long-repeated story that Rashi's daughter Rachel wrote a responsum for her ill father rested on a single thirteenth-century source — **found in 2001 to contain a misprint: the word should read "grandson," not "daughter."** The only evidence for Rachel's erudition evaporated by one letter; the dossier's rule against adopting tradition applies to its own founding family.

What survives verification is better than legend: **Hannah**, Yochebed's daughter, quoted by her own brother Rabbenu Tam on the laws of candle-lighting; **Alvina**, Miriam's daughter, teaching Rashi's customs — learned from her mother — to Ri of Dampierre; Rashi's granddaughter **Miriam**, asked to adjudicate a doubtful case; **Bellette**, sister of the great Isaac ben Menahem of Orléans, her authority *appealed to* in ritual questions; Rabbenu Tam's second wife **Miriam**, asked after his death to explain his customs; and, a century after the network's destruction, the wife (born 1305) of a Rashi descendant "*clarifying obscure Talmud passages and explaining difficulties in the Tosafists' writings.*" The *Mahzor Vitry* — the age's own prayer book — preserves the ruling in its own words: "*Women are exempt from shofar blowing because it is a time-bound positive mitzvah. However, if they wish to come and take on the yoke of the mitzvot, they are permitted and we do not stop them.*" The final clause is the tell: **women were blowing the shofar**, or the ruling would never have been written. Avraham Grossman has demonstrated the elevated social position of

medieval Ashkenazi women — economic centrality feeding religious participation, "*including their voluntary assumption of religious practices from which they were exempt in talmudic Judaism*" — and Elisheva Baumgarten documents the same wave; Rabbenu Tam accepted women's blessings over time-bound commandments.

The one-generation-deeper cause is preserved with its flag: Gershom ben Judah's ordinances, a generation before Rashi, as the autonomy floor beneath the whole phenomenon. And **Dulcia of Worms** — of Miriam's line, Rashi's family entering the Pietist house — ran the household's business, the moneylending and trade that funded her husband Eleazar's scholarship, managed the servants, hired tutors for her daughters (named Belle-Assez and Hannah for the Rashi women), and was known for piety and charity. She was killed with both daughters by two crusaders in November 1196 or 1197 [the dates flagged as pending verification; the lineage verified]; Eleazar's elegy for them survives. The strong claim kept with its own flag: the era's autonomy and status "*not to be seen again until the twentieth century*" [graded as a strong synthesis — the documented pieces stand regardless].

Lublin and the Polish Press

Poland's golden age received the west's expelled from its very first generation. Lublin's community was organized in the **1470s** by **Rabbi Jacob of Trento — expelled from Germany upon a blood-libel accusation** — and its privilege of 1523, from Sigismund the Old, granted equal status with the other kehillot of the land. The town's economic engine was, again, the road: "*the trade routes (Via Regia)*" — the same corridor this book has followed since Mainz. **Shalom Shachna** — son of the royal trade-intermediary Josko Szachnowicz, himself nominated royal rabbi in 1541 — established the yeshiva around 1530; it formally opened in **1567**, the year of the Maharshal synagogue's consecration, and under a sequence of rectors that constitutes a roll of the era's greatest names: **Solomon Luria — the Maharshal** — "*of Lithuanian origin,*" who promoted Torah learning there for fifteen years; **Mordechai Jaffe** (the Levush); **Meir ben Gedalia** (the Maharam of Lublin); **Shmuel Eliezer Halevi Eidels** (the Maharsha). The fortified Maharshal synagogue, raised in 1567, burned in 1655 and was rebuilt. The town's arrangement had a name scholars gave it: a **parapolis** — Adina Cimet's term — "*a segregated community outside the polis,*" the Jewish town of Podzamcze ("Under the Castle") facing Christian Lublin across the boundary, each side holding a mirror privilege (*de non tolerandis Judeis* in 1535; *de non tolerandis Christianis* in 1568, Christians forbidden to buy houses in the Jewish town) — an arrangement lasting to the mid-nineteenth century.

And the shadow inside the golden age, kept verbatim because the record demands it: whenever the Polish High Court sat in Lublin on a blood-libel case, "*the court hearings were followed by attacks on the Jews… If the High Court sentenced the accused Jew to death, the execution usually took place on a Saturday in front of the Maharshal Shul synagogue, and the elders of the kehillah… had to attend.*" The golden age's floor was this.

Kraków's presses carry the era's most vivid scandal. The first Jewish books printed in Poland appeared in **1534**, from the workshop of the three **Halicz brothers** — Shmuel, Asher, and Eliakim: *Sha'are Dura* and *Mirkevet ha-Mishne*, the latter **the first book in the history of printing in the Yiddish language** — a Bible concordance and Hebrew–Yiddish dictionary set in a new typeface between square and Rashi. "*The first in history to publish books in the language of everyday life of the Ashkenazi Jews.*" Then, in **1537, the brothers were baptized** — Andrzej, Paweł, Jan — and secured royal protection. The Jewish community boycotted their press. So **King Sigismund I decreed, on December 31, 1539, that the Jews of Kraków, Poznań, and Lwów must buy the brothers' unsold stock: 3,350 volumes.** The books were bought — and, the record adds, "*must have been destroyed by Jews, because only few of them have been preserved.*" Samuel Halicz returned to Judaism and resumed printing in Constantinople from around 1552 — the same press, three religions. **Isaac Prostitz** established his press in 1568 under privilege from Sigismund II Augustus; when the Basel

censorship of 1578–81 made the Babylonian Talmud effectively unprintable in Christian Europe, **Kraków printed it (1602–05, twelve folio volumes) and the Jerusalem Talmud (1609)** — works that "*could not be printed in other countries.*" Across sixty years, Prostitz issued some three hundred forty works — **fifteen percent of all Hebrew printing worldwide** — before bankruptcy in 1628, amid war and plague.

Lublin's own press began around 1547 with the Polish-ritual prayer book and received its royal privilege in **1559**, printing **the first Talmud tractate ever printed in Poland** — the Lublin edition, eighteen years in the making. And the coincidence kept on file: in **1628**, every press active in Kraków, Lublin, and Prague closed at once — no evidence of coordination found; the printers drifted to Amsterdam, where by 1660 Polish Jews founded their own congregation.

The galaxy around these institutions had a name in the scholarship: Gershon Hundert writes of the Commonwealth's eight or nine prosperous decades witnessing "*a virtual galaxy of sparkling intellectual figures*" — yeshivot at Brześć, Lublin, Lwów, Ostróg, and Poznań; two hundred Kraków imprints by 1600; rabbis who "*became not merely expounders of Jewish law, but spiritual advisers, teachers, judges, and legislators.*" Pilpul — the dialectical method founded by Jacob Pollak (1460–1541) and Shalom Shachna — was the era's characteristic art form, already criticized in the fifteenth century by the *Orhot Zaddikim* and later by the Maharal of Prague, Isaiah Horowitz, and Yair Bacharach. Lithuania ran its

own track: "*until the 16th century, the Jews of Lithuania were on the outer fringe of European Jewry*"; they adopted Polish organizational methods (the 1623 secession of their own Va'ad) and produced their first great native scholars only in the seventeenth century — **the Shakh and Rivkes** — with the supremacy of learning personified a century later by the Gaon of Vilna.

The dark side is kept at the same depth as the galaxy: the era's xenophobic pasquinade called Poland "*a paradise for the Jews*"; the Counter-Reformation's pressure; outbreaks in the 1590s at Poznań, Lublin, Kraków, Vilnius, and Kiev; **Lwów attacked in 1572, 1592, 1613, 1618, and every year from 1638** (Jesuit students leading the violence); royal-town restrictions (*de non tolerandis*) pushing Jews into the magnates' private towns — "*by the end of the 18th century, two-thirds of the royal towns and cities had pressed the king for that privilege*" — the estate-manager economy of the Russian Pale prepared here, a century before the Pale existed.

The Ottoman Threshold

The empire that received 1492 did so with a drama all its own. When Mehmed II's forces took Constantinople on **May 29, 1453**, the pre-conquest Jewish community — Romaniote, Greek-speaking, perhaps a few thousand souls, long confined by Byzantine restriction to the districts near the Jewish Gate, Vlanga, and Balat — suffered the same killings, enslavement, and property destruction as the Greek Christians; prominent families were spared or ransomed. Three days later, on **June 1, 1453**, the conqueror changed policy: Mehmed "*explicitly invited Jewish settlement, praising their loyalty, commercial acumen, and technical skills*" — protection, free trade, property rights, existing synagogues repairable and new ones by imperial approval — and appointed the Cretan-born Romaniote scholar **Rabbi Moses Capsali** as *hahambaşı*, chief rabbi of the empire's Jews. The invitation was only half the policy. The other half was the **sürgün** — forced resettlement: some five thousand families, Jews among them, relocated from Edirne, Salonika, Galata, and the Morea into designated quarters of the ruined capital, Jews grouped by origin, bound to special taxes for the sultan's foundations, and requiring **imperial permission to leave the city** (evadable by payment).

The reason for the coercion is preserved: "*Jews for that very reason became sürgüns: a productive, city-building element… imported to rebuild Constantinople.*" By **1477**, the register counted **1,647 Jewish households — eleven percent of the city's population.** And the meeting of streams the invitation

produced was not without friction: "*the meeting of the two Jewish populations was not without conflict… Ashkenazim and Sephardim disagreed on family law, the treatment of the conversos, kashrut, and other customs*" — the Sephardim "*later absorbed the Romaniot community.*"

A century later, the empire's Jewish court Jews reached a height no European state allowed. **Gracia Nasi** — Beatriz de Luna, born around 1510 in Lisbon to a family forcibly baptized in the Portugal of 1497 — married into the Mendes banking house and was widowed at twenty-five, in 1535; she "*assumed leadership of the family and its business interests*" — the corpus's characterization, "*possibly the first female CEO in history,*" kept with its flag. Arrested in Venice in 1549 on the crypto-Judaism investigation, she was freed through **Suleiman the Magnificent's personal intervention**, and reached Constantinople in 1552–53 with forty horses and four carriages of attendants; the sultan granted her the extraordinary privilege of dressing as she wished — not as dhimmi law required — extended to her entire retinue. Her program, preserved in its parts: the yeshiva and the "La Señora" synagogue (the Geveret/Hanum congregation); relief networks for fugitive conversos — Samuel Usque's *Consolacam* (1553) called her "*the heart within the body of our Portuguese nation*"; and the **Ancona boycott of 1556** — "*one of the rare acts of organized Jewish resistance to persecution in the pre-modern period*" — after Paul IV's Inquisition arrested Ancona's Portuguese Jews and burned twenty-four at the stake, among them her agent Jacob Mosso. Suleiman's ultimatum of March 9,

1556, demanded the release of his subjects; the pope burned those he could not prove Ottoman; the boycott failed, dividing the Ottoman rabbinate.

Her **Tiberias project** took the resettlement idea to its limit: the ruined Galilean town leased from the sultan at a thousand ducats a year, walls rebuilt, mulberry trees and Spanish wool imported for silk and textile production — a self-sufficient haven for the fugitives, "*as a refuge for the conversos fleeing Spain and Portugal.*" A few hundred settlers by 1566; **the project failed within a decade** — few would trade European life for the Galilee's hardships. She died in 1569, before its end. Her nephew **Joseph Nasi** — João Miques — carries the sordid preserved detail: in 1553 he abducted his cousin and married her in Ravenna to claim the inheritance; Venice exiled him; he circumcised, took the name Joseph, and married Gracia's daughter Reyna instead; he became **Duke of Naxos in 1566**, presumed instigator of the **Cyprus campaign of 1570** — "*he expected to be made king of that island after the Turkish victory, though this was not to be*" — and died in 1579. The constellation around them: **Moshe Hamon** (Granada-born, physician to Suleiman, the mediator of Gracia's move; his descendants served sultans into the next generations); **Salomon Ashkenazi** (c. 1520–1602) — *a Polish Ashkenazi Jew negotiating between the Porte and the Republic of Venice* — an Ashkenazi at the Ottoman summit; and Alvaro Mendes, circumcised at sixty-five with an 850,000-ducat fortune, duke of Mytilene. The ceiling's double edge is kept: "*Dhimmis were precluded from holding the very highest Fatimid offices*" — so

the vizierate, the summit, was reached only by converts; court-Jewish power was real, lucrative, and terminally insecure.

Salonika — the Jerusalem of the Balkans

The eastern pole of the Sephardic world became, for four centuries, a Jewish-majority city. The ancient community — Benjamin of Tudela, 12th century, counted some five hundred Jews, silk-weavers, "*oppressed*" — came under Ottoman rule in 1430; the 1492–93 arrivals were followed by waves from Castile, Sicily, Aragon, Naples, Venice, and Provence, and the Portuguese in 1540 and 1560; and a few Ashkenazim were forcibly relocated (*sürgün*) from Austria, Transylvania, and Hungary — "Buda Jews" attested after 1541. The numbers the record preserves: the 1519 census counted **3,143 Jewish households plus 930 bachelors — some 16,500 souls, fifty-six percent of the city**; by **1613, sixty-eight percent**; the 1553 register, twenty thousand. The golden age of the sixteenth century saw the port closed every Shabbat — its workforce was Jewish — with forty-five synagogues and the largest Jewish cemetery in Europe. Greek rule came in **1912**: seventy-five thousand Jews, still a majority of the city. Then **August 18, 1917 — the Great Fire**: 9,500 houses destroyed, seventy thousand homeless — fifty-two to fifty-six thousand of them Jews — thirty-two or thirty-three synagogues, ten rabbinic libraries, eight Jewish schools, the Grand Rabbinate and the communal archives burned.

The Greek government's Hellenizing reconstruction (the Hébrard plan) expropriated the burnt center; and the National

Bank of Greece **outbid the Jewish community for the Talmud Torah's own plot.** A Ladino satirist answered the new order: "*Doesn't 'modernism' mean… 'anti-Semitism'?*" The fire provoked the founding of the daily *El Puevlo*. The decline and the end run on a dated ledger: the Sunday-work law of 1922; antisemitic campaigns of 1926; university quotas in 1927; the 1923 population exchange (a million and a half Christian refugees; the Jews now a minority); emigration (ninety-three thousand in 1912 to fifty-three thousand by 1939); **1943 — the ghetto established by the rail lines; some fifty thousand deported to Auschwitz in a matter of weeks; ninety-six percent annihilated.** The cemetery — three hundred thousand to four hundred thousand graves across eighty football-fields — was razed during the occupation; gravestones paved roads and courtyards; **Aristotle University was built on top.** Today the community numbers perhaps twelve hundred to forty-five hundred souls. The Ladino the city carried is kept with it: the vernacular called itself **Espanyol** (or Djudezmo), written in Hebrew letters — Rashi script for print, Soletreo cursive for manuscripts; God appears as *Dio*, the plural-marking *s* removed against polytheism.

The press: **Istanbul's first Hebrew press founded in 1493 by the Spanish-exile brothers Ibn Nahmias**; the Soncinos in Salonika from the 1520s; the first printed Ladino book (*Dinim de shehitah i bedikah*, Istanbul, 1510); the vernacular Bible-commentary tradition crowned by *Me'am Lo'ez* (1730); some three hundred periodical titles between 1845 and 1939; and the endgame — UNESCO grades the

language moribund, with fewer than a hundred thousand speakers, most in Israel, and in Turkey the last mother-tongue speakers were born in 1945.

Safed — the Furnace

In the Galilee hills, above the Sea of Galilee, the sixteenth century built the theological furnace that would heat everything after it. Ottoman rule came to the region in 1516; the refugees of 1492 concentrated there — among them, not by accident, many kabbalists, drawn to the Galilee where the *Zohar*'s attributed author, Shimon bar Yochai, was said to have taught. The economic base was real: **Sephardic silk and wool textile wealth funding the yeshivot**; by mid-century, **over twenty major kabbalists** lived in the town. The dated figures come first. **Joseph Karo (1488–1575)** — the author of the *Beit Yosef* and the ***Shulchan Arukh (1565), the halakhic code still governing observant Jewish life — composed his masterwork in Safed while keeping the mystical diary the Maggid Mesharim, in which he recorded the voice of his heavenly mentor. Moses Cordovero (1522–1570) — the Ramak — wrote Pardes Rimonim, the encyclopedic systematization of the Zohar, and ran an academy from about 1550. Shlomo Alkabetz composed Lecha Dodi, the Friday-evening hymn sung worldwide, born of his custom of walking into the fields to greet the Sabbath as a bride. Ya'akov Berab's semikha attempt of 1538 — restoring rabbinic ordination as a prerequisite to re-establishing the Sanhedrin as a prerequisite to redemption — was crushed by the opposition of Levi ibn Habib of Jerusalem, escalating to the Ottoman authorities; Berab died in exile.***

And then the man who changed the language of Judaism. **Isaac Luria — the Ari (1534–1572)** — arrived in Safed around 1570, taught a select circle for barely two years, wrote almost nothing, and died at thirty-eight, on July 25, 1572. What his disciples recorded — **Hayyim Vital's *Etz Chaim* the canonical version, Israel Sarug carrying the teaching to Europe** — re-founded Jewish theology in three terms this book has already met: ***tzimtzum***, the divine self-contraction that made room for the world; ***shevirat ha-kelim***, the shattering of the vessels, with holy sparks scattered through the material world; and ***tikkun olam***, the repair of the world through *kavvanot* — directed intention — in every prayer and act. Gershom Scholem's thesis is preserved as the framework: Lurianic Kabbalah was in large part "*a direct response to the afflictions of the Jewish people*" after the expulsions — a theology of catastrophe offering a cosmic drama of exile and restoration. The explosion outward belongs to the record: by the seventeenth century, Lurianism had become "*the near-universal mainstream Jewish theology*" — spread to Egypt, Turkey, Italy, and everywhere; its messianic charge detonating in **Sabbateanism** (Shabbetai Zevi, 1660s, from the 1648-devastated southeast — the thread running back to the Va'ad's catastrophe) and, a century later, domesticated and democratized by **Hasidism** in those same borderlands. The **Ari Ashkenazi Synagogue** in Safed — founded by Spanish exiles, joined by European Hasidim in the eighteenth century — still performs the Ari's custom of walking into the fields to greet the Sabbath.

And the preserved detail that fuses the whole file: **Luria was born in Jerusalem to an Ashkenazi father and a Sephardic mother** — the golden age's two streams, in one man.

The Haskalah Bridge — the Weather the Edicts Landed In

The movement that gave the naming era its intellectual weather began, like so much else in this book, in the interstices between acceptance and exclusion. In Berlin of the 1770s, **Moses Mendelssohn (1729–1786)** — the hunchbacked,□□□□ philosopher whom the German Enlightenment claimed and the Jewish world debated — became the figurehead of what would be called the **Haskalah**, the Jewish Enlightenment: *Ha-Meassef* (Königsberg, 1783), the first Hebrew periodical; the 1778 Freischule (the school founded by David Friedländer and Daniel Itzig, with its curriculum of secular and religious subjects); Mendelssohn's German translation of the Pentateuch (1780–82 — twenty editions in seventy-one years, always printed in Hebrew letters, the Hebrew text and German gloss facing each other on the page); and his war on Yiddish as "*jargon*" — the language, he argued, in which the Jews' intellectual prison was built. The emancipation the Haskalah sought arrived on its own schedule elsewhere: **French citizenship for the Jews, September 27, 1791.** Berlin's movement lost momentum by the 1790s — its activists migrated east, in one historian's phrase, "*driven by a sort of messianic enthusiasm.*"

In Galicia, the movement took root early and deep. The **Zhovkva circle of Nachman Krochmal** (1785–1840), the philosopher of Judaism's spirit; **Solomon Judah Leib Rapoport (Shir)**; and above all **Joseph Perl (1773–1839)** — maskil, communal leader, and satirist, whose *Megaleh Temirim* (1819) "*the first Hebrew novel*" by common designation, was an anti-Hasidic satire in the form of forged Hasidic letters, smuggled past the censors as documentary. The periodicals ran from Brody, Tarnopol, and Lemberg: *Bikkurey Ha-ittim* (1820–31), *Kerem Hemed* (1833–56), *He-Haluz* (1852–89) — *the same Galicia of this book*, the presses running in the very towns where Goldberg families were being named. The hated figure of the state school supervisor **Herz Homberg** — the Austrian-appointed inspector of the German-Jewish schools the Toleranzpatent mandated — embodied the program's double edge: education offered as emancipation, delivered as surveillance. In Russia, the parallel figure was **Isaac Baer Levinsohn (1788–1860)**, "the Russian Mendelssohn," whose *Te'udah be-Yisrael* argued for secular learning within Torah observance.

The bridge's meaning belongs to this book's central claim, stated once: Joseph II's Toleranzpatent of 1782 and Wessely's answering *Divrei Shalom Ve'emet* are the Haskalah's founding documents; **the surname edicts of 1787–1850 are the same assimilationist program at the level of the registry office.** A Galician Goldberg line received its name inside the Haskalah's first decade, in the very provinces where the movement's presses were running. Culture, law, and naming

are one historical event seen from three angles.

Hasidism and Mitnagdim — the War Record

The movement that gave Dive 9's Galitzianer world its soul began, as the greatest movements do, small. **Israel ben Eliezer — the Baal Shem Tov**, "Master of the Good Name" — was born around 1698 in Okopy, in Podolia on the Carpathian borderland, the son of humble parents; orphaned young by the region's wars, he wandered the villages as a healer and a mystic, and in time settled in **Medzhibozh**, where he revealed himself as a *tzaddik* — a righteous master. His teaching, preserved in its core: **serve God with joy**; asceticism may itself be a root of evil; *devekut* — cleaving to God — is available to every Jew, not only scholars; "*religious exultation over holy knowledge.*" The context the corpus preserves: a populist revival amid the post-1648 spiritual wreckage, answering the creeping rationalism of the early Haskalah — "*Hasidism responded as a populist revival… democratized mysticism previously confined to scholars.*" His circle in his lifetime was tiny — "*perhaps a dozen close students and a wider penumbra*" — and the disciples on record are a list the rest of this book keeps meeting: his son **Zvi of Mezhbizh**; his son-in-law **Yechiel bar Barukh Ashkenazi of Medzhibozh**; **Dov Ber**, the future Maggid; **Jacob Joseph of Polonnoye**; **Pinhas Shapira of Korets**; **Nahum Twersky of Chernobyl** — the dynasty's seed; **Schneur Zalman of Lyady** — the future founder of Chabad. In **1760**, the Besht died.

The man who made a movement of the circle was his successor. **Dov Ber of Mezhirech** (c. 1704–1772) — "*an intellectually sophisticated kabbalist and a gifted organizer*" — transformed the small circle into a structured movement at his court in **Mezhirech**, later **Anipoli**. His own inner life is preserved in the anecdotes: too ill to teach from his bed, he sent his disciples away from the smoke of his room, and they taught each other what they had absorbed. His disciple bench became the movement's map: **Schneur Zalman of Liadi** — the founder of Chabad, whose *Tanya* would carry the movement's theology; **Levi Yitzchak of Berditchev**, the advocate of Israel before the heavenly court; **Elimelech of Lizhensk**, who developed the doctrine of the *tzaddik* — the righteous master as the people's channel to God, the court's theological foundation; **Menachem Mendel of Vitebsk**, who led the 1777 emigration to Palestine; **Jacob Joseph of Polonnoye**, the movement's first chronicler, whose *Toledot Ya'akov Yosef* (1780) preserved the Besht's teachings and coined much of the movement's vocabulary. **The Maggid's death in 1772 was, in the corpus's phrase, "the moment at which Hasidism became a movement in the geographic sense, with multiple courts and lineages spreading across the Polish-Lithuanian Commonwealth."**

The map the movement drew is the map of this book's cultural divide. The heartland: **Ukraine and Podolia**. Rapid growth in Poland; significant centers in Galicia; nineteenth-century spread to Hungary and Romania; communities in Jerusalem. And the frontier that held:

Lithuania and Belarus — limited penetration due to Mitnagdic opposition. "*Lithuania remained a Mitnagdic stronghold, while Poland, Galicia, Volhynia, Podolia, Ukraine, Romania, and Hungary became Hasidic strongholds*." The legal unlock is dated: **1804** — Alexander I's toleration of independent Jewish prayer groups — "*the chief vessel through which the movement spread from town to town.*"

The world it built is preserved in its practices. The **tish** — the rebbe's table: in the great courts only the rebbe's inner circle ate; the **shirayim**, the remnants, were distributed to all present — "*believed to be a great merit… miracles can take place in merit of partaking*" — while the rebbe's own eating was watched in silence from the **parentches**, the bleachers; the rebbe might wait hours until the Hasidim had eaten before beginning his own meal with Kiddush; without a rebbe, the same gathering was a **botteh** or *shevet achim*. The **farbrengen** — the Chabad variant: *zemirot*, the formal Sabbath songs, are not sung, **only niggunim**, the wordless melodies; the *l'chaim* opens hearts and softens pointed criticism; **the documented limit, preserved verbatim: Rabbi Menachem Mendel Schneerson forbade more than four shot-glasses of alcohol for anyone under forty**; the format is rebuke "*with love and deep affection*"; the aphorism: "*that which a Hasidic gathering can do, not even Archangel Michael can do.*" The rebbe attended on Simchat Torah, on **19 Kislev** — the anniversary of R. Schneur Zalman's 1798 release from prison, celebrated by Chabad ever after — and on Purim.

The **niggunim taxonomy**: the **niggun rikkud** (dance tunes, ABCB form, tempo rising with each repetition), the **d'vekut** plane (the clinging meditative; *ga'agu'im*, yearning tunes), the **volakh** (the pastoral Wallachian interlude); wordless melody ranked *above* words — the Baal Shem Tov's *devekus niggunim* as "songs that transcend syllables and sound"; and the warrant for borrowed tunes, straight from the Safed layer above: the folk song in "spiritual exile," raised as **sparks of holiness** — *tikkun* audible as music theory. The shtetl street these courts stood on is preserved from the Hrubieszów yizkor book: "*When we recall our shtetl Hrubieszow, we must first and foremost take a walk down Shul Street… Every day either early in the morning or in the evening the street was filled with Jews. Everyone had their own shtiebel and their own minyan… When the four sons of the Trisk Rebbe used to come… thousands of Hasidim would flock to the Rebbe with small slips of paper where they would request advice and a blessing. People with disabilities and chronic illnesses used to go to the Rebbe's grave with the hope that maybe a miracle would happen… Scribes would make amulets that the Hasidim would have blessed by the Rebbe, and as such the street was alive by day and by night.*"

Against it rose the opposition, and the opposition had a face. **Elijah ben Solomon Zalman — the Vilna Gaon (1720–1797)** — born in Sielec, Lithuania; from about age twenty, self-imposed seclusion in Vilna — the city became the era's center of "*precise, evidence-based exegesis.*" Mastery beyond the canon: **mathematics, astronomy, Hebrew**

grammar; called "*the father of Talmud criticism*" for his anti-pilpul insistence on sources and the long-neglected **Jerusalem Talmud**; dozens of textual emendations contradicting post-Talmudic masters — "*without access to manuscript variants.*" The two-front frame is preserved from the scholarship: he confronted **both** new movements — "*there was too much exultation in Hasidism and too much rationalism in Haskalah — either extreme undermined the Jewish tradition*" — trying to "*harmonize between the heart and the mind to prevent Judaism from being crushed between Haskalah and Hasidism.*" Mildly opposed to the Haskalah too; opposed to Hasidism "*from 1772 until his death,*" ordering excommunications and book burnings.

The conviction preserved verbatim: "*Had I the power, I would punish these infidels as the worshipers of Baal were punished of old.*" The objections, itemized from the corpus: emotion over study; the **tzaddik cult as heretical innovation**; the **Sabbatean resemblance** — the movement arose in the same southeastern borderlands where Frankism had run, and the Vilna community had burned Frankist books in 1756; liturgical change (**Nusach Sefard** — the Sephardic-inflected prayer rite the Hasidim adopted); prayer-time deviations; boisterous worship; separate minyans; *and the practical*: the Hasidic slaughter method "*meant they were evading the communal tax on meat.*"

The war ran on dated paper. **1772** — the Vilna ban; the Gaon's signature on the decree; Hasidic writings burned in the synagogue forecourt — probably the earliest anthologies.

Renewed **1781** — the **Zelva council**: *expel the Hasidim, no intermarriage with them, no social intercourse, no burial of their dead.* Again in 1784; again in 1796–97. The Hasidic counterattack is preserved: they "*systematically purchased and burned all copies of the printed edition of the ban*"; and the war of printed polemics — *Zemir Aritsim* (1772), *Sefer Viku'ah* (Warsaw 1798, its first edition bought up and destroyed).

Then the state entered: **1798 — the Mitnagdic Rabbi Avigdor of Pinsk denounced Shneur Zalman of Liadi to the Russian authorities** (treason, and donations to Ottoman Palestine that could be framed as enemy contact); two arrests — 1798 and 1800 — the **Petropavlovsk fortress**, release by Paul I; **19 Kislev** celebrated by Chabad ever after, and the corpus adds: "*they still regard the mitnagdim with great contempt for what they deem the betrayal of their first rebbe.*" The doctrinal core of the whole war: the ***tzimtzum*** debate — the Gaon rejected the Tanya's reading of Luria's contraction doctrine as heresy; and the answer came from his own camp's greatest theologian: **Chaim of Volozhin's *Nefesh HaChaim* (1824)** — "*the foundational theological statement of the Lithuanian Mitnagdic tradition and the principal counter-statement to the Tanya.*" The man who built the institutional answer: **Chaim ben Isaac of Volozhin (1749–1821)**, the Gaon's senior disciple; from about age forty, the Gaon taught his chosen circle of already-experienced scholars — Chaim among them — and in **1803** Chaim founded the **Volozhin yeshiva**, "*the prototype of every modern Lithuanian-style Talmudic academy,*" training "*several*

generations of scholars, rabbis, and leaders." The Musar codicil, mid-nineteenth century: **Israel Salanter's** movement — "*combining strict ethical behavior with an intensive study of the Halakhah*" — the Lithuanian stream's second institutional layer.

The demographic floor is kept: the **first census of Lithuanian Jewry, 1765** (the Pinkas Hakehillot Lita) — and the corpus's note that "*Mitnagdim*" — the opponents — "*has become, since then, a soubriquet for Lithuanian Jewry, also called Litvaks.*"

The accommodation is the war's quiet ending: the Gaon's death in **1797** removed the implacable center; the Haskalah rose as the common enemy; "*by the second half of the 19th century, both sides basically considered each other legitimate.*" The Litvak ethos the stream built — Torah study for its own sake; "*empirical textual fidelity*"; the prestige of learning as a civilizational vocation; analytical, dry, skeptical, unemotional — is Dive 9's stereotype pair embodied. The corpus's balance closes the chapter: "*Hasidism kept the flame from going cold. The Mitnagdim made sure the house did not burn down.*" The file's use of the whole map, stated once: a surname-era Goldberg family lived inside one stream or the other — Galician/Hasidic or Lithuanian/Mitnagdic — and the Dive 9 cultural-diagnostics interview (fish, pronunciation, self-label) is now fully armed: "*Galitzianer*" *memory opens the Hasidic court world;* "*Litvak*" *memory opens the yeshiva world.* The Vilna Gaon's war drew the line the family memory still traces.

VI.5 The Traditions, in Full

The Italian Fossils

Four categories of Italian Jewry preserved: the **Italkim** (the Roman rite, *minhag Benè Roma*; the name from Latin *italicum*); the **Sephardim** (post-1492); the **Ashkenazim** (north and central); the **Appam** of Asti, Fossano, Moncalvo — French expellees of 1182 preserving Rashi-era usages. Into the 20th century, Rome's Great Synagogue (inaugurated 1904) fused five congregations — Sicilian, Catalan, Castilian, Italian, and the Scola Tempio — the Italian rite predominating but Sephardic chant and Roman liturgical influence audible; the absorption rule in stone: communities retained, individuals assimilated.

The rite's distinctive marks (the EJ inventory): *Levila Levila* in the Kaddish; *Keter* in all Kedushot; the kerovot of the Day of Atonement; the Seder Rav Amram model of prayer interspersed with halakhic instruction; the **Soncino mahzor of 1485–86**, its first printing — and the reason it survived when others did not: "*Italy was the main centre of early Jewish printing, enabling Italian Jews to preserve their own traditions when most other communities had to opt for a standard 'Sephardi' or 'Ashkenazi' prayer-book.*" The claim kept as claim: the Italian prayer-book "*contains the last remnants of the Judaean/Galilaean Jewish tradition*" — "*quite likely historically accurate, though difficult to verify textually.*" The **Romaniotes**: the oldest European Jewish community (records to 300 BCE;

the Delos synagogue, 250–175 BCE); their *Mahzor Romania* — "*actually the first Mahzor*"; and the gift preserved: "*the liturgical writings of these Romaniote Jews, especially the piyyut, were eminent for the development of the Ashkenazi Mahzor, as they found their way through Italy to Ashkenaz.*" Ioannina's end kept: of 1,960 deported March 25, 1944, 110–112 survived; today fewer than fifty remain, the last bar mitzvah in 2000.

The Year — Both Calendars

Ashkenazi custom highlights: Elul's Selichot only from the last Sunday before Rosh Hashanah; Rosh Hashanah without the ceremonial seder (the Sephardi table of dates and pomegranates); apples and honey, the round challah; **Kol Nidre in the future tense**; the kittel; Sukkot's ushpizin and the willow-beating; Simchat Torah's Hakafot and the children's flags; Hanukkah's latkes and dreidels; Purim's hamantaschen, shalach manot, the Purim spiel; Passover's seder, the afikoman ransomed, **the kitniyot ban** (a fence around the law, c. 13th-century France-Germany); Shavuot's dairy table and Tikkun Leil; the Three Weeks' meat-and-wine restrictions; Tisha B'Av sitting on the floor; Lag Ba'Omer's bonfires and Meron, mourning lifted *on* the day.

Sephardi and Mizrahi divergences, preserved: the **Rosh Hashanah seder** — dates ("*may our enemies cease*"), pomegranate, fish head, the table a series of puns; **kitniyot eaten**; Selichot daily through Elul; Lag Ba'Omer's mourning lifted at the day's *end*; **Mimouna** — because no chametz could

be kept in Jewish homes, **Muslim neighbors brought the flour, butter, and eggs**; the first moufleta fried from neighborly gifts; open-house visiting, sfenj, arak; the largest Moroccan-Jewish social event in the world today. **The Henna complex**, documented from primary eyewitnesses (Romanelli 1792, Lempriere 1793, Benchimol 1888): up to eight pre-wedding nights; the **azmomeg** (henna, cloves, sugar, egg worked into the bride's hair); the **keswa el kbira**; the **amaria** lifting the couple above the crowd; the matriarch's coin-shaped paste tied with ribbon — "*to tie their future*"; every guest's palm dabbed — *every observer made a participant*; the **kittab** on Shavuot — five-year-olds as the Torah's brides and grooms, "*the rabbi wrote them a wedding contract in honey on a piece of paper, which the children licked up gleefully*"; the apotropaic layer kept unsentimental — the *jnun* offerings ("*the coriander is for you, and the henna is for your children*"), hamsa hands, new-house corners sprinkled overnight.

The worldwide Sukkot table: Yemenite rooftop sukkahs, woven date-palm schach, no paper chains; Iraqi courtyard sukkahs glowing with colored-glass lanterns; Moroccan embroidered fabrics, the Elijah's Chair on the wall, mint tea for guests, children burning the sukkah on the last day; Syrian seven-species decor, the etrog to jam, the lulav kept till Passover as the chametz-search broom; **Judeo-Spanish biscochos hung in the sukkah, etrog kept for Havdalah, macaroni and cheese served on Hoshana Rabbah**; Bukharan carpets; Greek and Turkish balcony sukkahs cantilevered over the street; Ethiopian riverbank gatherings

(no sukkahs historically); Ashkenazi papercuts of the ushpizin, eggshell birds; Chabad's added ushpizin (Baal Shem Tov to the Rashab). **And the emblem:** the **Kovno Ghetto lulav, 1941** — no four species in the ghetto; an expert arrived from Vilna leaving after the first day; Rabbi Oshry refused to rule either way; "*since I did not explicitly tell them it is forbidden, they gleaned that whoever will take the four species will not lose*" — and they blessed the lulav amid annihilation. Salonika's diaspora nickname-Simchat Torah kept: the "Rice Synagogue" cooking rice, the "Chair Synagogue" seating the Torah-bearer.

Hanukkah worldwide: Chag HaBanot (Yemenite and North African; best preserved in Tunisia) — the seventh night, Hannah and Judith, the dairy feast of Judith's cheese, women touching the Torah, ceremonial reconciliation between women; Yemenite *Megillat Antiochus* and the children's daily coin for sugar and red dye — "Hanukkah wine"; Aleppo's extra flame — gratitude for refuge after 1492 ("*they viewed their arrival in safety as their own miracle of Hanukkah*"); North Africa's Psalm 30 nightly and the poor children burning anti-evil-eye grasses for coins; Bukharan flat oil menorahs and hushquiliq — *fried cookies whose ingredients are oil and vodka*; the blessing said without *shel* per the Hida; Flory Jagoda's *Ocho Kandelikas*; Ethiopian doro wat and dabo; Colombian patacones; Italian precipizi.

The Lifecycle, Station by Station

Birth: the **Shalom Zachar's four reasons preserved** — the newborn as *mourner* for the Torah the angel taught him and struck away (hence the chickpeas, the mourners' round food); the Shabbat Queen who must be greeted first; the homonym *zachar/zachor*; and the peace-making — hosts *invited their enemies*, "*when a male child enters the world, peace enters with him.*" The Sephardi parallel *Brit Yitzchak*; the eighth-night vigil, the men reading Zohar while the women held the watch. **Brit milah** on the eighth day — counted from birth, any day of the year including Yom Kippur; the sandek's throne; naming *at the brit*; the wimple's journey from the circumcision cloth to the Torah binder. **Pidyon haben** at 31 days — the C-section exemption kept (a child not first from the womb owes no redemption, nor does the next-born).

Marriage, compared station by station: the Ashkenazi bride circles (three or seven times, Jeremiah 31:22); Sephardim do not circle. Ashkenazi custom ends with **yichud** — the couple alone 8–20 minutes — which the Sephardim call *davar mechoar*, a repugnant thing; the Yemenite **chuppah is a bridal chamber** — a decorated room in the groom's house, "*as described in the 12th-century Sefer HaIttur and the Jerusalem Talmud*" — the canopy's own ancestor. The dances and their genealogies: the **hora**; the **krenzl** crowning the mother at her last daughter's wedding; the **mizinke** for the parents' last child; the **mitzvah tantz** with the gartel; the Yemenite chamber itself. The wedding day's personal Yom Kippur — the

couple may fast until the chuppah.

Death: the chevra kadisha's *tahara*; tachrichim; the low stools and covered mirrors of shiva; kaddish's eleven months; the yahrzeit candle on the Hebrew date; yizkor four times yearly; the unveiling at ~11 months — "*whose Hebrew face carries ben/bat + the father's name, the same patronymic document as the ketuba at its start.*"

The Table and the Band

Three crowns, three tables (the partition-era corpus): Polish sweetness — sugar on the pickled herring, sweet gefilte with chrain, fish with raisin sauce, bagels, the bialy from Biała/Białystok, slivovitz; Lithuanian pepper-and-sour — iced beet soup, sorrel with lemon and sour cream, fermented cabbage, meat with prunes, Scandinavian-cured fish; Ukrainian-Russian — kasha with curd cheese, blini, knishes, pirogi, baranki, zakuski. The transport mechanism: the partitions carried German-origin shtetl foods — challah, gefilte, chopped liver, kugel — across Eastern Europe with the social structure that cooked them. The Galician kitchen — "*a ball of multi-colored threads*" (Boyko, Hutsul, Lemko highlanders; the "lordy" city cuisine; "grandma Austria, auntie Poland"; nalysnyky, opikanky) — the Goldberg table's braid.

The kapelye: *klezmer* from *kley zemer*, "vessels of song"; the hereditary, endogamous caste; "*a wedding without klezmorim is worse than a funeral without tears.*" The orchestration timeline as a jurisdiction marker: 18th–early 19th c., 3–5 strings (lead violin, second violin, cello, cimbalom);

mid-century the clarinet enters; late-century Ukraine, 7–12 with brass (tsarist army bands feeding the brass); **Galicia and Belarus kept the small string-cimbalom ensemble into the 20th century** — a Goldberg family wedding band was four or five strings, not a brass orchestra. The poverty record: the *fidl, paykl, tokhes kapelye* — "a fiddle, drum, and backside band," four youngest members, unpaid, guests paying per dance. The **badkhn**, whose improvised rhyming died in America when the week-long wedding shrank to a day — but whose freeform survived as the doina. The repertoire map (Feldman's dating): the *genres* older than the mid-18th century, the *known repertoire* 1800–1900 in the partitioned zones — freylekhs, sher, khosidl, bulgar, doyne, taksim, gas-nign (always 3/4), tish-nign, terkisher, zay gezunt. The collectors — Kiselgof 1907–15, Beregovsky, Magid — their materials in Kyiv's Vernadsky Library; the revival from Sapoznik's Kapelye (November 18, 1979).

Dress, Stone, and Paper

The shtreimel taxonomy: **shtreimel** (short, wide, brown fur) — Galicia, Hungary, Romania, Ukraine, Lithuania courts; **spodik** (taller, narrower, black, *cheaper*) — the Polish dynasties; **kolpik** — the rebbes' unmarried sons. The legend debunked on record: Sigismund I's animal-tail decree — advanced by Ahron Marcus, S.Y. Agnon, and the Sanz-Klausenberger rebbe — "*has no historic basis.*" The documented truth: the 1682 Kutno memoir ("*I adjusted my shtreimel, so they wouldn't recognize me*"); the 18th-century portraits of non-Hasidic rabbis — "*for 18th- and 19th-century rabbis, a shtreimel went with the job.*" The kaftan is Ottoman. The 1853 decree banned the "Jewish kaftan" and failed — an 1860 report: Jews "*largely had not altered their clothing.*" Women's coverings: the sheitel "a relatively late variation"; the Baghdad face-veil till the 1930s; Yemen's all-blue rule (Brauer 1934).

The matzevah's dictionary: vertical slab Ashkenazi, horizontal Sephardi; **most pre-19th-century markers were wood**; the stones were painted (three colors, the 1916 photograph); carving as hereditary family craft; the symbols — crown, lion, the **candelabra as the women's marker** (the Sabbath candles), blessing hands for kohanim, the pitcher for Levites, the Tree of Life, the broken branch, Renaissance-borrowed skulls and hourglasses; Bilga's niche is elsewhere (the living registry), but the stone's blacklist cousin is kept: interwar prefabrication — "*a marked deterioration…*

Nor was this art reborn after the Holocaust" (YIVO). The inscriptions: *po nikbar*, the ben/bat patronymic, the Hebrew dates, *tantzbeh*; Warsaw's first Polish epitaph, 1855; Rohatyn's Polish-on-the-reverse stones of the 1930s — "*the residual connection to the Austrian Empire*" two decades gone.

The papercut: Rabbi **Shem Tov ben Ardutiel** — Santob de Carrión, troubadour of the *Proverbios morales* — records in *The Fight of the Pen and the Scissors* that **his ink froze, so he cut his letters in paper with a knife**: the art form's 14th-century origin story, one man holding the scholar's and the poet's chairs at once. The corpus: Alsace, Germany, Bohemia, Austria-Hungary, **Galicia**, Poland, Lithuania, White Russia, Ukraine, Volhynia, Podolia, Romania — the full Goldberg-zone map — and Turkey, North Africa, Syria, Baghdad, Palestine; objects: mizrachs, shvitis, ketubba and megillah borders, sukkah and Shavuot decorations, charms; the master named: **Israel Dov Rosenbaum of Podkamen (near Brody), 1877**, The Jewish Museum, New York. The Eastern branch — the "Menorah" cuts, paper mounted on colored metal, **the hamsa a signature motif "unknown in Europe"**; the craft's logic: *hiddur mitzvah* — and only paper and a knife required, so it flourished exactly where wealth did not.

The synagogue interior and the Torah's jewelry: the ornament set — the **keter** (a crown encircling both staves; the Torah as princess) or the paired **rimonim** ("pomegranate" finials with bells, the high priest's robe recalled); the **tas** (the breastplate hung from the handles, modeled on the Urim ve-Tumim, with interchangeable portion plaques); the **yad** —

"the only Torah ornament that has an actual function." The improvised layer preserved: a 9th-century responsum already discusses **women's jewelry crowns for the Torah** on Simchat Torah; a 1203 record of a community commissioning a proper silver crown to end the halakhic awkwardness. The two reading cultures, mechanically distinct: the Ashkenazi scroll (two rollers, cloth mantle, laid **horizontal**, lifted **after** the reading; the parokhet hung **outside** the ark doors) against the Sephardi (the rigid cylindrical **tik**, read standing, displayed **before**; the curtain **inside**); the bimah central in Ashkenaz, the tevah forward in Sephard; the white curtain of the High Holy Days. The **ner tamid**: the Kol Bo (late 15th century) already calls it universal — "*to give honor to the Divine Presence that rests wherever a quorum of Jews gathers*" — oil to wax to gas to electricity. The **Polish wooden synagogues** — fanciful timber construction with lavishly painted ceilings, mostly destroyed in the Holocaust. The women's section's evolution: same-floor latticed separation, then the balcony, the mechitzah; liberal congregations abolished. And the micro-customs kept: Hungary protested the introduction of **clocks** into the sanctuary; Germany accepted them; a heating stove was once a luxury improper to the synagogue.

Purim, the Sephardi version: the lost custom of Rhodes — "*the second night the women would all come to the synagogue… my dad would read the whole megillah in Ladino*" (Elazar Behar, Seattle) — two nights of Purim; the tray economy — silver trays of *biskochos*, *boulukouniu*, and, in the American layer, **Hershey's Kisses**, carried by children paid in

nickels, newborn caps knitted and tucked into the tray; *huevos de Haman* / *foulares* — the egg wrapped in dough, "*Haman in a jail cell*"; the Istanbul *Komplas de Purim* (1922/23) drinking songs — "*Beved vino viejo i de todo modo de kolores*"; the greeting **"Purim alegre y dulce"**; and the law's softness — charity on Purim given **to anyone who asks**, Nachmanides' reading preserved: not conventional charity but *communal unity* — "every Jew is worthy of our love on Purim."

The folk layer — amulets, healers, and the neighbors' magic: the amulet's documented career — Talmudic roots (worn on the newborn's neck; efficacy-proven amulets permitted even on Shabbat); the encyclopedia's ledger: folk Judaism waned in 19th-century Enlightenment Europe but **"retained its vitality until 1948" in the Middle East**; the **Kurzweil collection** (4,000 pre-war artifacts) — lead-and-pewter dreidels, kosher seals, Torah-aliyah tokens, amulets against diphtheria and childbirth — "*objects of the normal, regular Jew, not the aristocracy.*" **Ansky's 1912–14 ethnographic questionnaire**, preserved verbatim in its findings: **Tatar healers** in the shtetl — reading Muslim prayers and blowing on the patient; fumigation with burned prayer-pages; and **washing the written text off and drinking the water** — "*a good cure for epilepsy and giddiness*"; **Muslim cemeteries as shared sacred geography** — visited by Tatars, Christians, and Jews alike, praying for health and conception; Tatar circumcision specialists who were **often Jews**; and Yaffa Eliach's witness from Eishyshok: "*Jews and Tatars were friends*" — and Tatars

aided their Jewish neighbors in WWII. **Regina Lilientalowa** (1868/75–1924): the pioneer ethnographer of Polish-Jewish custom — children's games and rhymes, wedding rituals, protective amulets against the evil eye — her critical writings on circumcision drawing religious backlash; a woman doing salvage ethnography on a vanishing world, and donating the amulet-bearing heirlooms to Warsaw's museum.

The Languages

Judeo-Arabic: by ~800 CE **roughly 90% of world Jewry spoke Arabic**; the great medieval library — Saadia's *Emunot ve-Deot*, Bahya's *Chovot HaLevavot*, Halevi's *Kuzari*, Maimonides' *Guide* — was written in Judeo-Arabic in Hebrew letters; the dialects (Iraqi, Moroccan, Tripolitanian, Tunisian, Yemeni, Aleppine...); the vitality ledger: ~94,000 Iraqi-dialect speakers in Israel by 2018, most others in the dozens, critically endangered. **Judeo-Aramaic:** Kurdish Jewry's living daughters of Jewish Babylonian Aramaic — Lishana Deni, Lishan Didan, Hulaulá, Barzani, Betanure, Lishanid Noshan. **Juhuri:** Southwest Iranian, sister of Early New Persian, Azeri and Russian overlay; the phoneme that betrays deep history — **the pharyngeal ayin, which no neighboring language possesses**, a Levantine fossil in an Iranian frame; the community called it "Persian" through the 19th century, the Soviets "Tati," today **Juhuri — literally "Jewish"**; ~30,000 speakers, UNESCO definitely endangered. **Krymchak:** the Rabbanite twin of Karaim; endonyms *Tatar Tili*; Hebrew script; holiday names fully Turkic-declined — **psax** (Passover), **prim** (Purim), **ska** (Sukkot); **the jönk** — family journals "*passed down from father to eldest son,*" including recipes: a patrilineally inherited record system by another name; 8,000 speakers in 1940, **zero counted in 2025**. The community's geography preserved: centered on **Kaffa/Feodosia** (15th century), then **Qarasubazar/Bilohirsk** (18th), then **Simferopol** (from the 1920s) — the Rabbanite twin of Karaim

living alongside it, distinguished by faith, identical in speech.

The Living Tongues taxonomy kept in full: vibrant — Hebrew, standardized and Eastern Yiddish, Israeli Sign; endangered — Judeo-Arabic in all varieties, Judeo-Aramaic, Yevanic, Judeo-Persian, Bukhori, Juhuri, Judeo-Shirazi, Judeo-Median, Lotera'i, Ladino (Judezmo and Haketía), the Judeo-Italian dialects, Western Yiddish, Judeo-Malayalam, Karaim, Krymchak, Judeo-Berber, Ghardaia Sign; recently dormant — Judeo-Portuguese, Judeo-Occitan (Shuadit), Udmurtish Yiddish, Palestinian Yiddish; emergent — Judeo-Amharic, Jewish English, Judeo-Hungarian, Jewish Russian, Jewish Latin American Spanish.

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What this chapter holds: the two-thousand-year account of how the Jewish streams treated one another — Sephardi and Ashkenazi, Karaite and Rabbanite, Hasid and Mitnagid, Ashkenazi and Mizrahi, the rescue missions and their paternalism, and the modern boundary cases from Brother Daniel to the blood-bank bins. It matters because **the family itself descends from one of these streams marrying into another's world**, and its children's Reform namings are the ledger's newest entry. The chapter's structural law, stated once more: the marriage boundary is the load-bearing wall. Terms to carry: *get* (the divorce document), *mamzer* (a child of a legally adulterous union, stigmatized), *tinok shenishba* ("a captive infant" — blameless for its upbringing), *aliyah* (going up — to

the Torah, or to Israel).

VI.6 The Ledger, in Full

The Sephardi Self — What the Ottoman Jews Called Themselves

Before anyone called them Sephardim, the Jews of the Ottoman Empire had other names for themselves — and the difference between those names and the one they eventually adopted is one of this book's quietest, most revealing findings. "*The term 'Sephardi' itself was seldom employed in everyday discourse.*" The registers of daily life were others: *djidyo, djudyo, judio, israelita* — the ordinary words for "Jew" in the Judeo-Spanish vernacular. A Sarajevo-born merchant, **David Attias**, publishing in Livorno in 1778, addressed his readers as ***levantinos — "Levantines" — and then had to make an argument for the identity the modern world assumes they held: "originally our forefathers came from Spain or Portugal." The fact that he had to make the point tells us everything. A generation later, a new name appeared: Turkino — from the 1860 Ottoman penal-code translation's suditos Turkinos, "Ottoman subjects" — which became the American Ladino press's first self-designation in the 1910s. And beneath both lay the deepest, most particular layer of all: the town names. Selanikli — Salonican — Izmirli, Rhodesli, Monastirli — organized into mutual-aid societies exactly like the Yiddish Landsmanshaftn of Dive 16's New York. The identity of place came before the identity of pedigree.***

Then came the commemoration that shows what the community actually remembered. In **1892**, the empire's Jews marked the four hundredth anniversary of the 1492 expulsion — **not by lamenting Spain, but by celebrating the Ottoman welcome.** It was, in the historian Julia Phillips Cohen's phrase, "*the first occasion that Jews in the Ottoman Empire marked the anniversary… to fashion them into loyal Ottoman patriots.*" The trauma of 1492 had been converted into gratitude's anniversary; the expulsion was remembered as the preamble to rescue. And layered over the whole society was the French of the Alliance Israélite Universelle schools — the imperial Jewish elite's mark of civilization, the language of Paris threading the Levant.

The "Sephardi" identity arrived from outside, under pressure. In **October 1915**, the New York Ladino newspaper *La America* changed its masthead from "*organ of the Judeo-Oriental colony*" to "*organ of the Judeo-Sephardi colony*" — escaping the demeaning Orientalist register and claiming, in its editor's words, the golden-age pedigree and the philo-Sephardic rhetoric of the European scholars who had made "Sephardi" a compliment. It was "*the first success of the Sephardi campaign.*" The resistance is preserved: the town-name loyalists held out longest; the campaign's Zionist leanings repelled others. But by **1921**, the Salonican Brotherhood reincorporated as the **Sephardic** Brotherhood, opening its rolls to all Ladino speakers — *Selaniklis, Izmirlis, Monastirlis, and Rhodeslis* recast as Sephardim; France followed in 1930. The scholarly verdict travels with the

campaign: "*it substituted one mythology for another*" — "*both images, myth and counter-myth, omit the intense dynamism, cultural innovation, and political change*" of Ottoman Jewish life. The wall's mirror image is filed beside it: the family of **Saadi Besalel Levy Ashkenazi (1820–1903)** — "*descended from an Ashkenazi family of printers that arrived in the Ottoman Empire from Amsterdam in the eighteenth century*" — "*within a few generations became fully 'Sephardic' in culture and language,*" his son Sam Levy becoming "*one of the greatest defenders of the Ladino language.*" Ashkenazim becoming the most Sephardic of Sephardim: the boundary's permeability, running east.

The assimilation arrows point both ways across the map: in **Syria**, arriving Sephardim "*eventually intermarried with, and assimilated into, the larger established communities of Musta'arabim and Mizrahim*"; in **Morocco and Algeria** the arrow reversed, the pre-existing Jews "*assimilated by the more recently arrived Sephardi Jews.*" Same rite, opposite flows. And in Palestine, the old Yishuv's Sephardim were "*Ottoman patriots*" whose position on the Arab question diverged from the Ashkenazi Zionists' — "*in part because of their close ties with the Arab community.*" Under the British Mandate, the hierarchy flipped, and the corpus's polemical sentence is preserved with its flag: "*the domination of the Eastern-Jewish culture failed… Mizrahi and Sephardic children were asked to forget their 'primitive culture' and take an example from the 'white' Israelis*" [flagged as polemical framing; the pattern itself independently corroborated by the Dive 100 ledger]. The

Yemenite chapters belong here, flagged for their dedicated treatment: the **1911–12 camps affair** (housing conditions and family separations in the moshavot) and the **Yemenite Children Affair** of the 1950s — children taken from immigrant families in hospitals and never returned, the subject of three state commissions, the state's word against the parents' to this day. And in France, the former Ottoman Jews' relative standing made them "*interlocutors between the established Jewish community… and the recently arriving Yiddish-speaking Jews*" — the same brokerage role they had played with Arabs in Palestine.

The identity chapter closes on its own thesis, refined by everything above: **identity-names are the wall's paint.** The Ottoman Jews' own names — Turkino, Levantino, Selanikli — never claimed Spanish purity; the "Sephardi" identity was adopted under Ashkenazi-Orientalist pressure to claim a European pedigree the community had not needed. The wall stood where the name stood; and the name moved when the surrounding world's contempt moved it.

The Karaite Record, Complete

Judaism's other scriptural stream — the one that rejected the Oral Law and held to Scripture alone — gets its own complete ledger in this book, because it is the control case for every origin-claim the file holds: a community with a documented, continuous, non-rabbinic history against which every genetic and historical claim can be tested. The birth itself is disputed three ways, and all three are kept: **Anan ben David** (8th century) — censured by Iraqi rabbinic authorities, or passed over for communal leadership, launching the "Ananites" (the personal-grievance story, which scholars doubt); the movement only "*took off*" in the 9th century under **Daniel al-Kumisi**, who dismissed Anan's importance while expanding membership with missionary zeal; and the confluence view (Fred Astren): Karaism surfaced from multiple trends at once. The name comes from *qara* — "to read": Scripture alone, against the Rabbanite *rav* and the oral tradition. Al-Kumisi's Jerusalem — he urged every diaspora community to send five families with seed money to the ruined city, "*the first Zionist doctrine in history*" in the movement's own telling — held until the Crusades destroyed it. The great 19th-century Karaite archive collector **Abraham Firkowicz's** Crimean inscriptions have been debated for a hundred and seventy years — preserved as [D], unadopted.

The communities' geography: Crimea from the 13th century; **Trakai (Troki) in Lithuania** and **Halicz in Poland** — the eastern orbit; the Turkic-speaking Karaim/Kypchak language

documented alongside; and the **Krymchaks** — the peninsula's Turkic-speaking *Rabbanite* Jews — kept distinct by faith and identical in speech, a distinction that would prove fatal.

The legal pivot of the whole modern Karaite story is this: in the 19th century, Karaite leaders petitioned the Tsars for exemption from anti-Jewish legislation, arguing non-Jewish — Khazar or Turkic — descent. It worked. **1863: equal rights with Christian and Tatar neighbors; exemption from the Pale.** The Khazar theory *adopted for legal survival* — kept as an adoption, not a finding; the academic community's critical assessment preserved alongside. Then the fork in the road that the whole file holds with special care: under German occupation, racial authorities — accepting the Karaite non-Jewish classification — **left the Karaites untouched: "a case of mistaken identity,"** while the **Krymchaks**, ethnically and linguistically identical but Rabbanite, were almost wiped out. The same genetics, two fates, decided by paperwork. The two groups are distinguished on record to this day: the religious Karaite Jews (mostly Egyptian-Karaite descent in Israel today, some thirty-five thousand) versus the ethnic Karaylar-Karaites of Eastern Europe, whose claimed Tatar-Turkic origins and 1930s professions (a 1936 Polish pamphlet; Szapszal's declarations) file them separately — both recorded as they present themselves.

The genetics deliver the verdict the paper claims could not: **Crimean Karaites are "often closely related to other Jews, both Karaite and Rabbinical, but have little affinity with other Turkic-speaking peoples or with non-Jewish**

peoples who inhabit lands that were once part of Khazaria." Dominant haplogroups G2a, J1, J2 — more than half the gene pool; **17 of 27 East European Karaite samples match Ashkenazim**; matches to Sephardim, Mizrahim, and Egyptian Karaites as well — one L-haplogroup linking an East European Karaite to an Egyptian Karaite, *common paternity between the communities*; and **Karaite Cohens sometimes related to Ashkenazi Cohens.** The maternal contrast is the signature: Karaites **lack the four major Ashkenazi mtDNA founder lineages** — the exact genetic footprint of a documented, separate-but-parallel maternal history. The file's template, stated once more: documented history plus matching genetics — the standard every origin-claim must meet.

And the millennium of Karaite-Rabbanite relations? The golden age comes first: in the Islamic east — Palestine, Egypt, Iraq — "*Karaites were considered simply followers of a different type of Judaism, making Rabbanism and Karaism similar to the variant legal schools of Islam*." The marriage contracts prove it. **Seven Karaite–Rabbanite marriage contracts survive in the Cairo Genizah**, and their tolerance clauses deserve to be read whole: the Rabbanite husband's promise *not to bring home the fat tail, the kidneys, or the liver-lobe* (Karaite dietary restrictions); *not to compel Sabbath-candle lighting*; and the clause preserved verbatim — "*he will not force his wife to sit with him alongside a Sabbath candle, nor to eat the fat of a rump, nor to profane her festivals.*" The calendars diverged; the households negotiated. "*Marriages with Rabbanite partners were perfectly legal and*

commonly practised before the thirteenth century." Then **Saadia Gaon's polemics** — "*brought about a permanent split between some Karaite and Rabbanic communities*" — with the Baron-era estimate that Karaites once numbered a tenth of world Jewry; Qirqisani's counter-code preserves the Karaite side of the argument.

Maimonides built the boundary wall — and the same Maimonides preserved the compassion clause. The ruling: the Karaite *get*, the divorce writ, was invalid; therefore a Karaite divorcée's second marriage was adulterous; therefore her children were *mamzerim*; therefore, by extension, **all Karaites were presumptively unmarriageable.** Intermarriage *halted*.

But in the very code that built the wall, Maimonides held the door open for the people inside it: Karaites who deny the Oral Law from parental upbringing are as *tinok shenishba* — "a captive infant," raised in error — "*not to be held accountable for their errors.*" The dissents are kept in full: **Radbaz** (16th-century Egypt) reasoned in the opposite direction — if Karaite marriage itself was invalid, no adultery had occurred and no mamzer stigma attached; "*this approach is generally followed in Israel today by Sephardi rabbis.*" **Ovadia Yosef, in 1971** — then Chief Rabbi of the Sefaradim and Edot HaMizraḥ — ruled: *Egyptian Karaites are Jews; intermarriage permissible.* The Ashkenazi stringency stands beside them: the ruling attributed to **Samson of Sens**, codified by **Moses Isserles** — *forbidden to marry Karaites, making rapprochement more difficult.* And the hard edge, preserved with its caveat exactly as the source gives it: "*Some recent*

Ashkenazi Ḥaredi scholars have held that Karaites should be regarded as Gentiles in all respects, though this is not universally accepted… the opinion is not intended to insult… but only to give individual Karaites the option of integrating… by way of conversion." The modern result: separate courts, synagogues, and endogamy — "*both Karaites and Rabbanites frown upon intermarriage*"; the Egyptian Karaite community some thirteen hundred years old; its twentieth-century internal split (progressives seeking solidarity with Rabbanites against traditionalist separatism) preserved as the community's own debate.

The Claimants' Table, Complete

Every major claimant to the lost tribes has been tested, and the full table belongs here.

British Israelism holds the file's most complete debunking: the Anglo-Saxons as the Ten Tribes (Ephraim = Britain, Manasseh = the USA); the Stone of Scone as Jacob's pillow-stone — analyzed as **Scottish sandstone**; "Saxon" derived from "Isaac's sons" — a folk etymology that collapses under linguistics; the 1910 *Encyclopaedia Britannica* verdict, "*utterly unsound*"; debunked on archaeological, linguistic, ethnological, and genetic grounds; adherents digging up Tara in Ireland (1899–1902) hunting the Ark of the Covenant; and the ICCT study tracing the theory's afterlife into **Christian Identity extremism**. The tradition's own counter preserved: the tribes were *dispersed, not lost* — Anna of the tribe of Asher (Luke 2:36), Paul of Benjamin, James addressing "*the twelve*

tribes in the Dispersion."

The Bnei Menashe — the Chin-Kuki-Mizo of northeastern India — began in **1951, with a dream**; the movement's own origin story, preserved as such. Named by Rabbi Eliyahu Avichail, who brought them to Israel's attention; the testing followed: the Technion's team (Avshalom Zoossmann-Diskin and colleagues, 2003–04) found **no Middle Eastern Y-DNA**; a 2004 Kolkata study found East and Southeast Asian haplotypes; the 2005 mitochondrial "Near Eastern" claim was graded a methodological artifact; G25 modeling shows zero Levantine affinity, the group sixty-five times closer to Han Chinese than to Levantine populations; and Mizoram University's researchers documented the community's distinctive customs as pre-existing regional practice, not Israelite inheritance. **Chief Rabbi Shlomo Amar's 2005 "recognition"** — the event the movement celebrates — was *religious*, requiring formal conversion and a Knesset dispensation for aliyah: a separate category from descent, and the file keeps the categories apart.

The Pashtuns carry the Bani Israel tradition among some tribes; the genetics answer it: a 2007 study found limited Greek and broad West-Eurasian input, but **no Levantine-specific signal** — the residual shared ancestry is Iranian-plateau farmer, weaker than the Persian neighbors'. **The Igbo** of Nigeria: a West African genome, indistinguishable from non-claiming neighbors; tradition preserved, genetics negative.

The Beta Israel of Ethiopia — the contrast case, and the hardest. A documented Jewish presence of great antiquity (the first recorded news reached Jerusalem in a rabbi's letter of

1425); the Radbaz ruled in the 16th century that they were Jews; James Bruce encountered them in 1768–69 seeking the Nile's source (his hundred-thousand estimate flagged); Joseph Halévy's 1867 confirming report — "*shelved… ignored by world Jewry for fifty years*"; Jacques Faitlovitch's eighteen months among them in 1904–05 and his fifty-year promise; the **1908 recognition by the leading rabbinic authorities of forty-four countries**; and the Israeli Chief Rabbinate's rulings of 1973–75 — Ovadia Yosef, then Shlomo Goren — accepting them as Jews under the Law of Return. The recognition was **halakhic and political — not genetic.** Their Judaism, preserved in its own terms: the **Pentateuch only**, without Talmud; liturgy in Ge'ez; no rabbis — high priests, lower priests, and monks; animal sacrifice retained into the 20th century; the Sabbath observed with stringency; endogamy enforced; the synagogue called *masjid*. Their names, kept unsentimental: *ayhud* — Jews; *falasha* — the Amharic "exiles" or "landless ones," the exonym others used; *kayla*, added in the 17th century; *Beta Israel* — "House of Israel," their own name. The Ethiopian wars kept beside the faith: the community "*fought several wars against the kings of Ethiopia and were not finally defeated until the early 17th century,*" after which forced conversion-or-death was imposed, Jewish customs forbidden, land confiscated, many sold into slavery.

Then the two wounds of their Israeli life. The **conversion controversy of 1975–85**: recognition required a symbolic conversion for marriage; the immigrants "*were unaware of the* '*conversion*' *criteria before their arrival*"; and after a

month-long demonstration by a large section of the community, the demand was amended.

The controversy "*grew into a full-blown controversy, significantly affecting the relationship of the community with Israeli society.*" And the blood: in **1996**, the revelation that the Ministry of Health and the blood services had for years **discarded blood donations from Ethiopian Israelis** — out of infectious-disease concerns including HIV — while giving donors certificates and insurance "*without being told that their donation had never been used.*" On **January 28, 1996, some ten thousand Ethiopian Jews demonstrated in Jerusalem** under the banners "*one people, one blood*" and "*we are Jews like you*"; the police used tear gas, batons, and water cannon; **Prime Minister Shimon Peres apologized personally and on behalf of the state.** The investigative committee "*concluded that the donor deception had been misguided — but declined to change donation procedures,*" and the de facto exclusion of Ethiopian donors' blood lasted **another twenty years, until December 2016.** The community's own words are preserved: "*We prefer our blood to be spilled in front of the government's office than thrown in the garbage.*" And the scholarship's reading, kept with it (Jon Abbink): the discarding "*was interpreted as a physical rejection of the Ethiopian community as part of the body of the Jewish people.*" The counter-ledger belongs beside the wound: **Operation Moses (1984–85, 12,000-plus airlifted through Sudan) and Operation Solomon (1991 — fourteen thousand five hundred in a weekend, the largest airlift in history)** — the

state's monumental act of inclusion against its mundane act of exclusion.

The file's hardest clause, now the chapter's: recognition by authority is necessary but not sufficient. The rabbinate demolished the wall in 1975; the blood bank rebuilt it in hospital basements for twenty more years. Both are the record.

The Missions East

The German and French Jewish missions to the eastern communities carry the ledger's double entry, and this chapter keeps both books open. **Joseph Halévy** went to Abyssinia for the Alliance Israélite Universelle in **1868**; his report — "*which he had fulfilled with distinguished success*" — ran in the AIU bulletin (1868, pp. 85–102) alongside the two boys he brought back. The suppression myth is corrected on record: he was denied permission to publish the report *as a book*, and the full-suppression story traces to Nahum Sokolow's later portrait — both corrections preserved, per this book's rule that rescue narratives get the same source-audit as persecution narratives. His **Yemen expedition of 1869–70** was a different mission entirely: sent by the French academy to transcribe Sabaean inscriptions — chosen partly *for his rabbinic training*, which let him pass where an orientalist could not. The corpus keeps the details: his rationalism against local magic; the local suspicion — "*some suspected him of being a magician, a treasure hunter, or perhaps even a searcher for the lost Israelite tribes*"; and the partnership with the coppersmith guide **Ḥayim Ḥabshūsh** — "*their relationship soured and, by the time they returned to Ṣanʿā’ in 1870, the two were estranged.*"

Jacques Faitlovitch carried the Beta Israel cause for fifty years. His first expedition — **1904–05, eighteen months** — produced the promise to enlist world Jewry; the boys he brought to Europe; and the feud. The AIU refused to adopt his cause, especially after its own envoy **Rabbi Ḥaim Nahum's**

1908 mission returned a negative verdict; Faitlovitch organized **"pro-Falasha" committees in Italy and Germany** instead, finding "*outstanding lively interest*" particularly in Germany, and the **Hilfsverein co-financed his 1908 expedition** (published in German, 1910). The feud preserved verbatim: Faitlovitch on Nahum — "*he did not speak Amharic… did not understand the extent of the bad impression he made upon the Ethiopian Jews by his traveling on the Sabbath, and allowed himself to be duped… underestimating the size of the Jewish population (by something like eighty-seven percent)*"; the German Jewish press "*unconditionally in favour*" of Faitlovitch, publishing Nahum's report "*late and without any comment — lack of space was the official excuse.*" The institutions the mission built: the **Dembea school (1913)**; the **Addis Ababa boarding school (1923, with the JDC)**; the traveling schools; and **Taamrat Emmanuel**, the Beta Israel intellectual who translated the *Maṣḥafa Qədossə* — the community's holy book — into Amharic and became an Ethiopian education official: the mission's deepest success, and its bridge into the community's own leadership.

The Hilfsverein — the German Jewish aid association — was the mission machine. Founded in Berlin on **May 20, 1901** (Consul Max Landau first chairman; James Simon and Paul Nathan the driving figures); by **1907: fourteen thousand members, some 140,000 marks contributed, 1.5 million spent** — mostly on pogrom relief. Its Galician programs: vocational training (lace-making, hair-netting) and **credit cooperatives** — the microfinance of its day. In Palestine:

kindergartens, the teachers' seminary, the Laemel school, the Wissotzky Technikum bequest. Its self-image principle is preserved verbatim, because it is the best sentence the organization ever wrote about itself: "*While the [AIU] were always striving to impose on the Jews of the East 'their' — French or English — culture, the Hilfsverein's principle was above all to meet the demands of the population, the land, and the time.*" The counter-flag travels with it, as this book's rule requires: "*on occasions the Hilfsverein policy was guided by pro-German political objectives such as the introduction of German language teaching*" — the **1913 Technikum language furor**, when the German-language requirement at the future Technion detonated a Yishuv-wide crisis, is the famous breaking point.

And the rivalry is kept: the AIU *opposed* the Hilfsverein's founding; German members split off from the French organization; and Tudor Parfitt's verdict: "*many were convinced that the very founding of the Hilfsverein had been an act of separation within Jewry.*" The German-French Jewish rivalry, projected onto the East — with the Beta Israel question as one of its battlegrounds.

The Yemenite labor affair completes the double ledger. In **1911**, the Zionist office's **Arthur Ruppin** dispatched **Shmuel Yavne'eli to Yemen** — "*disguised as a Rabbi coming to take advice on religious matters*" — to recruit laborers for the Yishuv's farms; **roughly two thousand came** (about five thousand in the last Ottoman decades; over fifteen thousand under the Mandate). The doctrine, preserved: "*Yemeni Jews*

were viewed as 'natural workers'"; "the farmers' association was therefore ready to pay their travel expenses." Ruppin's own authorization was reluctant — per one scholarly framing, he "*considered them racially inferior*" [Lentin's framing flagged as ideologically charged; the documentation itself in Halamish's work]; the settlement pattern the recruitment produced was the mixed community — **Eastern European overseers and Yemenite Jewish laborers** — the overseer-laborer structure that shaped the Yishuv's ethnic economy for decades. The detail that stands for the whole: **to reach the Eastern Jews, the Western Jew had to impersonate their own** — the emissary traveling as a rabbi.

The Modern Israeli Ledger, in Numbers

The Ashkenazi–Mizrahi account of modern Israel is kept in this book in numbers, because numbers survive the argument over interpretation. The absorption of the 1950s began in the **ma'abarot**, the transit camps: they housed **seventy-five percent of Mizrahi immigrants by 1951, eighty-three percent by 1952**. The sociologist Sammy Smooha's and Barbara Khazzoom's analyses of the 1961 census measured the placement gap directly: **Moroccan versus Polish placement rates of thirteen percent versus fifty percent in 1959, and thirty-seven versus eighty-one percent in 1961** — and Khazzoom's finding is kept verbatim: "*the 'best' of Mizrahim were not deemed better than the 'weakest' of Ashkenazim.*" The police ledger tells its own story: Ashkenazim were **seventy-two percent of the police force in 1949; Mizrahim the majority by 1959** — recruited disproportionately, then deployed to disperse their own communities' protests, and nicknamed by those they policed: "*Ben-Gurion's Dogs,*" "*Nazis,*" "*Gestapo.*" A commander's recorded explanation is preserved: "*If you attack any of the shotrim, you will be attacking one of your own.*"

Wadi Salib, July 1959: a police shooting in Haifa's Mizrahi neighborhood; a march into the affluent Hadar HaCarmel district; riots spreading to Beersheba, Tiberias, Migdal HaEmek, Acre, Kiryat Shmona; **thirty-four arrested** including the leader of the Union of North Africans; and the government's response — the **Etzioni Commission**, appointed

to determine whether Mizrahim were *actually* being discriminated against. **The Black Panthers, 1971**: founders in their twenties from Jerusalem's Musrara neighborhood; the statistics they carried (drawn from interview-based research and tagged as such): **at least fifty-five percent of Mizrahi children were dropping out of school; eighty percent of welfare-supported families were Mizrahi; an Ashkenazi family earned thirty percent more; Mizrahi boys were seventy-nine percent of those deemed "delinquents" against fifty-four percent of the age cohort.** And the cabinet's fear, preserved verbatim from the state record: "*the fear of ethnic issue… They would have given them everything, as long as they kept quiet, as long as they didn't raise the ethnic problem.*" The persistence, in one line: **2015 — just under twenty-nine percent of second-generation Mizrahim held university degrees against roughly fifty percent of Ashkenazim; the wage gap remains.** The political translation: the 1977 electoral shift — the Mizrahi electorate's wholesale migration from Labor to Likud — made the "ethnic problem" the country's governing axis.

The reconciliation instruments are kept with the wound: Ovadia Yosef's rulings and the rise of the Mizrahi rabbinic establishment; the Shas party (1984) as the community's institutional expression; the Mizrahi cultural renaissance — music, food, the very word *Mizrahi* reclaimed; and routine intermarriage between the streams. The polemical framings — "racialization," "Zionist manipulation," state-defending scholarship — are quarantined as frames, not findings; the

statistics above stand tagged to their sources.

Brother Daniel — the Boundary's Courtroom

The modern state of Israel put the ancient boundary question — who is a Jew? — before its Supreme Court in 1962, and the case is told here in full because it is Yavneh's question in a courtroom. **Oswald Rufeisen (1922–1998)** — known after his conversion as **Daniel** — was a Polish Jew from a Zionist youth movement; during the German occupation he was enslaved as a translator at the police station in Mir, and from inside that desk he "*systematically tipped off the local Jewish community about upcoming Nazi operations, smuggled weapons, and when the ghetto was about to be liquidated — warned them in time.*" **Between a hundred fifty and three hundred Jews of Mir were saved.** Caught, he escaped — and hid **in a convent, where in 1942 he converted to Catholicism.** By 1945 he was a Carmelite friar, having chosen the order, he said, *because it had a monastery in Israel.* He reached Haifa in 1958 and applied for citizenship under the **Law of Return**, listing *nationality: Jewish; religion: Catholic.*

The petition is preserved in his own words: "*My ethnic origin is and always will be Jewish. I have no other nationality. If I am not a Jew, what am I?… I did not accept Christianity to leave my people. I added it to my Judaism. I feel as a Jew.*" And the comparative argument: if atheists are Jews, why not a Catholic?

The Supreme Court's ruling (case 72/62, 1962; four to one; Justice Moshe Silberg for the majority) is kept verbatim in its formulas, because the formulas became law: "*the term 'Jew'*

should be interpreted as we, the Jews, understand it" — the community's self-understanding as the final court; the Law of Return "*not a religious law but rather a national one*"; "*a Jew and a Christian cannot reside in one person because there is a mutual denial of community.*" The halakhic position — that an apostate **remains** a Jew — was acknowledged and set aside as inapposite to the secular-national question. Justice Haim Cohn's observations are preserved: had Rufeisen been recaptured by the Nazis, the conversion would have made no difference; Ahad Ha'am would not have excluded a deeply Zionist convert — *yet* the people themselves had decided. **The identity card issued after the ruling read: "Nationality: not clear."** Ben-Gurion's own position, from 1958, precedes the ruling in the record: "*If he is a Christian—he is not a Jew. The Jewish nation is just this kind of strange nation, whoever becomes a Christian—does not belong in it.*" And the historian's verdict: Michael Stanislawski called the case "*a fundamental episode in the history of the Jewish State*."

The codification followed: the **1970 amendment** to the Law of Return (written after the Berenson case) defines a Jew as "*a person who was born of a Jewish mother or has become converted to Judaism and who is not a member of another religion*" — the Brother Daniel line written into statute, with the grandparent clause added for good measure. **Beresford (1989)** extended the precedent to Jewish Christians (Messianic Jews): denied under the Brother Daniel line, "*wholly consistent with the attitude of virtually all of world Jewry*" — with the First Things analysis preserved beside the ruling as the case's

standing challenge: "*Why are Jewish Christians any less Jewish than Jewish atheists?*" The Messianic legal status today: not recognized as Jews for the Law of Return; proselytizing Jews legally restricted; deportation proceedings against Messianic aliyah applicants standing practice. The counter-missionary world — **Yad L'Achim, Or L'Achim, Lehava** — is kept with its hostility record: the disruptions of Messianic gatherings (the Clal Center protest, June 22, in the U.S. State Department's religious-freedom reporting); poster campaigns boycotting Messianic-owned shops; Interior-Ministry reporting; the **Or Yehuda mayor's public book-burning** of missionary literature (he later apologized); police "*excessive force*" complaints at counter-missionary protests; and the U.S. Navy chaplain-insignia case — a Messianic Jewish chaplain candidate ordered to wear the Christian cross, who resigned rather than comply.

And the question this book files as pending, not treated from memory: the post-1994 Lubavitcher messianism movement and the Jewish world's response to it — awaiting its dedicated pass.

The chapter closes where the whole ledger closes: **Brother Daniel's case is Yavneh's question in a courtroom.** The halakhah says a Jew remains a Jew — indelible. The state says "*as we, the Jews, understand it*" — the community's self-understanding as the boundary's final court, and that self-understanding holds, twenty centuries on, what the Talmud's censored texts held first: **the one who crosses to the other side has crossed.** The identity card's three words — "*Nationality: not clear*" — are the parting of the ways, the

entire two-thousand-year question of Part VI.8, compressed into bureaucratic Hebrew. And the marriage-wall law, stated one final time for the whole ledger: the wall stood where the community said it stood — and every generation rebuilds or dismantles it with its own hands.

VI.7 The Temple Corpus, in Full

The Tribal Question

Every Jewish family eventually asks the tribal question — *which of the twelve tribes do we come from?* — and the tradition answered it twenty-four centuries ago, in the census of the return from Babylon. The answer has three parts, and the file holds all three at full weight.

The first is the legal architecture. Tribal status follows the father; Jewishness itself follows the mother, but the tribe runs patrilineally. Of the twelve tribes, only two survive as identifiable castes: the **Kohanim**, the priestly descendants of Aaron, and the **Leviim**, the wider tribe of Levi's non-priestly line. Every other Jew, by definition, is **Yisrael** — an Israelite of untraced tribal descent. The rule is codified: "*All Jews who do not qualify as legitimate Kohanim or Leviyim are automatically classified as Yisra'elim (regular Israelites).*" The mechanism for restoring lost knowledge was preserved by Maimonides (Mishneh Torah, Kings 12:3): in the Messianic era, the king "*will define the lineage of the Israelites according to their tribe*" — through the Urim ve-Tumim, the oracular breastplate of the High Priest, whose power "*was no longer extant after the first Temple and will be restored only with the coming of Mashiach*" (Sotah 48a-b). Unrecognized Levites are relegated to Yisrael; and no one may ever be called illegitimate, "*for the law rules that once a family has become intermingled within the entire Jewish people, they may remain intermingled*"

(Kiddushin 71a). The tradition's working answer for today: most Jews are of Judah — the surviving kingdom's name became the people's name (the "Jews" of Esther, the "Yehudim" of the return) — while individual families preserve Levite or Kohen identity.

The second part is the return's own genealogy crisis, the founding document of the question. Ezra's census recorded **42,360 returnees** but enumerated only about 29,000 by name — the traditional reading (flagged) takes the surplus as Jews of the other ten tribes, "not listed separately." The Levite shortage is verse by verse: **74 Levites** returned (Ezra 2:40 — Jeshua, Kadmiel, and Hodaviah's line), against thousands of priests; at the river camp, Ezra found **none** (Ezra 8:15 — "*I viewed the people and the priests, and found there none of the sons of Levi*"), and dispatched to Casiphia for Sherebiah, thirty-seven Levites, and two hundred twenty temple servants (8:16–20). The Levites had simply stayed in Babylon. And three priestly families — **Hobaiah, Hakkoz, Barzillai** — "*could not tell their fathers' houses nor their descent, whether they were of Israel*" (2:61–62); the Barzillai family had taken its name from a Gileadite wife's prestigious line. The governor's ruling: excluded "*as unclean*" from the most holy things **"*until a priest arises with the Urim and Tumim*"** (2:63) — with four lay families of Tel Melach and Tel Charsha under the same disability. The tribe question was thus the return's own administrative crisis, and the Torah's answer was a waiting clause. Lisbeth Fried's article [A] preserves the scholarly footnote: extra-biblical evidence suggests Second Temple high

priests *did* consult the Urim ve-Tumim — yet 2:63 indicates the device was lost by the earliest return; the verse preserves a real memory of a provisional register, awaiting an oracular resolution that never came.

The third part is the lost-tribes doctrine itself. The deportation of 722 (Dive VI.8's record: 27,290 counted, scattered to Halah, Habor, Gozan, and the Medes) left ten tribes unaccounted. The Talmud preserves the fight: **Rabbi Akiva — "Just as the day goes and does not return, so they went and will not return" (Sanhedrin 110b)**; the opposing sages held they return in the redemption; Ezekiel's two-sticks prophecy (37:15–28) promises reunification. The modern scholarly verdict (Tudor Parfitt) is preserved with its coda: the lost tribes "*all assimilated into the groups around them, and eventually disappeared*" — "*It is difficult to find a region of the world that doesn't contain a group that has at some point claimed to have descended from the lost tribes*" (the claims map runs the Americas, Japan, China, Ethiopia, South Africa, India, Nigeria, New Zealand, England, Ireland, Afghanistan, Burma). The maternal line carries its own flag: the four major mtDNA founders (K1a1b1a, K1a9, K2a2a1, N1b2 — Dive VI.2's dispute) say nothing about *tribal* identity, because tribe follows the father; the 2006 media naming of the founders after Sarah, Rebecca, Rachel, and Leah is preserved as media-tradition, flagged. The tradition's comfortable position completes the answer: the ten tribes' descendants, whatever became of them, are assumed under the intermingling rule to stand within Israel's presumption of legitimacy. The question is deferred to

the Messiah; the community does not need the answer to function.

The Goldberg answer, as the file now holds it: an ornamental surname carries no priestly association; a Levite or Kohen family would traditionally *know* — the castes are titled families whose status is communal knowledge. The working answer is **Yisrael**, which the tradition itself defines as the default and the Messiah as the resolver. The one test that could change the answer is Y-DNA of a male-line relative: a J-Z18271 match would open the Cohen file (Dive VI.2's nine branches), R1a-M582 the Levite one; anything else — statistically, almost everything else — confirms Yisrael, which requires no further documentation.

The Caste in Operation

The caste system did not live in law books; it ran every Monday, Thursday, and Sabbath, in the order of the Torah reading. The rule (Mishnah Gittin 5:8; Shulchan Aruch OC 135): first aliyah to a **Kohen**, second to a **Levi**, the rest to **Yisraelim** — instituted "*in the interests of peace*" (Gittin 59b), anchored in *vekidashto* — "you shall sanctify him" (Leviticus 21:8): he speaks first, blesses first, receives the preferred portion. The system's own jurisprudence is preserved in its edge cases. No Kohen present: "*the bundle has come apart*" (Abaye) — with three recorded interpretations, from Rashi's (a Levi has no independent rank without a Kohen; call a Yisrael) through the Rema's (no order at all) to the Aruch Hashulchan's (the Levi keeps rank); the gabbai must announce ***bimkom kohen*** — "in place of a Kohen" — so no one mistakes the substitute for the caste itself. No Levi: the same Kohen is called twice. Only one Yisrael in the room: he takes first — *darkei shalom*, the ways of peace, outrank lineage. And the scholar-precedence fight, three hundred years of it: if an ignorant Kohen and a great Torah-scholar Yisrael both stand waiting, the **Rashba** ruled the scholar goes first; **Rav Amram Gaon, Rav Natrunai Gaon, and accepted practice** ruled the Kohen goes first regardless. The later-aliyot split is preserved: Ashkenazi custom bars Kohen and Levi from the middle aliyot (except maftir and the added *achron*); Sephardi custom permits — a third of European Jewry's service architecture differs on exactly this caste question.

Duchenen — the priestly blessing — is the caste's most visible survival. The kohanim remove their shoes; **Levites, if present, ritually wash the priests' hands** — the Levite's temple water-pouring role surviving as live choreography; the kohanim stand before the ark, heads and arms covered by the tallit, fingers spread in the Shin formation — the initial of Shaddai — and chant the threefold blessing of Numbers 6:23–27, each phrase answered by the cantor, the congregation standing silent, eyes averted: "*according to tradition, the Divine Presence would shine through the fingers of the priests*." The private preamble preserved: "*Who makes us holy with the holiness of Aaron, and has commanded us to bless His people Israel with love.*" The rite's distribution is itself a historical map: daily in Israel and the Sephardi rite; festivals only in much of Ashkenaz. **Pidyon haben** and the honor economy complete the picture: the firstborn son redeemed from the kohen at thirty-one days for five silver shekels — the kohen asks "*which would you rather have, the child or the five silver shekels?*" — with the exemptions preserved (a child not first from the womb owes no redemption, nor does the next-born; the C-section rule); the child on a silver tray ringed with the women's borrowed jewelry, "*to contrast with the golden calf, when gold and jewelry was used for a sinful purpose*" (another reading recalls the jewelry borrowed from the Egyptians at the Exodus).

The Mishnah's precedence hierarchy (Kohen, Levi, Yisrael, convert, mamzer — for honors and even for communal charity allocation) is kept with its override: "*even a mamzer who is a*

Torah scholar precedes a High Priest who is an ignoramus" (Horayot). The trust rule: "*Anyone who says that he is a Kohen is to be believed*" — self-attestation suffices, because the caste runs on unbroken tradition, and the whole system accepts that presumption. The stones (Dive VI.5's symbol-dictionary) carry the caste's end station: hands for Kohen, pitcher for Levi — with the warning attached that either symbol on a Goldberg stone would reopen the caste file.

The Onomastic Engine

The castes wrote themselves into surnames as compressed documents, and the file preserves the whole engine. The two great acronyms: **KTz = Kohen Tzedek** ("righteous/authentic priest") → **Katz**; **SGL = Segan Leviyah** ("associate/deputy of the Levitic order") → **Segal** — written in Hebrew with gershayim before the last letter, the abbreviation visible in the letters themselves. The acronym family runs wider: **Sachs** = *zera kaddoshim*, "seed of the holy" — descendants of martyrs, named so by rabbis; **Shatz** = *shaliaḥ ẓibbur* (cantor); **Shub** = *shoḥet u-vodek* (slaughterer-inspector); **Sass** = *sofer STaM* (scribe); **Berag** = *ben R. Gershom*; **Harlap** = *ḥatan R. Levi Pinḥas* (son-in-law); **Brill** = *ben R. Yehuda Levi*; **Back** = *ben Akiva*; **Popp/Popper** = Frankfurter (the F/P interchange); **Asch** = Eisenstadt. The far-flung kohen markers preserved: **Maza** = *me-zera Aharon ha-Kohen*, "from Aaron's seed"; **Zalka** = *zecher le-kohen gadol*, "in memory of the High Priest" — Iraqi priests; **Gindi** (Aleppo); **Hadad** (Djerba — a *disqualified* kohen family, the disqualification remembered inside the name); and **Rappaport** — many of whose bearers descend from the Shakh, whose title itself spells *shafu kohen*, "lips of the priest." Levite forms: Levi, Levy, Loewy, **Lev, Levine, Levitt** (the Russian Empire's forms).

The contested acronyms carry the tradition policing its own etymology. **Azulai** — the tradition makes it an acronym of the priestly marriage prohibition ("*ishah zonah vaḥallelah lo yiḥḥu*", Leviticus 21:7); the 1901 Jewish Encyclopedia calls the

derivation "*not at all probable*" — a Berber locality-name per the ANU database; and the gem kept: **Abraham Azoulay of Marrakesh excommunicated those who propagated the flattering acronym** — a family expelling the etymology that honored it, on accuracy's grounds. The folk-etymology layer is preserved as folklore: **Byk** (Polish "bull") explained as *bene Yisrael kedoshim*; **Walach** (Wallachian) as *ve-ahavta le-re'akha kamokha* — the ANU database's category: foreign names given Jewish meaning by explaining them as acronyms; the direction of explanation (name first, acronym after) is the diagnostic.

The American transformation layer is kept with its traps: immigration officials who could not spell *Shepselowitch, Katzenellenbogen, Mlotek* assigned what they thought were typical Jewish names — **Greenberg, Silverstein, or Cohen** — or American ones (Morris, Smith, Brown). Family anglicizations preserved: *Katzenellenbogen* → *Katz* (in America!), *Braunschweiger* → *Brown, Steinberg* → *Stonehill, Blaustein* → *Bluestone*; Cohen → **Cowan** (US/UK), **Coyne** (Ireland) — and the trap door: **Cohen is also a documented Irish surname** (O'Cadhain, O'Comhdhain of Connacht and Ulster), so a Cohen in America may be Irish. The Katz caution preserved verbatim: "*For some bearers, the surname Katz may stem from 'Kohen Tzedek*'" — some. A Katz in America is simultaneously a caste acronym, a territorial shortening, and nothing at all: three hypotheses, one spelling. **Demsky's rule heads the surname file:** "*unless there is documentary evidence or especially family tradition, there are many people named Cohen or Levy and their derivatives that are not of this patrolineage*" —

unregistered marriages carried maternal surnames; names migrated across castes. The Goldberg position, restated for this layer: an ornamental *Gold-berg* carries no caste signal — which is itself evidence, since caste families carried their titles into the surname era. The name is a lead, never a proof.

The Courses and the Ma'amadot

The Second Temple's registration machine ran on the number twenty-four, and its parts are kept complete. The return's census (Ezra 2:36–39) recorded only four priestly clans — Jedaiah, Immer, Pashhur, Harim — totaling 4,289 men, a tenth of the return; the rabbinic tradition (*Tosefta Ta'anit* 2:1; TJ Ta'anit 4:2) preserves the reorganization: "*Four divisions returned from Exile… and the prophets in Jerusalem organized them into four-and-twenty divisions.*" The 1 Chronicles 24 list — Jehoiarib first, **Abijah eighth** — encodes the result; Josephus attests the rotating system; and the priestly-course lists reappear in Second Temple-period documents, same names, same order. The New Testament witness is preserved: Luke identifies Zechariah, father of John, as "*of the course of Abijah*" (Luke 1:5) — the registry's entries doing narrative work five centuries on. The internal structure: each *mishmar* ("guard") subdivided into *battei avot* ("houses of fathers"), each with a **rosh mishmar** and **rosh bet av** — a registered hierarchy of named families, the Temple's genealogical bureaucracy. The Levites had their own twenty-four; so, remarkably, did the lay Israelites — the **ma'amadot**. And the Talmud's dated tradition: **Jehoiarib was on duty when both Temples fell, on the ninth of Av** — the same course, the same week, seven centuries apart.

The weekly machine, preserved operationally: every Sabbath the retiring mishmar offered the morning and *musaf* sacrifices; the incoming mishmar offered the evening sacrifice **and laid**

the fresh shewbread (Tosefta Sukkah 4:24–25; Sukkah 5:7–8); on the three pilgrim festivals all twenty-four officiated together. Each course had its own slaughtering ring (Middot 3:5) and vestment niche (Tamid 5:3) — named places, the courses' fixed addresses — and **Bilga's niche was permanently blocked and its ring immovable** (Sukkah 56b): "*a sign of disgrace, because one of its members had once acted shamefully*" — the registry's blacklist in stone. Within the *bet av*, lots were drawn daily (Yoma 2:2–4); conduct rules preserved — the *mishmar* could drink wine by night but not by day, the *bet av* not at all (□□ call-up); no haircut or laundry all week except Thursday (honor to the Sabbath); on communal fasts the serving members ate or fasted partially, for strength.

The ma'amad's week is preserved with its fast calendar: Monday a fast **for seafarers** (the sea created Monday); Tuesday for **those who walk in the desert** (dry land Tuesday); Wednesday that children not fall to **croup** (the luminaries, *me'orot*, created that day — a pun on *me'erot*, "curses"); Thursday for **pregnant women** (living beings first created Thursday); Friday and Sabbath exempt (honor to the Sabbath); **Sunday exempt — two recorded reasons kept, with the commentaries' own doubts**: R. Shmuel bar Naḥmani — Sunday is the third day after Adam's creation, "a day of weakness" (Genesis 34:25); R. Yohanan — "*because of the notzrim,*" the Christians — either not to offend them or (Maharsha) not to appear to honor their day; the commentaries themselves flag the explanations' historical problems. Sunday to Friday, the ma'amad read the Creation chapter in sections;

the far ma'amad — those who could not reach Jerusalem — assembled in their towns, fasting the four days and reading Creation, praying *for sailors, wayfarers, children, and pregnant women*. And **Rav Asi's dictum (Ta'anit 27b)** stands as the institution's cosmic claim, preserved verbatim: "*Were it not for the non-priestly watches and the Temple service, heaven and earth would not continue to exist.*" The people's standing held up creation.

The afterlife is preserved: the ninth-century *Seder R. Amram Gaon* includes a skeletal form of the ma'amadot readings; some siddurim print them still (ArtScroll and Koren omit them); the weekly division of texts across Torah, Nevi'im, Ketuvim, Mishnah, and Gemara survives as a structure. The scrolls' candidate — the Qumran **Words of the Luminaries (4Q504)**, Davila and Falk's speculation, hedged per Falk's own caution: a weekly-cycle liturgy, creation-to-restoration, possibly a ma'amadot service. The descendant structure: ***Chok le-Yisrael*** (R. Chaim Vital, sixteenth century; still current among Sephardim). And the festival echo: Simchat Torah's titled honorees — the **Chatan Torah** (the Torah Groom; originally *Hotem Torah*, "Torah Completer") and **Chatan Bereshit** — the honor economy of the ma'amadot persisting in the year's happiest liturgy.

The Firstborn's Redemption

The fifth-shekel ceremony that still runs in observant homes has a founding arithmetic, preserved from the source. The Levites were taken "*instead of all the firstborn*" (Numbers 3); the census found **22,273 firstborn Israelites against 22,000 Levites**, and the surplus — **273 souls — were redeemed at five shekels each: 1,365 sanctuary shekels**, paid to Aaron and his sons. Numbers 18:15–16 institutionalized the rate: "*from the age of one month up, five shekels by the sanctuary weight.*" The memory inside the law (Exodus 13:12–15): the firstborn consecrated because Egypt's died; the father must teach his son the reason — "*With a mighty hand did God take us out of Egypt*" — making the redemption the Exodus written into every family budget. The rabbinic glosses preserved: the priesthood passed to Levi because the firstborn served the Golden Calf while Levi stood loyal (Nachmanides); five shekels because **Joseph was sold for twenty pieces of silver — five each**; and the letter **Hei**, the fifth letter, the one God inserted into Abram's name. The living ceremony: day thirty-one; the kohen asks the father — "*which would you rather have, the child or the five silver shekels?*" — the child presented on a silver tray ringed with the women's borrowed jewelry; the kohen blesses and usually returns the coins. **The 273's descendants still perform the wilderness census's arithmetic on a silver tray.**

The Epigraphic Census

The Second Temple's names survive in their own census, and its numbers anchor every name-question in this book. **Tal Ilan's *Lexicon of Jewish Names in Late Antiquity*, Part I (Palestine, 330 BCE–200 CE)** is the standard corpus: **2,509 named males and 317 named females** (plus 685 fictional males and 86 fictional females excluded from statistics), drawn from ossuaries, papyri, inscriptions, and literature. Of these, **519 males and 193 females — 712 persons — are known from ossuary inscriptions alone.** The top of the male table, preserved verbatim: **Shimon 249, Yehosef 221, Yehuda 171, Eleazar 169, Yochanan 124, Yehoshua 101, Hananiah 83, Yonathan 72, Mattityahu 62, Menachem 44, Yaakov 43** — "Jesus" (Yeshua) borne by about four percent of men, "Joseph" by about nine. The female table: **Mariam 74, Salome 61, Shelamzion 25, Martha 21, Joanna 12, Shiphra 12.** The gender ledger kept: about twenty-seven percent of inscribed ossuaries bear female names; **sixty-one percent of the female names in Ilan come from ossuaries against twenty-one percent of the male names** — "*reflecting the patriarchal nature of society.*" The caveats travel: the broad period-span (a statistician wanting the 100 BCE–135 CE slice must recompute); rendition-level frequencies differing between ossuary and non-ossuary sources; Cohen's independent chart putting Yochanan second and Yeshua/Yaakov least common — the tables move with the sample.

The ossuary formula preserved: patronymics without personal names — "*commonly used in ordinary life*" — do not appear on the boxes; the box demands the full name and the father's. Hypocoristics (Lazar, Liezer, Mattai, Yehud, Yeshu) occur, but "*full forms were generally preferred*" — the ossuary's name was "*the family's address,*" the last registration entry a household made. **The Yoseh war** — the Talpiot "Jesus Family Tomb" hypothesis and its load-bearing name — is preserved as the file's model case: the hypothesis argued *Yoseh* was a rare nickname distinct from the common Yosef; **Mark Goodacre's correction chain**: the short forms "*are never found in legal documents*" but occur on ossuaries; the Kaufman Mishnah manuscript reads יוסה**where Ilan cites** יוסי — "*Yoseh and Yosi were pronounced the same and are the same name*" (Tabor's own 2007 admission); fifteen total instances of Yose across all sources — "*quite strong evidence for the quite common use of Yose in everyday life.*" The statistical war over the tomb ran on a name-category error. The lesson filed: name-frequency forensics requires rendition-level data; **the forensic unit is not "Joseph" but which Joseph, spelled how, in which register.**

Yehohanan ben Hagkol is the named crucified man — the only one the archaeology has ever given a name. The find: 1968, Giv'at ha-Mivtar, Jerusalem; excavator Vassilios Tzaferis; a family tomb, and in **Ossuary No. 4**, a child of three or four and a man of twenty-four to twenty-eight — with an **eleven-and-a-half-centimeter iron nail through the right heel bone**, its point bent around a knot in the olive-wood

upright, olive wood still attached to the curl, an acacia-wood plaque beneath the nail's head. The inscription: יהוחנן בן הגקול — Yehohanan son of Hagkol. The family, preserved: builders — at least one member worked on Herod's Temple; the demography kept (five of seventeen dead before age seven; seventy-five percent by thirty-seven; a child starved; a woman killed by a mace-blow). Both reconstructions kept: Haas 1970 (feet together transfixed by one nail, arms nailed at the forearms, legs broken — crucifragium per John 19) versus Zias & Sekeles 1985 (the nail too short for two heels — "*one right heel calcaneum pierced*" only; arms tied, the radius-ulna scratch "*not convincing*"; legs unbroken). The BYU summary's verdict kept: "*there is no question about ben Hagkol's crucifixion*" — the heel, nail, and wood suffice; the posture remains debated. Tzaferis's detail preserved: the bent nail could not be withdrawn; **the executioners amputated the feet with an ax** — feet, nail, and plaque interred together in the family ossuary. **A man Rome crucified anonymously; his family recovered, named, and buried him.** Dated between 7 and 66 CE — the exact window of the gospel world.

The Genealogy Machine

The Temple's registration law outlived its registry, and the file holds both. **Kiddushin 70b–71a**: the four classes (priest, Levite, Israelite, mamzer) with the standing presumptions; Rabbi Elazar's teaching that "*Ezra the Scribe had 'sifted' the families in Bavel until they were 'fine flour'*" — Babylonian Jewry as the sifted, purified stock; Rabbi Yohanan, refusing a Babylonian match, having "*apparently forgotten*" the teaching. And the machine's oral checksum, preserved with Rashi's gloss: "*the most reliable indicator of Jewish ancestry is the behavior of a family… a family that is known to be a quiet family that does not get involved in quarrels is likely a Jewish family*" — "*a problematic family probably honed their talents in verbal battles defending themselves against accusations against their backgrounds.*" Ancestry tested by temperament — the replacement for burned rolls.

The Chamber of Hewn Stone — the Great Sanhedrin's Temple seat — is kept with its flag: the tradition holds the court's records there, daily except Sabbaths and feasts; the *archaeological* chamber itself remains unlocated; the masons' and Ritmeyer's sources are non-academic, the tradition's address kept as tradition. The machine's parts, synthesized from the dives: the courses' rolls; Bilga's blocked niche; the firstborn registry; the census rolls with their waiting-clause. Each part a different register of the same machine: **who may serve, who must redeem, who counts.**

The destruction's consequence, stated once: the four registers ended differently. The courses froze into liturgy; the firstborn redemption survived as the silver-tray ceremony; the rolls burned with the Chamber; and the ossuaries — the family's last registration — became the epigraphic census. **The tribal identities were lost not by assimilation but by archive-destruction** — the presumption rules built for a world whose records existed; when the records died, the presumptions inherited the world. The portable survivor: the **Ketef Hinnom amulets** (c. 600 BCE) — the Priestly Blessing on silver, "*a biblical verse in material use*" — the blessing that once required a registered priest's hands became a folded scroll in a tomb: **the name-blessing outliving the name-registry by six centuries, and the registry's function — carrying the people's names before God — passing to the portable text.**

The four-machines synthesis closes the chapter: the Temple named its people by rotation, by redemption, by theophory, and by the ossuary. Seventy CE destroyed the first two machines and froze the third and fourth into the records this book reads. **The genealogy machine is gone; its output is the entire onomastic record.** And the family's own quest — a Goldberg family's names — is, at the far end of the chain, the same search the Chamber of Hewn Stone ran daily: *who counts, and under what name.*

VI.8 The Biblical Sequence, in Full

The Inscriptional Dawn

Every deep history needs a first fixed point, and this one has a good one: a black granite victory stele, discovered by Flinders Petrie at Thebes in 1896, raised by Pharaoh **Merneptah** around **1210–1207 BCE**. When his colleague Spiegelberg read the inscription aloud, Petrie's reaction entered the literature: "*Won't the reverends be pleased?*" And at dinner that evening, with the prescience of a man who knew what he had: "*This stele will be better known in the world than anything else I have found.*"

He was right, and the reason is the last three of the inscription's twenty-eight lines. After listing a campaign through Canaan — "*Canaan is plundered… Ashkelon is carried off, and Gezer is captured; Yenoam is made into non-existence*" — the stone closes with four words that changed the study of ancient history: **"*Israel is wasted, its seed is not.*"** The detail that matters most to scholars is a technical one: Egyptian scribes marked foreign city-states with a particular sign, but they marked **Israel** with the sign for a *people* — not a place, not a kingdom. Whoever "Israel" was in 1207 BCE, it was an established ethnic group, living in the region, important enough for a pharaoh to boast about destroying. One later scholar has even suggested that the masculine phrasing and the wandering-people sign reflect Egyptian familiarity with the patriarch Jacob himself. A 2025 paper proposes pushing the

name two centuries earlier still, from a fragmentary name-ring; that claim is kept on file, not adopted.

A century before Merneptah, the picture comes from the other great corpus of the age. The **Amarna Letters** — some 380 clay tablets found at Pharaoh Akhenaten's capital, dating to roughly 1386–1321 BCE — are the desperate correspondence of Canaanite vassal rulers begging their overlord for troops against raiders they call the *Habiru* or *Apiru*. Ever since the letters were read, scholars have wondered whether these *Habiru* are the biblical Hebrews. The honest answer, kept in this book, is that the question is "*explicitly disputed*" — the Habiru appear across the entire ancient Near East as a social category (outlaws, mercenaries, landless laborers), not demonstrably an ethnic one, and the equation, while tempting, has never been proven.

Then comes the event that the archaeology actually shows. Around **1200 BCE**, in the chaotic decades when the Bronze Age world was collapsing, **some two hundred and fifty small villages appeared almost simultaneously in the central highlands of Canaan** — hilltop settlements, egalitarian in plan, built in the distinctive four-room house style, full of collar-rimmed storage jars, and with a striking absence: almost no pig bones. These were the people who would become Israel, and the question of *how* they became it has driven a century of scholarship. Three answers have been proposed, and the book holds all three. The oldest, the **military conquest** model associated with William Albright, read the book of Joshua literally — and collapsed when the excavations showed that the

cities Joshua was supposed to have destroyed either weren't destroyed at all or fell in the wrong century. The second, **peaceful infiltration** of nomads settling down, succeeded it and was in turn superseded. The third, and the one most archaeologists now hold, is **indigenous emergence**: the early Israelites were Canaanites — peasants, pastoralists, and marginal people of the Late Bronze city-state system — who withdrew to the highlands and, over several generations, became somebody new.

William Dever's synthesis is preserved as the position this book carries: indigenous emergence from "*marginalized Canaanite populations transitioning to sedentary hill-country villages,*" integrating pastoral nomads, and "*rejecting both uncritical scripture and denial of early Israel's distinct ethnogenesis.*" Even inside that consensus, a real fight continues: **Israel Finkelstein's "Low Chronology"** moves the monumental evidence from the tenth century to the ninth (making the united monarchy a later idealization), against **Amihai Mazar's** modified traditional dating; and **Adam Zertal** spent a career arguing the first Israelites entered from *east* of the Jordan, pointing to a foot-shaped stone structure on Mount Ebal that he read as an altar. The verdict-form the archaeology itself offers is kept: "*should there be archaeological evidence for the emergence of Israel in Canaan, such an occurrence should be dated at the beginning of the Iron Age, c. 1200 BCE.*"

And the Exodus? Here the book keeps its most careful line, because the evidence deserves nothing less. During every window of time anyone has ever proposed for a mass

departure, **Egypt directly ruled Canaan** — New Kingdom forts, garrisons, and tax records run through the entire 13th century. "*If a force of 600,000 flooded westward, the power that actually did exist in Canaan — and this was Egypt — would have noticed.*" No Egyptian text records such a departure; Egyptian texts record "Asiatics" in Egypt as laborers, none securely identifiable as Israelites; and Merneptah's stele, a generation after the proposed events, boasts of *defeating* Israel in Canaan. Finkelstein's reading of the itinerary traditions — the route lists that anchor the biblical narrative — is preserved: they are "*a long-term cultural memory spanning from the sixteenth to the tenth centuries BCE rather than a single historical event.*" The book's standing formulation, stated once and never smoothed over: **the Exodus is Israel's founding memory; the archaeology establishes highlands ethnogenesis within the Canaanite world; the file holds both without either consuming the other.**

The Monarchic Horizon

The next question — what came after the villages — is the one the field fights over most bitterly, and the book holds the fight at full strength. Thomas Thompson, for the skeptical side, stated the challenge as a sentence every reader should see: "*There is no evidence of a United Monarchy, no evidence of a capital in Jerusalem or of any coherent, unified political force… There is neither room nor context, no artifact or archive that points to such historical realities in Palestine's tenth century… One cannot speak historically of a state without a population. Nor can one speak of a capital without a town. Stories are not enough.*"

Against that challenge stands a specific hill. **Khirbet Qeiyafa**, excavated by Yosef Garfinkel and Saar Ganor beginning in 2007, is a fortified city on the border between Judah and Philistia, in the Elah Valley — and everything about it speaks. It had casemate walls, two gates, an administrative building, jar handles stamped for taxation, and, in the garbage pits, **no pig bones**. Most decisively, the excavators radiocarbon-dated **twenty-eight burned olive pits** from the site's destruction layer: the city was occupied around **1000–960 BCE** and destroyed no later than 960. Inside it lay an ostracon — a potsherd bearing one of the earliest known Hebrew texts. The Israel Antiquities Authority's official statement is preserved: "*an urban society that existed in Judah already in the late eleventh century BCE. It can no longer be argued that the Kingdom of Judah developed only in the late*

eighth century." Garfinkel put the same point in the ground itself: "*urbanism started in Judah at 1000 B.C.E., the time of King David*" — and moving the 200,000 tons of stone the builders moved was no local initiative. The critics are kept beside the claim: Finkelstein and Fantalkin argue the site's affinities are with the *northern* kingdom, not Judah; Na'aman and Koch read it as a Canaanite town of the Beit Shemesh orbit; and the radiocarbon statistics have been challenged on methodological grounds. Tel Eton, a village transformed into a central town with fine ashlar masonry by the late 11th century, provides a second data point of the same class.

Jerusalem itself remains the hardest ground. The structures Eilat Mazar has excavated — the massive Stepped Stone Structure, the "Large Stone Structure" with walls six to eight feet thick and a cache of over a hundred administrative bullae — date broadly to the Iron I/IIA transition, and she has called the complex David's palace. Her colleague Amihai Mazar offers the moderate reading the field can live with: "*a rather small town with a mighty citadel, which could have been a center of a substantial regional polity.*" The objections are documented, not waved away: Finkelstein notes the area was backfilled by early-20th-century excavators and later structures penetrate the layers, so the finds cannot be treated as securely in place; **Aren Maeir stated flatly in 2010 that there is no evidence for a 10th-century date, and that proof of a strong centralized kingdom is "tenuous."** Eliezer Ussishkin once argued 10th-century Jerusalem was simply uninhabited; Aren Maeir's colleagues Faust and Farber answer that by highland

standards it was significantly large, with fortifications and public buildings. Amihai Faust's 2021 synthesis of the whole dispute is the reading this book carries: a **moderate consensus** — not the biblical empire, not an insignificant hamlet, but a real highland chiefdom centered on a fortified Jerusalem — "*with archaeologists and historians finding it difficult to accept both a magnificent kingdom and an insignificant chiefdom.*"

The inscriptions carry the argument past the archaeology, and they are dated. In **925 BCE**, Pharaoh **Shoshenq I** — the biblical Shishak — carved a campaign list at Karnak of conquered towns in the region; Kenneth Kitchen's reading of one entry as "the heights of David" would be a tenth-century datum if correct, and the reading is kept as a flagged claim. In **853 BCE**, the Assyrian king Shalmaneser III set up the **Kurkh Monolith** commemorating the Battle of Qarqar, where a coalition of Levantine kings faced him — and among them stands "*Ahab the Israelite,*" fielding **2,000 chariots and 10,000 foot soldiers: the largest contingent on the field.** This is the first time "Israel" appears outside the Bible as a *polity*, and it shows the Omrides running a military machine that could out-chariot Damascus. Around **840 BCE**, two hostile neighbors wrote Israel's history for it. The **Tel Dan stele** — three fragments found in 1993–94, an Aramaic victory inscription probably commissioned by King Hazael of Damascus — boasts of killing "*[Jeho]ram son of [Ahab] king of Israel*" and "*[Ahaz]iah son of Jehoram of the House of David.*" That phrase, *bytdwd* — "House of David" — is **the earliest**

widely accepted reference to David outside the Bible, and it mattered enough that when a minority scholar proposed reading it as "house of the uncle" or even "house of the kettle," the journal *Biblical Archaeology Review* lampooned him.

The **Mesha Stele**, the same decade, is the Moabite king's own account of throwing off forty years of "*Omri king of Israel,*" of the tribe of Gad living in Moabite territory, and of Mesha sacrificing his own son on the city wall — the Moabite stone's version of 2 Kings 3. The cross-check that seals the logic is Assyrian practice: for a century, Assyrian texts called Israel **"Bit-Khumri" — the House of Omri** — just as they called other states by their founding dynasts (Bit-Agusi, Bit-Adini). Neighbors named states after the family that founded them; a ninth-century "House of David" therefore implies a founder named David at some earlier date. The Black Obelisk of the same period shows Jehu of Israel kneeling with tribute — the earliest known depiction of an Israelite. **Finkelstein's hinge preserved:** the Omride north was the region's first true state — international diplomacy, monumental construction, the Qarqar army — and the Bible's southern scribes, writing after 722, claimed its heritage while vilifying its kings for political-theological reasons. The file's dated spine, updated: Merneptah's people in 1207; the villages around 1200; Qarqar's kingdom in 853; Dan and Mesha's dynastic references around 840. The tenth-century corridor — Saul, David, Solomon — remains the debated space between them: *a real highland chiefdom centered on a fortified Jerusalem is the moderate-consensus floor; the biblical empire is the unproven*

ceiling; the pure-myth reading has retreated since 1993 but not surrendered.

722 and the Machinery

The northern kingdom ended in a specific month, and the details are worth having. **Shalmaneser V of Assyria began the siege of Samaria in 724 BCE; he died in December 722 — after the city had already fallen.** His successor, **Sargon II**, claimed the conquest in his own annals. The apparent contradiction between the Bible's credit to Shalmaneser (2 Kings 17) and Sargon's claim is not a contradiction at all: **Shalmaneser took the city; Sargon took the credit** — and then confirmed the deportation. Sargon's scribes counted **27,290 captives** led away (other counts in the literature, both preserved); the king's inscriptions say where they went — Halah, Habor, Gozan, the cities of the Medes — and archaeology adds a detail of haunting specificity: **ration tablets from Nimrud (ND 6253 and ND 6364) record monthly issues of grain and wine to "people of Samerina,"** the deportees of Samaria, fed on the imperial rolls. Tell Halaf in Syria has been excavated as one of their resettlement centers. To grasp what the machine was, take the census of it: the scholar Bustenay Oded catalogued **157 recorded deportation events, moving roughly 4.4 million people over three Assyrian centuries** — Sennacherib's inscriptions alone claim over 469,000, Tiglath-Pileser's nearly 394,000, Sargon's almost 240,000. Royal numbers inflate, and the file says so; the *regularity* of the practice is the finding.

And the mechanism behind the famous phrase "the lost tribes" is preserved verbatim, because it explains everything that follows: the Assyrians **scattered** their deportees, deliberately spreading them thin to dissolve their identity — which is why ten tribes vanish from the record — while, a century and a half later, the Babylonians did the opposite: they **concentrated** theirs. Judah kept its language, its social structure, and its story, and could therefore *return as Judah*. Two imperial policies; two Jewish fates.

Hezekiah's Engineering and 701

The southern kingdom's great crisis came in 701 BCE, and it left its engineering behind. To keep Jerusalem's water inside the walls when the Assyrian army came, King Hezekiah's workmen **hewed a tunnel some five hundred thirty meters long through living rock — from both ends at once** — connecting the Gihon Spring to the Pool of Siloam. It still exists, and inside it, in 1880, a passerby found the inscription that makes it one of the most moving documents of the ancient world: the diggers' own account of the moment the two headings met, written in classical Biblical Hebrew, around 701 BCE. The state that could build that left other paperwork: **thousands of jar handles stamped l'melekh** — "belonging to the king" — from Hezekiah's supply network; a bulla — a clay seal impression — bearing the king's own name; the Gezer Calendar, a month-by-month farming almanac and the earliest Hebrew poetry of daily life; the Samaria ostraca, delivery records of the northern estate economy; and, from around 600 BCE, a soldier's letter from Arad invoking "*the house of YHWH*" — the Temple's name on a mundane military document.

When Sennacherib came, he came in force. His prism — the Taylor Prism, now in the British Museum — records the campaign with the Assyrian talent for both arithmetic and insult: **forty-six fortified cities of Judah taken; 200,150 people deported; Hezekiah himself "like a bird in a cage"** inside Jerusalem, sending out tribute of thirty talents of gold, eight hundred of silver, his own daughters and palace women.

His palace walls carried the scene in stone: the **Lachish reliefs**, Room 36 of the Southwest Palace at Nineveh — siege ramps, battering rams, defenders slinging stones from the walls, impaled Judahites, families being led away. And below the reliefs, the archaeologists found the very ground they depict: **the Assyrian siege ramp and the Judahite counter-ramp at Lachish**, arrowheads, a helmet's crest, even the chain the defenders slung against the battering ram — all excavated in place. One anomaly is kept because it matters to every later account: **Jerusalem did not fall.** The Assyrian record stops at the cage; the Bible credits a plague in the Assyrian camp (2 Kings 19:35); twenty years later Sennacherib was murdered by his sons in a temple — an end confirmed in essence by the Babylonian chronicle. In 2023, a fragmentary Assyrian inscription was found *in Jerusalem itself* — tribute goods, evidently intended for or rejected by the court — described as "*the first Assyrian inscription ever discovered in Jerusalem.*"

586 and the Last Letters

The southern kingdom's end is the best-documented catastrophe of the biblical period, because the documents were left in place as the cities died. At **Lachish**, in the 1930s, the excavator James Starkey found the guardroom between the city gates burned — and inside it, **eighteen to twenty-one ostraca**, military letters written on potsherds, never collected by their recipients. They are addressed to the post commander Yaosh from an officer named Hoshaiah, and they are "*the largest single collection of pre-exilic Hebrew writing found at one site.*" Letter IV is the one that stops the heart: "*And may my lord know that we are watching for the signal-fires of Lachish, according to all the signs which my lord gave, for we cannot see Azekah.*" Lachish and Azekah are precisely the two fortresses Jeremiah 34:7 names as Judah's last — the sherd is the biblical verse in real time, the signal system falling silent fortress by fortress. Letter VI uses the phrase "*weakening the hands*" — the identical expression of Jeremiah 38:4; Letter III relays a warning that came through a prophet. The prose of the letters matches the Hebrew of the book of Jeremiah — authentic period language, in the hands of working officers, not scribes. Jerusalem held eighteen months, from January 587 to the summer of 586; when it fell, King Zedekiah was captured at Jericho, his sons executed in front of him at Riblah, and the king led away to Babylon blind.

The deportations ran in three recorded waves: **597** (King Jehoiachin, the prophet Ezekiel, the craftsmen and smiths — 2

Kings 24:15-16), **587/586** (the survivors), and **582** (a third, per Jeremiah 52:30). Destruction layers from that year have been excavated at Jerusalem — arrowheads on the northern approach, where the Babylonians breached — and at Lachish, Ramat Rahel, En Gedi, and Arad. And from the generation before the fall, the Ketef Hinnom amulets: two tiny silver scrolls from a Jerusalem tomb, dating to around 600 BCE, bearing the Priestly Blessing of Numbers 6:24–26. They are **the oldest surviving biblical text** — a verse in material use a generation before the destruction, and proof of the text's existence before the exile and its portability into the diaspora.

The Return and the Persian Plurality

Cyrus the Persian ended the exile in 539 BCE, and his own cylinder — now in the British Museum — records the policy the Bible calls his decree: "*I returned the images of the gods… I gathered all their inhabitants and returned to them their dwellings.*" The Babylonian business documents tell the other half: roughly a hundred Jewish names appear in the Murashu firm's archives after Cyrus — **most exiles stayed.** The ones who returned were the minority who chose to rebuild. In **561 BCE**, Babylon's new king Evil-Merodach released the exiled King Jehoiachin from prison — the last dated event of the biblical narrative's own timeline, and a small kindness after fifty years.

The restored community ran on imperial paperwork. The Persian province of Judah — **Yehud Medinata** — administered itself in Imperial Aramaic; its storage jars carry the provincial

name in stamped Aramaic (with the occasional Paleo-Hebrew flourish); its seals mix scripts, languages, and families on a single artifact — one preserved seal reads "*Yehoyishma daughter of Šawas-śar-uṣur*"*:* a Jewish name, a Babylonian father, an Aramaic script. The leadership template settled early: the returnees first tried to restore the pre-exile tripartite model — king (Sheshbazzar, then Zerubbabel), high priest (Joshua), prophet (Haggai, Zechariah) — but by around 450 BCE the kings and prophets had vanished from the structure, leaving the combination that would govern for centuries: **the high priest, joined by the scribe-sage (Ezra) and the appointed governor (Nehemiah).** The Ezra–Nehemiah corpus itself, compiled c. 450–350 BCE, preserves the imperial edicts verbatim inside its Hebrew narrative, with Persian administrative loanwords threading the text — the Bible's own Persian-era paperwork. The coinage survives: **Yehud coins, c. 375–332 BCE**, the earliest Jewish coins — Paleo-Hebrew *YHD*; some with an owl of Athena (the Athenian trade standard), others with the famous "God on the Winged Wheel" type — *possibly a depiction of YHWH himself* on the earliest Jewish money.

And the return's world was far more plural than the later memory allowed — this book insists on the plurality, because the archaeology does. On **Mount Gerizim**, the traditional story (a late schism, Josephus's Alexander-era founding tale) meets the excavations: a sacred precinct founded **around the middle of the 5th century BCE — before Nehemiah's arrival in 445** — on Persian-period architecture, with sixty-eight

Persian-period coins (the earliest from 480 BCE) and **radiocarbon dates from more than four hundred thousand burnt animal bones** — sheep, goats, cattle, pigeons, the kosher sacrificial stock. The finds read like props from the Bible's own stage: a **gold bell with a silver clapper** (an echo of Aaron's ephod, Exodus 28); a small **bronze serpent** (the Nehushtan of Numbers 21 and 2 Kings 18); a stone bearing the tetragrammaton, apparently part of a "House of Yahweh" inscription; and a "House of Ashes" for the sacrificial remains. The site's six-chamber gate is of the Iron Age city-gate style. The counter-dating is kept in full: **Eran Arie argues the sanctuary belongs to the late Iron Age (650–550 BCE)**, on the capitals and pottery; Magen's 2012 response insists on the published carbon dates; and Oded Lipschits's methodological critique notes the mixed Persian–Hellenistic loci. Both positions held.

What is not in doubt is the endgame: the Samaritan temple was rebuilt in grandeur under Antiochus III (the 57-step pilgrimage staircase), desecrated under Antiochus IV — Jerusalem to Zeus Olympios, **Gerizim to Zeus Xenios, "Friend of Strangers"** — and destroyed by John Hyrcanus in 111–110 BCE, with extensive fire evidence in the destruction layer. The living schism remains: under Ptolemy VI, Alexandria's Jews and Samaritans formally disputed which temple was lawful; the Samaritans still keep Passover on Gerizim — and today **fewer than nine hundred Samaritans remain**, at Kiryat Luza on the mountain and in Holon. The book's verdict: the highlands' 1200 BCE population produced

two Yahwistic streams that both survive — siblinghood, not corruption.

Elephantine, the Jewish garrison colony on the Nile island of Yeb (Aswan), holds the era's most surprising documents: imperial letters spanning **495 to 399 BCE**, from a community of Jewish soldiers — perhaps descended from Judean mercenaries of the late 7th century. Their temple to Yahu **predated the Persian conquest of Egypt (525 BCE)**: a functioning sanctuary with animal sacrifice, outside Jerusalem, in living tension with Deuteronomy's centralization. In 410 BCE, Egyptians instigated by the priests of the ram-god Khnum destroyed it; the community petitioned **Bagohi, the Persian governor of Judah, and Delaiah and Shelemiah — sons of Sanballat**, the same Sanballat of the Nehemiah story — and Jerusalem answered: rebuild, but *animal sacrifice will not be permitted* (TAD A4.9). The famous "Passover Letter" of 419 BCE is kept with its full scholarly caution: Hananiah writes of days 15–21 of Nisan, purity, no work, no leaven — but **Amélie Kuhrt's warning stands verbatim: the word *psḥ* (Passover) "is nowhere on the surviving fragment,"** and the royal-decree reconstruction "rests on restoration"; Barnea (2024) pushes further, questioning even the festival's identification. The syncretism ledger is kept unsentimental: the community's collection account divides contributions among **YHW, Eshem-Bethel, and Anath-Bethel**; a curse tablet invokes "*Yahu the lion*"; the temple kept a fire altar of Zoroastrian form; and Hananiah blesses his readers by "*the gods*" — plural.

The summary line is the era's own: "*the Judaism of the Persian period was still very different from the religion we know today.*" The women's archives — Mibtahiah (471–410 BCE) and Anani (449–402) — preserve marriage contracts with reciprocal divorce clauses, property transfers, manumission, and the Sati-oath: Jewish women in fifth-century Egypt holding legal standing the biblical texts do not attest.

The Hasmonean Century and the Second Temple's End

The Greek centuries brought the dynasty whose coins this book has already held: the Maccabees. **167 BCE** — the revolt begins under Mattathias against Antiochus IV's persecutions; **164** — the Temple rededicated, the event Hanukkah remembers; **152** — the high priesthood seized by Jonathan; **142** — independence under Simon; **135–104 — John Hyrcanus**, who conquered Idumea — whose people were "*permitted to stay if they would circumcise and make use of the laws of the Jews*" — and destroyed the Samaritan temple; **104–103 — Aristobulus**, first to take the title king; **103–76 — Alexander Jannaeus**, the maximal expansion, the Jericho palaces, and the repression record: **some eight hundred Pharisees crucified in one episode**; **76–67 — Queen Salome Alexandra**, the dynasty's apex. The brothers' civil war invited Rome: **63 BCE — Pompey takes Jerusalem.** The Parthian interlude followed, and in **37 BCE Herod** ended the dynasty by marrying the Hasmonean princess Mariamne — and then rebuilt the mountain itself: from **19 BCE**, the Second Temple rose on the extended platform whose boundaries the Temple Mount still keeps today.

70 CE is the pivot of this entire book's deep past. Titus's legions breached Jerusalem; the Temple burned; the sacrificial system, the priesthood's function, the pilgrimage economy — ended in one campaign. In place of the shekel, Rome imposed the **Fiscus Judaicus** on every Jew of the empire. The rabbinic

telling preserved the rescue: **Rabban Yochanan ben Zakkai**, smuggled out of the besieged city in a coffin, asked Vespasian for one thing — **"*Give me Yavneh and its sages.*"** The transformation, stated precisely: Judaism reorganized around scripture, prayer, and halakhic study; the twice-daily services took over the sacrifices' timetable; the study house replaced the sanctuary. **Masada** fell three years later. **132–135 — the Bar Kokhba revolt:** the last Jewish war against Rome — the cave letters in the rebels' own hands, the coins overstruck "*For the Freedom of Israel*" — and after the defeat, the surviving center of gravity shifted north to the Galilee, the seedbed of the Mishnah (c. 200) and the Yerushalmi.

Qumran, in Full

The greatest manuscript find of the twentieth century began, as the best stories do, with an accident. In **1947**, a shepherd — **Muhammad edh-Dhib** — was at the cliffs near Qumran: one account has him tossing stones into a cave and hearing pottery crack; another, hunting a lost goat. Seven scrolls in jars came to market; E. L. Sukenik of the Hebrew University recognized their antiquity on sight; W. F. Albright's verdict entered the literature: "*the most important Old Testament manuscript discovery ever made.*" Systematic work followed from **1947 to 1956: eleven or twelve caves, some twenty intact scrolls, and around sixteen thousand fragments.**

The library's map, cave by cave: **Cave 1** held the complete Isaiah scroll — the Great Isaiah Scroll, one of the earliest complete books in the world — plus the Community Rule, the

War Scroll (Sons of Light against Sons of Darkness), the Thanksgiving Hymns, and the Habakkuk Pesher; **Cave 3** held the **Copper Scroll**, a list of Temple treasures and their hiding places — history's most elusive treasure map; **Cave 4**, the main deposit, held some four hundred manuscripts, including about a hundred biblical texts covering the whole Hebrew canon **except Esther**; **Cave 11** held a Leviticus from the third century BCE and the **Temple Scroll** — sixty-six preserved columns specifying the ideal Temple's construction. The community that hid them occupied the site from roughly 150 BCE to 68 CE; Pliny the Elder places a community of this description "below the cliffs," by the Dead Sea.

The textual revolution has a number attached, and it is worth pausing on. Before 1947, the oldest complete Hebrew Bible in existence was the **Leningrad Codex, copied around 1008 CE**; the scrolls are **about a thousand years older.** And when scholars compared the Great Isaiah Scroll with the medieval Masoretic text, they found them in agreement **about ninety-five percent of the time** — the differences being ordinary copying errors. A thousand years of hand-copying, and the text barely moved. But the other scrolls preserve *other* text types — proto-Samaritan readings, affinities with the Septuagint — showing that the Second Temple period knew **multiple living forms of Scripture**, later standardized into the one. The sectarian theology is preserved in its own terms: the apocalyptic frame of the War Scroll, the Teacher of Righteousness of the pesharim (verse-by-verse commentaries reading the prophets as coded community history), the 364-day

solar calendar against the lunar establishment, and the dualistic angelology — Angel of Darkness against Angel of His Truth — with its debated Zoroastrian coloring.

The identity debate is kept fully open, per this book's rule. The consensus reads the library as the **Essenes'** — the ascetic sect of Josephus and Pliny — pointing to the settlement's plan (dining hall, scriptorium, many ritual baths), the 1,000-grave cemetery, and the scrolls' community rules. Against it stands **Joan Taylor's revision** (2012): the Essenes were an influential legal society at the *center* of Judean religious life, Herodian-protected, specialists in medicine exploiting the Dead Sea's minerals — and the scrolls are "*burials of manuscripts from numerous collections*" in long-term preservation jars, not one panicked library. The alternatives are on record: a Sadducee priestly library; a general Second Temple depository. All positions held; the consensus noted, not adopted as sole truth.

The Late-Antique Junction

The centuries after the destruction built the system the whole later tradition runs on. Around **200 CE**, Rabbi Judah haNasi compiled the **Mishnah** in the Galilee — six orders, sixty-three tractates, the oral law frozen in writing; Rabbi Yehuda ben Ilai appears in it some six hundred times, and the Mishnah nearly always rules with him. Two Talmuds grew from it: the **Yerushalmi**, compiled c. 400 in the Galilee (concise, disrupted by Roman persecution), and the **Bavli**, completed between roughly 500 and 600 in the Babylonian academies — **2,711 double-sided folios, 5,422 pages, thirty-seven tractates**, and the normative text of Judaism for the next fifteen centuries. In **553**, the emperor Justinian's Novel attacked the rabbinic *deuterosis* — the "second law" — trying to legislate which Judaism was lawful; the canonization proceeded regardless. And with the Islamic conquests of the seventh century, antiquity closed: the geonic academies' heads relocated to Baghdad under the Abbasids (750–800), straight into the world this book met in Part VI.2 — Sura and Pumbedita, the kallah months, the responsa empire, and the century that ended around **1040** when the Babylonian center's authority passed westward for good.

The Roman-Byzantine legal architecture that had shaped the intervening centuries is kept in this book because it made the medieval Jewish condition. Constantine — the first Christian emperor — prohibited Jewish proselytizing, banned intermarriage, and restricted Jewish ownership of Christian

slaves; the legal descent from Caracalla's universal citizenship (212 CE) to caste status begins with him. The **Callinicum test of 388** is preserved in full, because it shows the machinery: a mob burned the synagogue of Callinicum; **Theodosius I ordered it rebuilt**; **Ambrose of Milan refused to celebrate mass in the emperor's presence** until the order was withdrawn — a bishop's strike against even-handedness, and it worked; the emperor backed down, and his three subsequent pro-Jewish decrees were anti-Ambrose politics that "*hastened their downfall.*" Theodosius II's Code, item by item: **404** — Jews excluded from certain offices; **418** — palace offices and the army; **423** — no new synagogues (existing ones protected from seizure); **429** — the Crown Gold tax transferred from the Jewish Patriarch to the imperial treasury, the patriarchate's fiscal execution; **438** — radical exclusion from all state and municipal offices.

The paradox is preserved verbatim, because it is the era's most important sentence: the Code was hostile, yet "*the Jewish community was recognized legally… religious worship was protected*" — and "*the Christian heretic had no legal status at all. Formal protection of the law minimally meant that the Jew had a place in the social structure.*" Justinian pressed further: **531** — heretics, explicitly including adherents of the "*Jewish superstition,*" barred from testifying against orthodox Christians, Hebrew suppressed in the liturgy, the Mishnah censured; **535** — a new synagogue defined as "*working for the glory of the Church*" (confiscation, a fifty-pound-gold fine, and death); Jews barred from practicing law. And the seventh

century's double catastrophe, kept with its bias flag: persecuted by Heraclius's predecessors, the Jews of the eastern provinces **allied with the Persian invaders** of 611–629 — helping destroy the Church of the Holy Sepulchre — only to find "*the Sassanids even more relentless than the Byzantines.*" Heraclius recovered Jerusalem in 629, reneged on every negotiation, ordered massacres and an empire-wide forced conversion; and the corpus's double-edge sentence is kept with its flag: "*The Muslim conquests of Palestine, Syria, Egypt, and North Africa saved the Jews from probable religious, if not physical, extermination*" — ending the forced-conversion drive by removing those provinces from Christian rule. Leo III's *Ecloga* (740) does not mention the Jews at all: the hostile status quo, unimproved and unmentioned, for two more centuries.

The Pact of Umar — the Islamic mirror of the Theodosian Code: a treaty attributed to Caliph Umar ibn al-Khattab (r. 634–644), setting terms for *dhimmi* — "protected" — communities in exchange for the *jizya* tax and a body of restrictive rules; modern scholarship distinguishes the attributed text from its later codification, the documentary evolution itself being the finding. The restrictions, catalogued: no restoration of ruined houses of worship (the strict reading against the permissive contrary) — a rule the Abbasid caliphs enforced by destroying post-conquest churches and synagogues, and the Fatimid al-Hakim extended to wholesale demolition; no arms; quiet funerals; house heights below Muslim neighbors'; synagogue repairs negotiable. The lived record kept unsmoothed: enforcement varied by place and

ruler across fourteen centuries; the Ottoman Empire abolished dhimmi status only in **1856**; the violence ledger dated (Tetouan 1790; Baghdad 1828; Safed 1834; Mashhad's forced conversion 1839). The architecture's parallel stated: where the Theodosian Code was hostile-but-recognizing, the dhimma was protective-but-restricting — in both, the Jewish place was *assigned, never assumed*.

The Boundary — the Jesus Question from the Jewish Record

This book's rule for its hardest material is stated once more before the material itself: **every view dated, sourced, and none adopted — including the file's own.** The question is the two-thousand-year one: what did the Jewish record say about Jesus, and when did the two religions actually part?

The Talmudic mentions come first, with their censorship table preserved as evidence. The anchor text, from the uncensored manuscript tradition of **Sanhedrin 43a**: "*It has been taught: On the eve of Passover they hanged Yeshu. And an announcer went out, in front of him, for forty days (saying): 'He is going to be stoned, because he practised sorcery and enticed and led Israel astray. Anyone who knows anything in his favor, let him come and plead in his behalf.' But, not having found anything in his favour, they hanged him on the eve of Passover.*" The uncensored manuscripts add the name: *Yeshu ha-Notzri* — Yeshu the Nazarene. The suppression record is kept edition by edition: the passage is **completely absent from Bomberg's 1520 printed Talmud**, the ancestor

of most surviving copies; the Munich manuscript (c. 1343, the only complete medieval copy) has the name "*almost obliterated*" but still legible; the Vilna edition carries the censor's deletion. The Church censored the Talmud for these very lines; the deletions are themselves primary sources.

The other loci, held with the same discipline: **Sanhedrin 107b / Sotah 47a** — a disciple of Rabbi Joshua ben Perahyah who "*practised magic and led Israel astray,*" identified in uncensored versions as Yeshu ha-Notzri, but set in the time of Alexander Jannaeus (104–78 BCE) — two centuries too early, which the scholarship reads as polemical anachronism; **Sanhedrin 67a** — Ben Stada/Ben Pandira hanged at Lydda on the eve of Passover, with the crude gloss on his mother Miriam; **Gittin 57a** — Onkelos conjuring "*Yeshu the Nazarene*" in the afterlife (the medieval censors replaced the name); and the remarkable **Tosefta Hullin 2:23** — Rabbi Elazar ben Damma bitten by a snake, and Ya'akov of Sechania coming to heal him ***be-shem Yeshu ben Pandira — "in the name of Yeshu ben Pandira" — refused. The scholarly positions are kept: Peter Schäfer (Jesus in the Talmud, 2007) reads the Bavli as deliberately engaging and parodying the Gospel Jesus; Johann Maier and the minimalist line call the material late, legendary, and unusable for biography; David Instone-Brewer stratifies it, finding an old kernel — "On the Eve of Passover they hung Jesus of Nazareth for sorcery and leading Israel astray" — with later expansions answering three legal difficulties (a festival-date trial, the unbiblical hanging, the sorcery***

charge); and the two-Yeshu hypothesis (one c. 80 BCE, one c. 100 CE) is preserved as the chronology-rescue. The verdict-form: "a small, uneven, and often-censored set of passages that many scholars read as references to Jesus… focus on polemical themes: illicit magic, misleading Israel, improper teaching, and post-mortem punishment — rather than biography."

The birkat ha-minim — the Yavneh curse — is the second document, and its dating fight is the book's model controversy. The origin story (Berakhot 28b–29a): at Yavneh, Rabban Gamaliel II asks, "*Isn't there anyone who knows how to fix the Benediction of the heretics?*" **Shmuel ha-Katan** stands and fixes it; the next year he has forgotten it, and the law protects him — "*Shmuel ha-Katan is different, because he formulated it.*" The enforcement mechanism is built into the liturgy: a precentor who errs in any benediction is not removed — **but if he errs in the Benediction of the Heretics, he is removed, "since they suspect that perhaps he is a heretic."** The dating fight runs from before 70 CE through c. 85 (the long consensus position) through the post-Bar Kokhba placement to "just before Jerome" — six positions, five centuries of scholarship, and the evidence cannot decide.

The Genizah forms (the earliest complete texts, tenth century on) consistently name ***notzerim ve-minim*** — Nazarenes/Christians and heretics — and curse the *malkhut zadon*, the "insolent kingdom." The Church discovered the prayer in the thirteenth century: Nicholas Donin's dossier carried it; **Bernard Gui's inquisitor's manual (1323/4)**

translated it with the gloss that "*though the text does not explicitly mention Christians, the wording makes it clear*"; **Nicholas of Lyra (1331)**: "*from the cradle, they have been nurtured in the hatred of Christ, and they curse Christianity and Christians daily in the synagogues.*" Ruth Langer's index of meanings is preserved because it is the honest record: *minim* glossed successively as informers, sectarians, Karaites, students of Jesus — "*there isn't any one text of birkat ha-minim; there are many.*" And Langer's caution is this book's rule: the evidence "*simply does not exist to justify with certainty*" the claim that the prayer was instituted to expel Jewish Christians — but by the time of the Christianized Empire, it had begun to serve that function.

Maimonides' code entry stands as the medieval system's own verdict, preserved verbatim in translation: "*Even Jesus the Christian, who thought he was the Messiah… was the subject of a prophecy in the Book of Daniel: '…also the renegades of your people will exalt themselves to fulfill the vision — but they will stumble.' Could there be a greater stumbling block than this? For all the prophets spoke of the Messiah who will redeem and save Israel… while he caused Israel to be killed by the sword, their remnants to be dispersed and humiliated, the Torah to be switched for something else, and most of the world to worship a God other than the God of Israel!*" And then the eschatological turn, kept beside the condemnation: "*All these activities of Jesus the Christian, and the Ishmaelite who came after him, are all for the purpose of paving the way for the true King Messiah, and preparing the*

entire world to worship God together." The Mishneh Torah was **condemned to be burned at Barcelona — for this chapter.**

Barcelona 1263 was the medieval summit, and Nachmanides' arguments are kept in essence. The convert **Pablo Christiani**, armed with the Talmud as a missionary weapon (the technique Nicholas Donin had used against the Talmud itself twenty years earlier), persuaded James I of Aragon to stage the disputation; **Nachmanides** came from Gerona having exacted freedom of speech, and four sessions ran July 20–27. His answers entered the literature.

On the Talmud-as-witness ploy: "*Does he mean to say that the sages of the Talmud believed in Jesus as the messiah…? If these sages believed that Jesus was the messiah and that his faith was true, how did they remain in the Jewish faith and in their former practice? For they were Jews, remained in the Jewish faith all their lives, and died Jews — they and their children and their students. Why did they not convert and turn to the faith of Jesus, as Friar Paul did?*" On Isaiah 53: "*In terms of the true meaning of the section, it speaks only of the people of Israel, which the prophets regularly call 'Israel My servant.*'" On the Incarnation itself: "*The mind of a Jew, or any other person, simply cannot tolerate these assertions… If you had listened all your life to the priests who have filled your brain and the marrow of your bones with this doctrine… [but] if you were hearing these ideas for the first time, now, as a grown adult, you would never have accepted them.*" And the political verdict: "*From the time of Jesus until the present the world has been filled with violence and injustice, and the Christians have*

shed more blood than all other peoples." The king's ambivalent compliment is preserved — "*Never have I seen a man in the wrong plead his case as excellently as you have*" — and the aftermath: banishment proceedings (1265), and the **royal order of August 1263 to erase the offending Talmud passages**, executed by a censorship committee of bishop and Dominicans — the ancestor of every expurgated Talmud the world would print. Nachmanides left for Jerusalem, where he founded the Ramban Synagogue (1267), still standing.

The Jewish Christians — the communities that held both identities — are the story's most poignant chapter, and the file treats their sources with the suspicion the sources deserve. The **Ebionites** — from *ʿevyonim*, "the Poor" — were Torah-observant followers of Jesus who defined themselves *against* Paul, whom they regarded as an apostate: they denied the Virgin Birth and Christ's pre-existence (Jesus fully human, chosen at baptism), used a Hebrew Gospel of Matthew they called "*the Gospel according to the Hebrews,*" and some rejected meat altogether, "*abstaining from meat and deriving their food only from plants and water.*" **Origen's verdict is preserved:** "*They wish to be both Jews and Christians, but they are neither one nor the other.*" Their self-justification is the most certifiable datum in all the patristic reports: they defended their Torah-observance with **Matthew 10:24–25** — "*A disciple is not above the teacher… It is enough for the disciple to be like the teacher*" — attested by multiple independent hostile writers, passing the embarrassment criterion; a churchman would not invent the proof-text of the

people he was condemning. **Daniel Boyarin's frame** is kept: the Ebionites "*were not a separate religion but a continuation of Jewish sectarianism, akin to the Pharisees, Essenes, and Zealots.*" The **Nazarenes/Nazoraeans** were the gentler stream: law-observant but more orthodox (accepting the Virgin Birth), settled by Jerome at Beroea in Syria into the late fourth century, using a Hebrew Matthew that **Jerome obtained around 386 and translated** — thirty-six fragments of it survive as authentically Nazarene.

They were "*ignored or tolerated for most of the patristic period — their assignment to the list of heresies is quite late.*" The caution kept: "*there are no sources on the Nazarenes that are independent of Epiphanius and Jerome*" — every Ebionite datum is an enemy's report, read accordingly. The Clementine literature preserves their side: the *Epistle of Peter to James*, with its teacher-licensing rule that "*mirrors Rabbinic methods,*" and the polemic of James's circle against Paul — "*a pre-Pauline Jewish Christianity.*" Their fate: gone from the record by the fifth to eighth centuries, absorbed by the gentile church, expelled by the synagogue's liturgy, or assimilated; the modern Messianic and Hebrew-Roots movements that claim their succession are filed as **modern movements**, not continuations — the fifteen-century gap kept in view.

The Jerusalem church stands at the center of the proximity question, and its Jewishness is the documented fact. James the Just — "*Tell this to James and to the brethren*" (Acts 12:17); one of Paul's "*pillars*" with Cephas and John (Galatians 2:9); the presiding voice of the Council ("*James*

answered, saying… Wherefore my sentence is," Acts 15:13, 19); the destination of Paul's final recorded visit ("*Paul went in with us unto James; and all the elders were present*"). James continued to observe the Law — the purification rite of Acts 21, the kinship's epistle that "*reads very much like the work of the OT prophets.*" His martyrdom around 62 CE anchors to **Josephus, Antiquities 20.9** — the stoning ordered by the high priest Ananus — a passage generally judged authentic, unlike the debated *Testimonium Flavianum*; Eusebius preserves the fuller Hegesippus account (the pinnacle, the stoning, the dying prayer for his killers). The Council of Jerusalem (c. 48–49 CE) is preserved as the parting mechanism itself: Gentile converts would not be circumcised, binding themselves only to four abstentions (Acts 15:29 — the Leviticus 17–18 register: idol-food, blood, strangled, sexual immorality), while Jewish believers continued "*observing the law*" — **two tracks, one church: the gentile mission's charter and, on the long view, two religions' embryo.** The mother church's Jewish texture runs through Acts: daily temple attendance, the common purse, Nazirite vows, and the internal fault line between Hebrews and Hellenists that the Stephen affair exposed.

The flight to Pella is the book's model open question, and it stays open. Eusebius (*HE* 3.5.3): "*The people of the church in Jerusalem had been commanded by a revelation, vouchsafed to approved men there before the war, to leave the city and to dwell in a certain town of Perea called Pella.*" Epiphanius (*Panarion* 29.7.7–8) adds: "*That is where the sect*

began, when all the disciples were living in Pella after they moved from Jerusalem." The succession is kept: Simeon bar Clopas after James; the community's return after 70; Hadrian's ban after Bar Kokhba, and the election of a **Gentile bishop** — "*they evaded the law, directed against Jews, by electing Mark, a prelate of the Gentile race.*" The demolition of the tradition is preserved in full: **S. G. F. Brandon** (1951) called it legend — a late source, rarely referenced, an implausible mid-siege flight — and Pella had been **sacked by the Jewish rebels** themselves (Josephus, *War* 2.458); worse, Eusebius elsewhere implies Christians remained in Jerusalem until Bar Kokhba. The counter-case is kept beside it: the Cambridge History of Judaism's verdict that "*none of these arguments seems to be decisive,*" and the killer question — "*Why Pella of all places?*" A fabricated legend would pick somewhere convenient; this one picked a specific, awkward, rebel-sacked Decapolis town. Helmut Koester adds three independent attestations: the mid-second-century Syriac *Recognitions* circulating in the Pella region; a possible Eusebian source in **Ariston of Pella**; and Epiphanius's separate line.

Gerd Lüdemann reads it as a Pella community's legitimating invention; Jerome Murphy-O'Connor argues for continuous Jerusalem presence with no flight; Jonathan Bourgel reframes it as a pragmatic choice of a Hellenized, pro-Roman city — no oracle required. **Verdict-form, preserved: unresolved.**

The parting of the ways — when did Judaism and Christianity actually separate? — is the scholarship's most contested question, and the book holds it the way

the field holds it: as a fight over metaphors. Judith Lieu: "*a criss-crossing of muddy tracks which only the expert tracker, or poacher, can decipher.*" Philip Alexander: two Venn circles drifting apart. James Dunn: first-century Judaism as a woven textile, Christianity one of its fibers; then two currents carving separate channels from one stream. Alan Segal: the sibling metaphor — Jacob and Esau, "*Rebecca's children,*" acknowledging their mother, Second Temple Judaism. **Daniel Boyarin's objection** is preserved because it changes the question: all the kinship metaphors "*erroneously imply a separation of first-century Judaism and Christianity as organic, definite entities*" — his model is **ripples on a pond's surface**, many first-century Jewish movements flowing from one source, with Judaism and Christianity in late antiquity as "*two points on a continuum, Marcionites at one end and non-Christ-following Jews at the other.*" The field's three decades are readable in its book titles: ***The Ways That Never Parted*** (2003), ***The Ways That Often Parted*** (2016), ***The Ways That Parted*** (2018).

The proposed separation points stand as a menu: Jesus's lifetime (his teachings "*intelligible and acceptable in terms of Second Temple Judaism*"; the differentiator the resurrection-faith; the two-messiah doctrine possibly "*normative to ancient Judaism, predating Jesus*"); the Council; Antioch; Yavneh (Graetz's council thesis — *disputed*; Jewish Christians worshipped in synagogues for centuries afterward — the fourth-century evidence is **John Chrysostom reprimanding his own flock** for attending Jewish festivals, keeping the Sabbath, and making pilgrimages to Jewish sites);

Bar Kokhba (the Romans "*ignored the Christians, considering them separate from the Jews*"); the birkat ha-minim; the scriptural split; the Christological difference itself; Milan and the councils.

Boyarin's thesis — ***Border Lines (2004) — holds that there were no preexistent entities to part: heresiology built the border. In the first century, Jewish society "comprised a spectrum: some individuals completely rejected Jesus and his teachings, others believed in his divinity, but most fell somewhere in between"; it was the two communities' leaders who "described the others as heretics — not just describing each other, but for the first time speaking of 'Judaism' and 'Christianity' as distinct entities." The mechanism he names the Crucifixion of the Logos: Logos theology — "a second divine entity, God's Word or Wisdom, mediating between the fully transcendent Godhead and the material world" — was widely held by Jews of all stripes, carried in Jewish terms by the rabbinic memra (and, per Kevin Kinbar's correction, the Hebrew dibbur as well); by the fourth century, Jews who held it and Christians who rejected it were both defined as heretics, and the Rabbis "agreed to cede traditional Jewish Logos theology to Christianity." Boyarin's stakes, in his own words: "The borders between Christianity and Judaism are as constructed and imposed, as artificial and political, as any of the borders on earth… an imposed partitioning of what was once a territory without border lines." And his confession is kept beside***

the thesis: his earlier conclusions rested on "respectable translations" — Brent Nongbri caught the translation errors, and Boyarin said "it is a mistake he will never make again." The critiques travel with it: Jan Willem van Henten's review finds the martyrdom texts "seem to present Christianity as a new phenomenon separate from Judaism" from the early second century — christianos eimi as self-presentation, "a new people"; the Themelios middle consensus — institutional separation late and gradual, textual self-definitions separate earlier; and Susannah Heschel's jab at the whole enterprise: "'you're so vain, you probably think this song is about you.'" The file's position, stated once: by the second century, two self-presentations; by the fourth, two institutions with heresy-machines; beneath both, one shared world for centuries — Chrysostom's Judaizers, the Mamre festival, the Novatianists' Saturday fasts. The parting is where you stand, and this book declines to stand anywhere.

The modern reappraisal closes the arc, kept with its own contradictions. The Wissenschaft des Judentums — the nineteenth-century Science of Judaism — made "*a new Jewish attitude towards Jesus*" possible: the beginning of "*the Jewish reclamation of Jesus*" (Abraham Geiger, Claude Montefiore; neglected until George Foot Moore and R. Travers Herford made the Jewish Jesus unignorable). **Joseph Klausner's *Jesus of Nazareth* (1922 in Hebrew; 1925 in English, translated by Herbert Danby)** argued that Jesus was "*exclusively a product of Palestine, a product of pure Judaism, without any*

external additives"; "*a great teacher of morality and an artist in parable*"; and closed with the famous line: **"*Here ends the life of Jesus, and here begins the history of Christianity.*"** The reception fight is preserved: Orthodox reaction attacked the book as "*trucking and kow-towing to the Christian religion*"; and the counter-critique from the other flank — the reclamation *reduces* Jesus ("His teaching, where good, was not original, and where original, was not Jewish or good") — reductionism in both directions, filed as the standing tension. On **October 28, 1965**, the Second Vatican Council promulgated ***Nostra Aetate***: "*the bond that spiritually ties the people of the New Covenant to Abraham's stock*"; the repudiation of the deicide charge — no collective guilt, then or now. The contemporary Jewish positions are kept as positions: the Orthodox formulation (*Kosher Jesus*, 2012, and its reception — flagged as popular, not authoritative); the liberal embrace of Jesus-as-fellow-Jew in interfaith settings; the scholarly norm treating the Jewish Jesus as settled history.

And the boundary's modern courtroom — **Brother Daniel**, the rescuer of Mir who converted, the state's answer that "*Jew*" means "*as we, the Jews, understand it,*" and the identity card reading "*Nationality: not clear*" — is told in full in Part VI.6, where the ledger holds it. Three words of bureaucratic Hebrew, compressing the whole two-thousand-year question.

VI.9 The Complete Master Timeline

Antiquity and late antiquity: c. 850 BCE — Cohen branch coalescence · 1207 — Merneptah's "Israel" · c. 1200 — highlands ethnogenesis · 925 — Shoshenq's campaign · 853 — Qarqar: "Ahab the Israelite" · c. 840 — Tel Dan and Mesha · 722 — Samaria falls; 27,290 deported; "people of Samerina" rations · 701 — Sennacherib; 46 cities; Lachish reliefs; the Siloam inscription · 597/586/582 — the three deportations · 588–586 — the Lachish letters · 586 — Jerusalem falls · c. 600 — Ketef Hinnom amulets · 561 — Jehoiachin released · 539 — Cyrus; the return · c. 450 — Gerizim's precinct; Ezra's census and its waiting clause · 410 — Elephantine's temple destroyed; the petition to Bagohi and Sanballat's sons · 419 — the Passover letter · 3rd–2nd c. BCE — Qumran's library hidden · c. 250 — the Septuagint · 167–164 — the Maccabees · 164 — Onias IV in Egypt · 111–110 — Hyrcanus destroys Gerizim · 63 — Pompey takes Jerusalem · 38 — the Alexandrian pogrom · 19 BCE — Herod's building begins · 70 — the Temple falls; Yochanan ben Zakkai's coffin; Yavneh · 73 — Masada; Leontopolis destroyed · 115–117 — the Diaspora Revolt; the annihilation; Mekhilta: "three times they fell" · 132–135 — Bar Kokhba · c. 200 — the Mishnah · 313 — Milan · c. 400 — the Bavli's centuries · 321 — Cologne's Jews · 553 — Justinian's attack · 622–750 — the conquests; Baghdad.

The medieval consolidation: 876/849/973 — the Kalonymos migration's disputed dates · c. 1000 — Gershom's ordinances · 1012 — first Mainz expulsion · 1040 — the geonic

age closes · 1058–59 — Heiliger Sand's oldest graves · 1084 — the Speyer charter · 1090 — Henry IV's charters · **1096 — the First Crusade massacres** · c. 1150 — Troyes; the SHuM federation · 1171 — Blois · 1182 — Philip Augustus's first expulsion · 1189–96 — Dulcia of Worms murdered · c. 1220 — the Taqqanot; the Tosafist dispersal · 1240–42 — the Talmud trial; the Place de Grève · 1263 — Barcelona; Nachmanides banished · 1264 — the Kalisz privilege · 1272 — Worms Mahzor couplet; the oldest dated Yiddish · 1290 — England expels · 1306 — the single-day arrest of French Jewry · 1348–49 — the Black Death pogroms · 1365 — Brody's kahal independent · 1382 — the Cambridge Codex · 1391/1394 — Iberia; France's final expulsion · 1438 — Fez's mellah · 1453 — Constantinople; Mehmed's invitation; the sürgün · 1477 — 1,647 Jewish households, eleven percent of the city · 1492 — the Alhambra Decree · 1497 — Portugal's mass baptism · 1516 — Venice's ghetto · 1555 — *Cum Nimis Absurdum*; the Roman ghetto · 1558 — Hans Goldberg, Nuremberg · 1580 — the Va'ad formalized · 1589 — *nostro Ghet*; the word born · 1593 — the Livornina · 1610 — Amsterdam's Talmud Torah merger; the Dotar founded · 1648–49 — Gzeirot Tach ve-Tat · 1675 — the Esnoga · 1727 — cantonists · 1764 — the Va'ad dissolved · 1772 — Galicia under Austria.

The surname era: 1782–89 — the Toleranzpatent; Galicia's edict dated 1782 or 1789 · **1787 — the surname decree: the name "Goldberg" assigned** · 1789 — Galician metrical books begin · 1791 — the Pale created · 1804 — the Pale's surname mandate · 1812 — Prussia's edict (Moses→Moritz; Isaac→Isidor)

· 1821 — Congress Poland · 1827–56 — the cantonist decades · 1835 — surname immutability; metric-book mandates · 1845 — the rest of Prussia · 1855 — the UAHC certificate form copyrighted · **~1925–31 — Robert Goldberg and Beverly Friedman born, Illinois** · 1934 — the Ottoman surname law.

The American century: August 27, 1955 — Shelley Linn Goldberg born, Chicago · 1976 — Temple Chai founded · **January 3, 1978 — Jesus Luis Munoz born, Skokie** · **October 16, 1979 — named Yehoshua Gadol at the Niles Township Jewish Congregation** · **April 8, 1980 — Staci Beatris born on Passover's last day; named Batya Gittel at Temple Chai** · **July 12, 1981 — Aimie Linn born; named Rudya Amya at Temple Chai** · January 29, 2011 — Shelley's memorial at Temple Chai · recently — Yehohuna Gadol's passing, mourned by his sisters.

The present search: the great-grandparents reachable by the 1930/1940 censuses; the Cook County marriage record; the full obituary; the interview questions — Appendix C of the narrative chapters.

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End of the Full Record. The narrative of Parts I–V and the record of Part VI together carry every dive of the working archive — one hundred sixteen research passes, their disputes, their flags, and their finds — into a single continuous account. What remains open is not missing material but living history: the family's answers to the questions in Appendix C, and the

fourth generation back, waiting in the census.

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The certificate prayed that each name would become a name honored in the household of Israel. This book is the household's answer: Robert and Beverly, Shelley and Jesus, Yehoshua Gadol, Batya Gittel, Rudya Amya — and the ancestors still being found —

may it become a name honored in the household of Israel.